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$800 mn asset manager to shift 2 funds out of GIFT on tax issues

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INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND THE NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE" AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, and the Abridged Prospectus)

JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Jio Platforms Limited was incorporated on November 15, 2019, at Ahmedabad, Gujarat, as a public company limited by shares under the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 (**"RHP"**).

Corporate Identity Number: U72900GJ2019PLC110816
Registered Office: Office-101, Saffron, Nr. Centre Point, Panchwati 5 Rasta, Ambawadi, Ahmedabad 380 006, Gujarat, India
Corporate Office: TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park, Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai 400 701, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person(s): Ms. Savithri Parekh, Company Secretary and Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran, Compliance Officer
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com; **Tel:** +91 22 7967 0000; **Website:** www.jio.com

OUR PROMOTER: RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 270,000,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ("THE COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS ("RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND THE RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY. THE COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMs, IS OFFERING A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT")

PRICE BAND: ₹ 1,065 TO ₹ 1,119 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 106.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 111.90 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER

THE PRICE TO EARNING RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 31.71 TIMES, AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 33.31 TIMES, AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 22.35 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

BID/ISSUE OPENS TODAY

BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON(1): FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026

(1) UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.

Jio Platforms Limited, is a technology platform, built on proprietary digital technology and pan-India digital connectivity as its foundational layer, driving digital transformation in India. Our Material Subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited, served 533.3 million customers in India as of June 30, 2026.

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION
RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

ISSUE SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 1,065 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)
Fresh Issue	270,000,000	287,282.94^	270,000,000	301,876.48^
Post Issue Market Capitalisation	**9,209,030,830**	**9,807,617.83**	**9,209,030,830**	**10,304,905.50**

^ Considers the impact of Employee Discount of ₹ 54 per Equity Share

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRE-ISSUE AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED OCTOBER 14, 2026, AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE ISSUE ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated October 14, 2026, the above Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors /KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP vis-à-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary issuances / secondary transactions as disclosed in 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP and provided below in the advertisement and other relevant factors.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to the section titled "Risk Factors" section on page 30 of the RHP.

1. **Risk relating to telecommunication license and spectrum:** The unified licence for providing telecom services held by Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited ("RJIL") across circles in India is due for renewal in October 2033. Further, the spectrum held by RJIL is valid for a period of 20 years with the majority of the spectrum expiring between 2041 and 2042. Any inability to maintain or renew such licences or to successfully bid for any spectrum required for our operations, could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

Continued on next page...

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2. **Dependence on Reliance Industries Limited, Reliance Retail Limited and other Reliance Group entities:** The Company and its subsidiaries have entered into various non-exclusive agreements with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited, a subsidiary of the Promoter and other Reliance Group entities for certain key aspects of the business. Disruption of these arrangements could significantly impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides an overview of our significant transactions with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited and Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited, for the periods/Fiscals indicated.

Particulars	Parent[1]/ fellow subsidiary / joint venture of the Parent	Three months ended June 30,		Fiscal		
		2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
		(in ₹ million, unless otherwise indicated)				
Purchase of Property, Plant and Equipment and Other Intangible Assets	Parent[1] (A)	19,440	14,237	39,040	37,099	62,246
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (B = A/U)	46.46%	11.82%	11.42%	8.38%	11.63%
	Reliance Retail Limited (C)	750	2,352	5,867	14,720	9,458
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (D = C/ U)	1.79%	1.95%	1.72%	3.33%	1.77%
	Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited (E)	414	192	5,339	5,190	1,107
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (F = E/ U)	0.99%	0.16%	1.56%	1.17%	0.21%
Revenue from Operations	Parent[1] (G)	9,322	7,972	36,442	35,997	35,449
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (H = G/ V)	2.38%	2.28%	2.48%	2.81%	3.24%
	Reliance Retail Limited (I)	3,001	4,279	16,374	10,416	7,244
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (J = I/ V)	0.77%	1.22%	1.11%	0.81%	0.66%
Revenue Received in Advance[2]	Reliance Retail Limited	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587
Professional Fees	Parent[1] (K)	5,797	7,520	26,254	29,614	23,364
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (L = K/ W)	1.95%	2.88%	2.40%	3.14%	2.87%
	Reliance Retail Limited (M)	1,082	3,232	7,671	6,730	4,601
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (N = M/ W)	0.36%	1.24%	0.70%	0.71%	0.57%
Network Operating Expenses	Parent[1] (O)	3,131	4,312	18,761	15,807	15,388
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (P = O/ W)	1.05%	1.65%	1.71%	1.68%	1.89%
Selling and Distribution Expenses	Parent[1] (Q)	-	-	-	6,299	9,449
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (R = Q/ W)	-	-	-	0.67%	1.16%
	Reliance Retail Limited (S)	10,527	11,858	43,551	35,158	30,008
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (T = S/ W)	3.54%	4.54%	3.98%	3.73%	3.69%
Cash Capex[3] (U)		41,838	120,481	341,843	442,680	535,096
Revenue from Operations (V)		391,729	350,323	1,468,853	1,282,184	1,095,581
Total Expenses (W)		297,708	261,350	1,094,060	942,057	813,674

Notes:

(1) *Parent, in this table, means the Promoter.*

(2) *Recharge vouchers sold to Reliance Retail Limited are accounted as 'Advance against services' which is disclosed as a related party transaction under the head 'Revenue received in advance'. When Reliance Retail Limited or its distributor/ sub-distributor further sells the vouchers to our customers by way of recharge to the digital connectivity services, RJIL recognises such transfer as 'Deferred revenue' and thereafter, based on the type of tariff plan, it is accounted as operating revenues in the profit & loss account. In light of the above, revenue received in advance has not been presented as a percentage of revenue from operations.*

(3) *Cash Capex refers to the cash outflow towards expenditure for property, plant and equipment, spectrum and other intangible assets less proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment and other intangible assets.*

3. **Dependency on Reliance Retail Limited for distribution of prepaid connectivity services:** RJIL has a master distribution agreement and a master collection agreement with RRL. RRL is the sole distributor of our pre-paid connectivity services. Our revenue from pre-paid connectivity services constituted 76.37%, 77.88%, 77.08%, 78.57% and 79.35% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any disruption in this relationship or distribution channel could adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides the details of the Revenue Received in Advance attributed to the above arrangement with RRL:

Particulars	Three months ended / As of June 30		Fiscal / As of March 31		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
	(in ₹ millions)				
Revenue Received in Advance	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587

4. **Dependency on RJIL that contributes significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT and KPIs relating to digital connectivity services:** RJIL contributed significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT in periods / Fiscals as indicated below:

Fiscals / period	RJIL's revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations	RJIL's EBITDA (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated EBITDA	RJIL's profit after tax (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated PAT
Three months ended June 30, 2026	342,121	87.34%	195,904	93.89%	71,669	92.31%
Three months ended June 30, 2025	308,821	88.15%	173,013	95.40%	67,110	94.39%
Fiscal 2026	1,288,714	87.74%	723,544	94.88%	281,732	93.76%
Fiscal 2025	1,141,413	89.02%	612,334	95.42%	247,948	94.97%
Fiscal 2024	1,001,194	91.38%	528,784	96.21%	204,656	95.53%

Note: The financial information of RJIL provided above is on a standalone basis.

Any material adverse impact on the business, financial conditions or results of operations of RJIL would have a corresponding material adverse impact on our consolidated business, financial condition and results of operations. Further, while we operate as a technology platform, our key operational indicators ("KPIs") are primarily pertaining to our digital connectivity services provided by RJIL and do not reflect the technology platform specific metrics. Our competitors may perform more favourably on certain operational or financial KPIs, which could affect our competitive position. For details of comparison of the KPIs of our Company with listed peers, see *"Basis for Issue Price - Comparison of KPIs with Listed Industry Peers"* on page 135 of the RHP.

5. **Network, Infrastructure and Service Disruption Risk:** The uninterrupted performance, reliability and availability of our network, passive infrastructure, technology, products and services are critical to our operations and our ability to consistently deliver our digital services. Any disruption to our network, passive infrastructure and technology could impair our ability to ensure consistent performance and deliver uninterrupted customer experience, which could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations, and could lead to increased churn in our customer base.
6. **Risk related to Technology change:** The connectivity industry is subject to rapid and continuous technological change, and our connectivity infrastructure faces the risk of technological obsolescence. If we are unable to respond to changes in technologies, including for instance, more competitive satellite-based broadband services and the evolving demands of our customers, we may face technological obsolescence, which would have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
7. **Risk relating to negative publicity of 'Jio' Brand:** The "Jio" trademark is owned by the Promoter, and we do not control the use of this trademark by other companies in the Reliance Group. Negative publicity arising from actions outside its control, inability to protect intellectual property or infringement claims could have a material adverse impact on our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
8. **Dependency on a limited group of passive infrastructure service providers:** We rely on a limited set of passive infrastructure service providers for our operations. For instance, of the 360,537 Network Towers used by us for our operations, 174,451 Network Towers are owned by Summit Digitel Infrastructure Limited, as of June 30, 2026. Additionally, as of June 30, 2026, we rely on Jio Digital Fibre Private Limited, for substantially all our optic fibre network requirements (approximately 98%), aside from the last mile fibre network which is owned by RJIL. Any disruption in the availability of these passive infrastructure assets could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Cybersecurity, Data Privacy and Information Security Risk:** Our systems, platforms, network infrastructure, and the services provided by our Promoter and third-party technology partners are exposed to cybersecurity threats, security breaches, operational disruptions, and other technology-related risks. Any such incident or disruption could impair our operations, compromise data security, increase costs, expose us to regulatory and legal liabilities, and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, and reputation.
10. **Artificial Intelligence ("AI") and Machine Learning ("ML") Technologies Related Risk:** We rely on AI and ML technologies across our operations, including for network automation through our proprietary JioBrain platform, customer engagement and service delivery. The deployment of AI and ML technologies across our operations may not yield the desired results. Further, reliance on AI/ML technologies may expose us to inherent risks pertaining to algorithmic bias and model errors leading to inaccurate or biased outputs, which may cause reputational harm and adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. Our Price/Earning (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 at the upper end of the price band is 33.31 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 22.35, as of October 13, 2026.
12. Weighted Average Return on Average Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 9.04%. Return on Average Net Worth for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and June 30, 2025 is 2.30% and 2.31% respectively (unannualized).
13. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP:

Period	Weighted average cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition#	Range of acquisition price per Equity Shares: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year / 18 months/ 3 years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

#As certified by D T S & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN 142412W/W100595), by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026, (UDIN 26136433YFEPPE7981).

Note: No Equity Shares were transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

14. The 19 BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 160 public issues in the past three years, out of which 46 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date

Book Running Lead Managers	Total public issues	Issues closed below issue price listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	-	-
BofA Securities India Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	2	-
BNP Paribas*	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
CLSA India Private Limited*	-	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	8	2
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited*	5	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* *	5	1
Jefferies India Private Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	3	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
SBI Capital Markets Limited*	6	4
UBS Securities India Private Limited*	-	-
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	131	37
TOTAL	**160**	**46**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs*

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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken any pre-IPO placement from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
2. The Promoter and the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of Equity Shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
3. For the pre-Issue and post-Issue equity shareholding of the Promoter, Promoter Group and top 10 public Shareholders, refer to the section titled 'Capital Structure' on page 99 of the RHP.

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE

(You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company)

*(The **"Basis for Issue Price"** section on page no. 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: https://investmentbank.kotak.com, https://www.morganstanley.com/india, https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking, www.india.clsa.com, www.damcapital.in, www.goldmansachs.com, www.hdfc.bank.in, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.jpmipl.com, www.sbicaps.com, www.ubs.com/indiaoffers and www.360.one for the "Basis for Issue Price" section updated with the above price band)*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors)

Particulars	Time
Bid/ Issue Period (except the Bid/ Issue Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/ Issue Closing Date*^	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIIs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors, Eligible Employees Bidding in Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications for bids beyond ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs, Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bidding	Monday, October 19, 2026
Bid/Issue Opens on	Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Bid/Issue Closes on	Friday, October 23, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, October 26, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, October 28, 2026

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Issue BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the ICDR Master Circular, and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days in compliance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. However, in case of revision in the Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**") ("**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), and 40% of such Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non- Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. One-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 1,000,000 provided that under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Non-Institutional Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, and Eligible Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to participate in the Issue through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see *"Issue Procedure"* beginning on page 534 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "*History and Certain Corporate Matters*" on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, please see the section titled "*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*" on page 577 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,900,000,000,000 divided into 10,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and 180,000,000,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹89,390,308,300 divided into 8,939,030,830 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company is Reliance Industries Limited (including one Equity Share each allotted to six individuals as nominees of RIL) (10,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each). For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus has been and shall be delivered to the RoC as applicable, in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 577 of the RHP.

Disclaimer clause of the SEBI: SEBI only gives its observations on the Issue documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 488 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "**Risk Factors**" beginning on page 30 of the RHP

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. C27, 'G' Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) , Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4336 0000
E-mail: jio.ipo@kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
Contact Person: Ganesh Rane
SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704

Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited
Altimus, Level 39 & 40
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6118 1000
E-mail: jpl_ipo@morganstanley.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investors_india@morganstanley.com
Website: https://www.morganstanley.com/india
Contact Person: Keyur Thakar/ Hrithik Khanna
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011203

BofA Securities India Limited
Ground Floor, "A" Wing, One BKC, "G" Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6632 8000
E-mail: dg.jpl_ipo@bofa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com
Website: https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia
Contact Person: Sahil H. Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011625

Axis Capital Limited
1st Floor, Axis House
P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4325 2183
E-mail: jio.ipo@axiscap.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaints@axiscap.in
Website: www.axiscapital.co.in
Contact Person: Sanaea Sumondy/ Simran Gadh
SEBI Registration No: INM000012029

BNP Paribas
1, North Avenue Maker Maxity
Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3370 4000
E-mail: LIST.CIB.JioIPO@asia.bnpparibas.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
indiainvestors.care@asia.bnpparibas.com
Website: www.bnpparibas.co.in
Contact Person: Ankur Thacker
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011534

Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited
1202, 12th Floor, First International Financial Center, G Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 098
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6175 9999
E-mail: jio.ipo@citi.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors.cgmib@citi.com
Website: www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking
Contact Person: Naman Kulshreshtha
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010718

CLSA India Private Limited
8/F Dalamal House
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6650 5050
E-mail: jio.ipo@clsa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.helpdesk@clsa.com
Website: www.india.clsa.com
Contact Person: Prachi Chandgothia
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010619

DAM Capital Advisors Limited
Altimus 2202, Level 22
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4202 2500
E-mail: jio.ipo@damcapital.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaint@damcapital.in
Website: www.damcapital.in
Contact Person: Aanchal Wagle/ Jay Shah
SEBI Registration No.: MB/INM000011336

Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
9th and 10th Floor, Ascent-Worli
Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6616 9000
E-mail: jioipo@gs.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: india-client-support@gs.com
Website: www.goldmansachs.com
Contact Person: Saurav S
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011054

HDFC Bank Limited
Investment Banking Group
Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7th Floor, Tower 2 and 3
One International Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi
Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3395 8233
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@hdfc.bank.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com
Website: www.hdfc.bank.in
Contact Person: Bharti Ranga/ Souradeep Ghosh
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011252

HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited
52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6864 1289
E-mail: jplipo@hsbc.co.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in
Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in
Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar/ Harshit Tayal
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010353

ICICI Securities Limited
Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6807 7100
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@icicisecurities.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com
Website: www.icicisecurities.com
Contact Person: Ramesh Vaswana / Soumavo Sarkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179

IIFL Capital Services Limited
(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)
24th Floor, One Lodha Place
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4646 4728
E-mail: jio.ipo@iiflcap.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com
Website: www.iiflcapital.com
Contact Person: Gaurav Mittal/ Pawan Kumar Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010940

Jefferies India Private Limited
Level 16, Express Towers
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4356 6000
E-mail: Jio.Platforms.IPO@jefferies.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: jipl.grievance@jefferies.com
Website: www.jefferies.com
Contact Person: Akshat Shah/ Meghna Biju
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011443

JM Financial Limited
7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg
Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6630 3030
E-mail: jpl.ipo@jmfl.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com
Website: www.jmfl.com
Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361

J.P. Morgan India Private Limited
J.P. Morgan Towers
Off C.S.T Road, Kalina, Santacruz (East),
Mumbai - 400 098 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6157 3000
E-mail: JIO_IPO@jpmorgan.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investorsmb.jpmipl@jpmorgan.com
Website: www.jpmipl.com
Contact Person: Shivam Goel/ Rishank Chheda
SEBI Registration No.: INM000002970

SBI Capital Markets Limited
1501, 15th Floor, A & B Wing, G Block,
Parinee Crescenzo, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4006 9807
E-mail: jio.ipo@sbicaps.com
Website: www.sbicaps.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investor.relations@sbicaps.com
Contact Person: Krithika Shetty/ Prashant Patankar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000003531

UBS Securities India Private Limited
Unit 2901, Level 29, Altimus,
Dr. GM Gokhale Marg /
Pandurang Budhkar Road,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 018, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6155 6000
E-mail: OL-jioipo@ubs.com
Website: www.ubs.com/indiaoffers
Investor Grievance E-mail: igbmindia@ubs.com
Contact Person: Vidhit Patni
SEBI Registration No.: INM000013101

360 ONE WAM Limited
360 ONE Centre, Kamala City
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West),
Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4031 7000
Email: jioplatforms.ipo@360.one
Investor Grievance E-mail:
mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one
Website: www.360.one
Contact Person: Devesh Patkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000012801

REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE

KFin Technologies Limited
Selenium Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Gachibowli,
Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally
Hyderabad - 500 032, Telangana, India
Tel: + 91 40 6716 2222/ 1800 309 4001
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@kfintech.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
einward.ris@kfintech.com
Website: www.kfintech.com
Contact Person: Williams R
SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221

Company Secretary
Ms. Savithri Parekh

Compliance Officer
Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran

TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park,
Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli,
Navi Mumbai 400 701Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 7967 0000
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary or Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

Continued on next page...

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AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:

Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP, before applying in the Issue. A copy of the RHP is made available on website of SEBI at **www.sebi.gov.in**, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**, respectively, and on the website of the Company at **https://www.jio.com**; and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one;.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:

A copy of the abridged prospectus is made available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Issue at **https://www.jio.com/platforms/** ; **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one; Registrar to the Issue, **KFin Technologies Limited** – www.kfintech.com., respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS:

Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED**, **Tel**: +91 22 7967 0000; BRLMs: **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000**; Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000**; BofA Securities India Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000**; Axis Capital Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183**; BNP Paribas,** Telephone: +91 22 3370 4000**; Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999**; CLSA India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6650 5050**; DAM Capital Advisors Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500**; Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000**; HDFC Bank Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233**; HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289**; ICICI Securities Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100**; IIFL Capital Services Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728**; Jefferies India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000**; JM Financial Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030**; J.P. Morgan India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000**; SBI Capital Markets Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807**; UBS Securities India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6155 6000**; and 360 ONE WAM Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000**; Syndicate Members: HDFC Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2230753400**, Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited** Tel: + 91 2268497400, **JM Financial Services Limited** Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, **Kotak Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2242858484, **SBICAP Securities Limited** Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, **Sharekhan Limited** Tel: +91 22 6750 2000, **360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited** ***(Formerly known as Batlivala & Karani Securities India Private Limited)*** Tel: + 91 022 40317000 / +91 022 40076000 **and 360 ONE Distribution Services Limited** Tel: 9321332882 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members:

Almondz Global Securities Ltd, Ambit Capital Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Centrum Finverse limited, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance Ltd, Mehta Equities Limited, Monarch Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Paytm, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Rikhav Securities Ltd, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Sundae Capital, Sunidhi Securities & Finance Ltd, Sushil Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Systematix Shares & Stocks (India) Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha

Escrow Collection Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Refund Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

Sponsor Banks: Axis Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

Jio Platforms Limited has provided a toll free number to address any queries related to the Issue.

Toll free number: 1800 309 4001

You may also address your queries related to the Issue by typing **'Hi'** or **'Hello'** on

WhatsApp to 7977222222

For JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Ms. Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra
Date : October 21, 2026

All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them In the RHP.

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of the Company at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled "**Risk Factors**" on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

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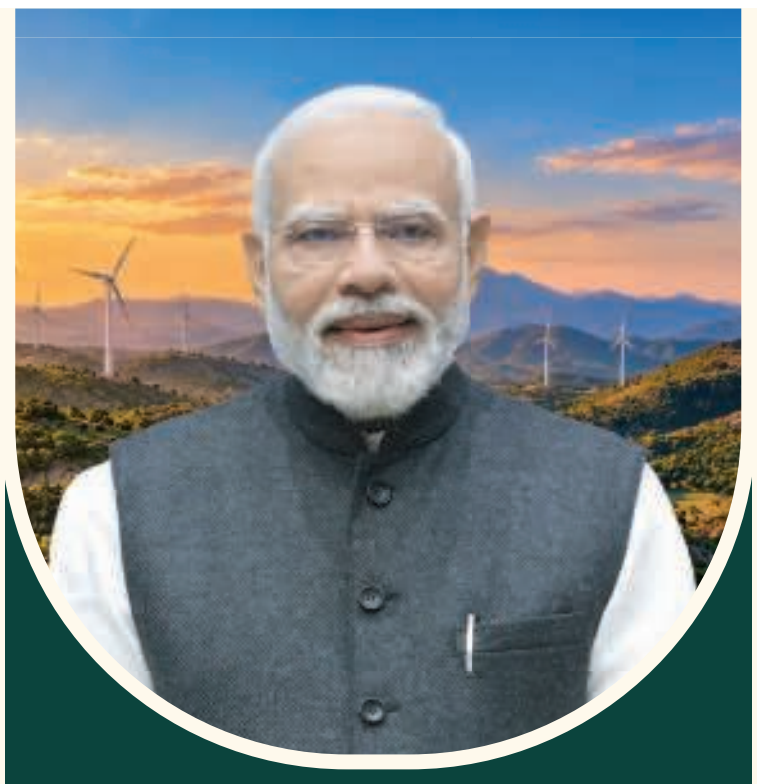

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Shri Narendra Modi
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COMPANIES 2 ▸

6 months after patent expiry, semaglutide generics fuel growth

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FM seeks global framework to address the fallout of sanctions

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Power sector: The old is undermining the new

IN BRIEF

Rubio calls India a 'refining superpower'

PHOTO: REUTERS

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio (*left*) with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar in Mumbai on Tuesday

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio on Tuesday described India as a refining superpower, adding that the US delegation will discuss with Reliance about producing oil in Venezuela. Asked what role India can play in meeting the world's energy demand, Rubio, who arrived in Mumbai on a three-day India visit, said: "India is a refining superpower. They have the capability to refine heavy crude. They've done so in the past, and I think as more and more Venezuelan oil comes online, it's something they can do." 7 ▸

RESULTS RECKONER

Quarter ended Sep 30, 2026;
Common sample of 171 companies
(Results available for 198 companies)

Sales		
Sep 30, 2025	₹5.07 trn	6.2%
Sep 30, 2026	₹6.02 trn	18.9%
Reported net profit		
Sep 30, 2025	₹1.10 trn	9.1%
Sep 30, 2026	₹1.34 trn	21.9%
Adj net profit (excl. extraordinary items)		
Sep 30, 2025	₹1.12 trn	9.8%
Sep 30, 2026	₹1.35 trn	20.8%

'Jio IPO is landmark for Indian capital markets'

Q&A A day before the mega initial public offering (IPO) of Jio Platforms opens, its Managing Director **Akash Ambani** speaks about the company's future, the implications of the stock market listing, the telecom sector's demands from the government, satellite broadband vision, tariffs and competition. Edited excerpts from an email interaction with **Nivedita Mookerji:**

A decade after it was launched, Jio is going for an IPO. What will change for the company?

■ Jio is where I began my professional journey, so this step means a great deal to me. The IPO reflects the trust of over half-a-billion Indians, and with that trust comes the responsibility to keep innovating and put customers first. Jio started as a vision, and it was a privilege for me to work with our team to turn it into our own technology stack, scoring many global firsts and over 7,220 patent applications. The next decade will be even more transformative. We want to take 5G, home broadband and artificial intelligence (AI) to many more people and businesses, and to take the technology we built in India to select international markets through partnerships. Our purpose remains to build one of the world's leading digital infrastructure platforms, creating enduring value for all shareholders.

PHOTO: JIO PLATFORMS

"WE ARE EVALUATING PARTNERSHIPS WITH LEADING GLOBAL CONSTELLATION PROVIDERS TO BRING (SATCOM) SERVICES THERE SOONER"
Akash Ambani,
Managing director, Jio Platforms

What are the implications for the Indian telecommunications sector?

■ Indian telecom proved that a digital nation can be built bottom-up, on affordable data. In FY26, Jio serviced 60 per cent of India's wireless data. Jio's listing is an important milestone in that journey. It lets public-market investors see how connectivity, technology and digital services together create value across the economy. I believe the sector is well placed to play an even greater role in India's future.

■ 'IPO brings responsibility to be transparent, uphold strong governance standards' P2 ▸

PAGE 6

Rising overnight rates point to surge in liquidity demand

The Reserve Bank of India's overnight variable rate repo auction on Wednesday is likely to see strong demand as declining surplus liquidity pushes up overnight rates. The weighted average call rate rose to 5.66 per cent on Monday, nearing the marginal standing facility rate. ANJALI KUMARI reports

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KRISHNA KANT & RAM PRASAD SAHU look at 10 defensive stocks that have underperformed but their lower valuations offer room for recovery

■ PSBs take returns lead; private banks hold valuation edge P10 ▸

$800 mn asset manager to shift 2 funds out of GIFT on tax issues

KHUSHBOO TIWARI
Mumbai, 20 October

Artha Bharat Investment Managers IFSC, a fund management entity (FME) in GIFT City managing over $800 million in assets in the financial centre, is relocating two of its funds to Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM), citing tax uncertainty and compliance burden.

The FME is relocating the master fund of the $112 million Artha Global Multiplier Fund, which invests primarily in the US consumer theme. The second is the recently launched Artha Bharat Absolute Return Fund, an arbitrage fund investing in Indian securities. The Artha Global Multiplier Fund is open only to non-resident Indians (NRIs).

"WE DO NOT BELIEVE THAT TAXATION IS SMOOTH HERE (GIFT CITY)," SAID SACHIN SAWRIKAR, FOUNDER & CEO, ARTHA BHARAT

■ Some GIFT AIFs get tax notices despite exemption P10 ▸

The FME is in the process of setting up a new fund in ADGM, following which investors in the current funds may shift to the new one.

Sachin Sawrikar, the firm's founder and chief executive officer (CEO), said: "We do not believe that taxation is smooth here (GIFT City). There is a lot of uncertainty. Our FME was disallowed the tax deduction under Section 80LA, a matter we are pursuing. Leading fund jurisdictions generally tax at the investor level. In India, there are several categories, with differentiated taxation."

Section 80LA of the Income Tax Act, 1961 provides tax deductions for specified income earned by Offshore Banking Units in Special Economic Zones (SEZs) and units in International Financial Services Centres (IFSCs). Turn to Page 6 ▸

HDFC to ramp up beyond home shores

SUBRATA PANDA
Mumbai, 20 October

HDFC Bank, India's largest private sector lender, may look to expand its overseas branch network under incoming Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (MD & CEO) Anup Bagchi, who is set to take charge by the end of this month.

A limited international presence constrained the bank's ability to mobilise foreign currency non-resident-bank — or FCNR(B) — deposits under the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) concessional swap facility, as noted by outgoing MD & CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan during an earnings call over the weekend. "We have just about two effective branches operating outside of the country — one was Bahrain, the other one was Singapore," he said.

Turn to Page 6 ▸

Major lenders' overseas footprint

SBI: 245 overseas points across 29 countries

ICICI Bank: 6 business centres and 12 representative offices

HDFC Bank: Branches in Hong Kong, Bahrain, Singapore and Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC); IFSC unit in GIFT City; representative offices in Nairobi, UAE and London

Axis Bank: Branches in Singapore and DIFC; IFSC unit in GIFT City; representative offices in UAE and Bangladesh

Retail auto sales rise on high base this Navratri, but cars see 14% drop

SHINE JACOB
Chennai, 20 October

Automobile retail sales during the nine days of Navratri rose 2 per cent this year compared with the corresponding period last year, despite an unusually high base set in 2025 when goods and services tax (GST) cuts and pentup demand drove an exceptional surge in purchases. Passenger vehicle sales, however, fell 14 per cent over the same Navratri-to-Navratri comparison, according to provisional data from the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (Fada).

Overall automobile retail sales between October 11 and 19 stood at 1.032 million units, compared with 1.012 million units during September 22-30 last year, the corresponding first nine days of Navratri. Two-wheeler sales rose 6 per cent to 759,684 units, pointing to continued strength in rural demand, while commercial vehicle sales increased 14 per cent to 34,120 units. Passenger vehicle sales, by contrast, fell to 172,087 units from 199,320 units during the corresponding period last year.

Turn to Page 6 ▸

Staying the course

Navratri sales (in units)

	2024	2025	2026	% change ('25 vs '26)
Two-wheelers	614,460	718,179	759,684	5.78
Passenger vehicles	161,443	199,320	172,087	-13.66
Three-wheelers	37,097	43,780	43,057	-1.65
Commercial vehicles	29,481	29,874	34,120	14.21
Tractors	18,203	19,209	20,912	8.87
Wheeled-CE	2,643	1,971	2,185	10.86
Total	863,327	1,012,333	1,032,045	1.95

CE: Construction equipment; 2024: Navratri-Dussehra (Oct 3-12); 2025: Navratri (Sep 22-30); 2026: Navratri (Oct 11-19); Source: Fada Research

A new spark: Sivakasi sets sights on fireworks exports

SHINE JACOB
Chennai, 20 October

PHOTO: SHINE JACOB

A fireworks-manufacturing unit in Sivakasi, which accounts for 85 per cent of India's organised fireworks trade

Sivakasi, a small town in Tamil Nadu, has added many feathers to its cap: From former Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru dubbing it "*Kutty* Japan" — an indication of its industrial prowess — to being billed the "Pyro Town of India" or the "Fireworks Capital of India", it has come a long way. Today, it outshines all its rivals in the industry, accounting for 85 per cent of India's organised fireworks trade.

As Diwali nears, Sivakasi is buzzing with optimism. It has received a breather from the Supreme Court on the fireworks ban and ramped up the production of green crackers, which should bring relief to the industry. There is another potential turning point: It is set to join the export bandwagon soon.

Sivakasi has already started receiving queries from European and US customers, with one Poland-based firm showing strong interest. These include companies that previously placed large orders with China.

If plans by Tamil Nadu's C Joseph Vijay government materialise, a policy to bring Sivakasi in line with global standards will soon be in place. The state is also seeking certain policy concessions from the Centre to boost exports.

Industry sources say Sivakasi is witnessing a marginal rise in orders this festival season, despite a price increase of between 30 and 50 per cent.

"We want Sivakasi to compete with the world through better technology, higher standards and new markets, while ensuring that the dignity, welfare and livelihoods of its workers remain at the heart of this transformation," state Industries Minister and Sivakasi MLA S Keerthana told *Business Standard*.

Turn to Page 6 ▸

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6 months after patent expiry, generics fuel semaglutide growth

ANJALI SINGH
Mumbai, 20 October

Six months after semaglutide lost patent protection in India, the market is settling into a steadier rhythm. Generic brands now account for about 74 per cent of monthly volumes, as lower prices widen access even as the initial rush for the weight-loss and diabetes drug begins to settle.

Figures from data insight platform Pharmarack's PharmaTrac show total semaglutide volumes, across injectable and oral formulations, rising from 114,000 units in February to about 434,000 in September, up nearly 281 per cent. Sales value climbed 135 per cent — from ₹48 crore to ₹113 crore — over the same period, suggesting that volumes have grown considerably faster than value as patients shift to cheaper generics.

Monthly sales volumes rose about 175 per cent from March to September. The sharpest jump came in April, the first full month after the March 20 patent expiry, when volumes surged 88 per cent, following a 38 per cent increase in March. Growth then slowed to 12 per cent in May and 4 per cent in June, before picking up to 18 per cent in July. Volumes were broadly flat in August and rose 7 per cent in September.

Pharmarack describes the market as "plateauing". Though the initial rush has eased, demand continues to expand, indicating the initial generic-led expansion is giving way to a more mature phase of growth.

The early excitement cools

Doctors report a similar shift: More patients can now afford semaglutide, but the early excitement around the drug is fading.

Aparna Govil Bhasker, consultant bariatric and laparoscopic surgeon at Saifee Hospitals in Mumbai, said prescriptions have risen since Indian versions entered the market. Lower prices have brought treatment within reach of more patients.

"The Indian drugs have really made a lot of difference to a lot of people because they are very affordable," she said.

The increase is visible among patients seeking treatment for both diabetes and obesity. Patients generally ask for a treatment option rather than a particular brand, with affordability and personal preference influencing their choice, Bhasker said.

But requests driven purely by cosmetic concerns, such as losing weight before weddings and other occasions, have declined. Use is becoming more "doctor-driven", she said, as patients better understand that semaglutide is a prescription medicine with potential side effects.

Generics dominate injectables

The shift is most pronounced in injectables — volumes rose from 63,000 units in March to 273,000 in September, including an 11 per cent increase over August. Their value rose from ₹34 crore in March to ₹76 crore in August.

Generic injectables accounted for about 230,000 units, or 84 per cent, of September's volumes, against 43,000 units for innovator products.

The widening gap between volume and value captures the effect of cheaper alternatives. By September, total semaglutide volumes were about 3.8 times their February level, while sales value was 2.4 times higher.

The market's composition is changing, too. Injectable volumes have risen consistently since generics entry, while oral semaglutide volumes fell in August before recovering slightly in September. Pharmarack recorded about 160,000 units of oral semaglutide in September, including 70,000 units of innovator products.

Patients still show some reluctance to use injections and often prefer tablets, Bhasker said. Oral formulations could gain ground as newer products become available.

Inventory begins to ease

Inventory levels offer another glimpse of the market's adjustment. Semaglutide inventory stood at 16 days in February, before patent expiry, rose to 25 days in March and April, and peaked at 26 days in May as companies adjusted to the arrival of generics. It then fell to 24 days in June and July and 23 days in August.

Falling inventory does not, by itself, establish stronger demand; it can also reflect lower production or dispatches. But stocks eased even as volumes continued to rise through August, suggesting the market was absorbing much of the additional supply.

Nirali Shah, research analyst at Ashika Investment Managers, said concerns that inventory accumulation was masking underlying demand had eased. "The patient who started because their neighbour lost weight is dropping off and what remains is the diabetic, the metabolic disease patient, the person whose doctor made a clinical decision. That is a smaller number today but a far stickier one," she said.

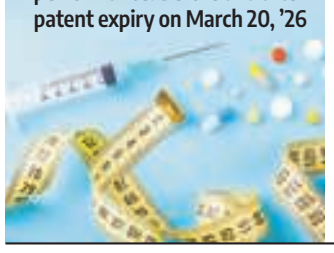
Shah described the transition as a move from a "buzz phase" to a "prescription habit phase", a pattern often seen in chronic-treatment markets after the arrival of generics.

The trajectory suggests two distinct stages: A sharp burst of growth after patent expiry, followed by slower expansion as the market establishes a new base.

For manufacturers, the next challenge is less about launching into the initial frenzy and more about retaining patients, building sustained prescriptions and differentiating products in an increasingly crowded market.

Market shift

Semaglutide market performance: Before and after patent expiry on March 20, '26



	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep
Total units sold	114,000	157,000	296,000	332,000	345,000	405,000	405,000	434,000
M-o-M volume growth *(%)*	12	38	88	12	4	18	0	7
Total value *(₹ cr)*	48	59	88	93	92	104	105	113
Generics' share in volume *(%)*	0	30	62	67	69	72	72	74
Generics' share in value *(%)*	0	22	51	53	52	55	55	57
Inventory *(days)*	16	25	25	26	24	24	23	-

M-o-M: Month-on-month; Note: Inventory days data for September was not available Source: Pharmarack

QUICK READ

Stellantis India looks to halve vehicle development time

Stellantis India is targeting to halve vehicle development time and ramp up localisation for certain models as it prepares to launch 12 products across Citroen and Jeep brands under its FaSTLAne 2030 roadmap, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Shailesh Hazela *(pictured)* said. "Globally, we announced that our ambition is to cut down our development time for bringing new products from 48 months to close to two years, which is around 24 months. That is what we are working on (for) our products, which we are going to launch," Hazela told *PTI* in an interview. Stellantis has one of its software and technology centre in Bengaluru. On localisation, Hazela said Citroen has localisation level in the range of 90-95 per cent, while Jeep brand's localisation stands at around 70-75 per cent. PTI

SLMG Beverages eyes ₹20K crore turnover in 5 yrs

SLMG Beverages, Coca-Cola's largest bottler in India, is targeting a turnover of ₹20,000 crore within five years and plans to list on the stock exchanges before that timeline, according to its Joint Managing Director Paritosh Ladhani. The company also looks to explore opportunities in overseas markets. "We should at least go for ₹20,000 crore in the next five years. We will definitely be listed by then," Ladhani told *PTI* in an interview. PTI

Prestige Estates to launch ₹40K cr homes in H2FY27

Realty firm Prestige Estates Projects Ltd will launch residential properties worth ₹40,000 crore in the second half of this financial year, a 2.5 times jump from April-September period, as it looks to encash festival demand. In its latest operational update, Bengaluru-based Prestige Estates informed that residential launches for April-September of the 2026-27 fiscal year aggregated 23.14 million square feet with a revenue potential of over ₹16,200 crore. PTI

OYO parent to nearly halve IPO fresh issue size to up to ₹3,350 cr

OYO parent PRISM is planning to nearly halve the size of the fresh issue in its proposed initial public offering (IPO) to up to ₹3,350 crore from almost ₹6,650 crore, sources said on Tuesday. "The original issue was sized before the company's more recent financial performance came through. With cash generation remaining strong and the balance sheet improving, the funding requirement has come down," one per said. The revised issue size comes with PRISM continuing to focus on reducing its outstanding debt. PTI

India has set itself the task of being a leader in 6G: GSMA APAC head

Q&A Satellite technology will complement mobile networks in bridging India's connectivity gaps, particularly in remote areas, as the country advances towards 6G, **Julian Gorman**, head of Asia-Pacific (APAC) at GSMA, the global telecommunications (telecom) industry association representing more than 700 companies, tells **Gulveen Aulakh** in New Delhi. Direct-to-device (D2D) services will further extend connectivity, while global spectrum agreements at the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference (WRC-27) will help shape their rollout. Gorman also discusses India's 5G progress, artificial intelligence (AI) integration, network monetisation, and anti-scam measures, arguing that the country is emerging as a global model for next-generation telecom technologies. Edited excerpts:

What role will satellite broadband play as India transitions to 6G?

■ India is a large and complex country. Mobile technology already covers 98 per cent of the population, but satellite technology can help address the remaining coverage gaps. In the short term, the focus is on closing the usage gap, as a significant portion of the population still lacks broadband access. As satellite technology evolves, we will develop different approaches to connecting the country. But we must keep our eyes on the goal of connecting everyone to mobile broadband so they can participate in the digital economy.

How far is India from seeing D2D networks?

■ It depends on the regulatory environment. Some markets, such as New Zealand, have introduced early services, including SMS over satellite links. Australia has introduced regulations requiring operators to provide national coverage, which will necessitate partnerships. However, mass adoption is still some way off. Discussions need to begin now, and they are already under way. These efforts will also feed into WRC-27, where we are working to ensure spectrum is available.

Consumer tariffs in India are among the lowest in the world. Is it time to raise them?

■ Consumer demand for data is still growing. Our forecasts suggest average monthly data consumption, currently in the mid-20 gigabyte (GB) range, will rise to around 75 GB by 2030. Video consumption is growing, while smart devices, glasses, wearables, connected cars, AI and AI agents are creating new use cases. These will help operators monetise their investments. The sustainability of investment is critical.

Is 5G Advanced around the corner for India? When is it expected to become mainstream?

■ We are beginning to see testing and trials of 5G Advanced in China and several other countries. It brings additional capabilities, including ultra-low latency, greater capacity, and new antenna technologies. GSMA is working globally to encourage more operators to adopt it.

In technology, there are leaders and followers, and some countries are still at the earliest stages of 5G. India has set itself the goal of leading in 6G, which puts greater pressure on its innovation ecosystem to move quickly.

"WE ARE STARTING TO SEE TESTING AND TRIALS OF 5G ADVANCED IN SEVERAL COUNTRIES... GSMA IS WORKING GLOBALLY TO ENCOURAGE MORE OPERATORS TO ADOPT IT"

Julian Gorman
Head of APAC, GSMA

Has India been slow to adopt 5G network slicing?

■ Network slicing is a key feature of 5G and will carry into 5G Advanced and 6G. It allows networks to deliver specific service levels for different use cases. RedCap (reduced capability), for instance, supports devices with lower data requirements and power consumption. Private networks in factories may need high capacity, while AI applications such as real-time translation require low latency. India's innovation ecosystem needs to explore these capabilities across sectors, including hospital, healthcare, mining and safety. Network slicing also offers data security benefits by allowing organisations to operate private networks over public infrastructure.

More on business-standard.com

BVG India focusing on long-term contracts with better margins: CMD

DEEPAK PATEL
New Delhi, 20 October

BVG India, which manages facilities for airports and railway stations and also operates bus fleets, is shifting its focus towards long-term contracts that offer better margins and faster cash collection, as the integrated services provider has reached a level where it could be more selective about the work it takes on, Chairman and Managing Director (CMD) Hanmantrao Gaikwad told *Business Standard* in an interview on Tuesday.

BVG India is also into emergency ambulance services, waste management and infrastructure management services. It also operates in environment and sustainability services.

The company wants contracts that provide good returns on investment and greater visibility on revenue and margins, rather than chase growth through low-margin work.

The integrated facility management (IFM), which includes housekeeping and building maintenance, contributes around 65 per cent to its revenue. On the other hand, emergency response services accounts for about 15 per cent, and environment and sustainability services, which covers waste management, landscaping and other environmental services, contributes around 20 per cent, the company's chief executive officer (CEO) Rupal Sinha said.

In financial year 2026 (FY26), BVG reported revenue from operations of ₹4,128 crore, up 25 per cent from ₹3,302 crore in FY25. Its profit after tax (PAT) from continuing operations rose 28 per cent to ₹284 crore in FY26 from ₹222 crore in the previous year.

Sinha expects the broad revenue mix to remain similar over the next five to seven years, with IFM contributing 60-65 per cent and the other two divisions making up the balance. The shares may fluctuate from year to year, particularly when the company wins a new emergency response contract, but will broadly remain at the same level, she said.

BVG India CMD Hanmantrao Gaikwad said the firm now has greater room to choose contracts based on their profitability

BVG India received approval from the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) for its initial public offering (IPO) in September 2026. The proposed IPO comprises a fresh issue of shares worth ₹300 crore and an offer for sale (OFS) of 2.85 crore shares by existing shareholders. The company plans to use ₹250 crore from the fresh issue to repay borrowings and the remaining ₹50 crore for general corporate purposes. The OFS will allow promoter Gaikwad and two investment vehicles affiliated with private equity (PE) investor 3i Group to sell their shares.

Chief Financial Officer (CFO) Manoj Jain said 3i, which has been associated with BVG since 2011, wants to exit and that this was the primary reason for the IPO. The fresh funds will also help reduce working capital borrowings and borrowing limits, creating more room to finance future growth, he said.

Gaikwad said the company now has greater room to choose contracts based on their profitability and how quickly they generate cash. "It should be a long-term contract. It should be a high-margin contract, an Ebitda-accreting contract," he said. Ebitda — earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortisation — measures operating profitability before these costs are deducted.

The company also assesses whether a contract fits its broader purpose of serving people, places or the planet. BVG is avoiding manpower-only staffing contracts because their margins are low, the CMD said. "Just increasing availability and top line doesn't make any sense," he added.

BVG is not "shying" away from government contracts, CFO Jain said, but will pursue those that meet its requirements for margins, cash flow, and duration. Government contracts can offer good margins, but payments often take longer to arrive.

Government business contributed about 78 per cent to BVG's total business in FY22, but its share has since fallen to around 40 per cent, Jain said. The company's average time to collect payments, known as days sales outstanding, has also declined from 180 days to 112 days as of March 2026.

The shift in business mix and the decision to exit some contracts also affected operating margins over the past few years, Sinha said.

BVG is also looking to expand overseas, with operations under way in Saudi Arabia. Also, a small part of the company's operations is starting in Israel this month, Gaikwad said. He expects international business to contribute around 10 per cent to total revenue once it reaches maturity, although he did not specify a firm timeline.

IPO brings responsibility to be transparent: Akash Ambani

FROM PAGE 1

What is your biggest ask from the government in terms of telecom policy?

■ The government has consistently been ahead of the industry in envisioning India's digital future. Digital India set the direction, and public infrastructure such as the UPI (Unified Payments Interface), Aadhaar, Jan Dhan and direct benefit transfer has brought services to people at scale. I deeply appreciate that foresight. It has earned India global recognition and gives us confidence in what the country can achieve. Policy certainty has been a big support to the industry. Sustaining this industry- and customer-friendly stance will take digital adoption deeper.

Jio's valuation has been a talking point; it is expected to be the largest IPO in India so far. What do the size and scale of the IPO signify?

■ The price band is public, and the valuation has come through the book-building process with investors, not from a management claim. True to the Reliance DNA, we have always believed in leaving enough on the table for incoming investors so that they stay invested for the long term. The pricing carries a reasonable discount to the peer group, by design. The size reflects the breadth of Jio's business and its role in India's digital economy, and it is a landmark for Indian capital markets... What matters more to me is what it brings: A wider group of shareholders, and the responsibility to be transparent, uphold strong governance and create enduring value.

Will the quarter-to-quarter cycle be a challenge for Jio, which has operated like a startup in many ways?

■ I do not believe so. Jio has the energy and nimbleness of a startup, but runs with the rigour and discipline of a large enterprise. Jio onboarded a new set of global shareholders in 2020 and is a material subsidiary of the Reliance Group. As a result, Jio has been running like a quasi-listed entity, with gold-standard corporate governance mechanisms. Our performance is already reported every quarter as part of Reliance's results, and transparency and accountability are already part of our DNA.

While comparison between Jio and Bharti Airtel is often done in subscriber numbers, growth, profits, and valuation, among other things, what according to you is the biggest similarity and difference between the two?

■ Jio is not just a telco; it is a digital services company built on connectivity, spanning 5G and home broadband, cloud, devices, software, entertainment and enterprise services. I leave comparisons to others, and we respect every competitor. The difference I would point to is that Jio is a technology platform that uses connectivity as its distribution layer. We designed and own the core technology ourselves, from the 5G core and OSS (operations support systems)/BSS (business support systems) platforms to the software that runs the network. That is how we could deploy more than 1 million 5G cells within 19 months. Our technology and digital-products team is 12,477 strong, and it designs and develops across all four layers — autonomous network, hardware, software and applications.

Jio Platforms MD Akash Ambani and RIL Non-Executive Director Isha Ambani in Mumbai on Thursday PHOTO: PTI

Is it time for an industry-wide tariff hike in telecom, including at Jio? Do you have an Arpu (average revenue per user in a month) target for the next five years?

■ Our promise to customers is simple: Data they can afford, on a network that keeps getting better. What I can point to is usage: In the quarter ended June 30, 2026, each customer used 43.7 GB a month. We have not set an Arpu target. Our approach is to build value per customer through deeper engagement, upgrades to 5G and new digital services, so that revenue growth rests on sustainable customer value. Affordability and inclusion will remain central to our growth.

AI will be a major driver in telecom going forward. How should the regulatory environment adapt to this?

■ Our ambition is AI for every Indian, not a privileged few. Jio-Bharat IQ and HelloJio work across 12 Indian languages, so people can talk to AI in the language they think in. Regulation should encourage innovation with clear, proportionate and predictable safeguards, and adapt as technology moves. Policymakers, industry and researchers must work together on data protection, cybersecurity, accountability and human oversight, so that AI is deployed responsibly and in the interest of users.

When do you expect satellite broadband to take off in India, and what does the Jio satellite broadband service plan to achieve?

■ Jio's vision is to enable digital life for every Indian by connecting everything everywhere at the highest quality and most affordable price. While telecom connectivity is ubiquitous in India with 99 per cent population coverage, there are some use cases for satellite for maritime, aviation and some of the remotest regions. Thus, satellite complements terrestrial networks, it does not replace them... We are evaluating the possibility of developing a sovereign Low Earth Orbit satellite constellation for India. At the same time, we are building ground station infrastructure in the country. We are also evaluating partnerships with leading global constellation providers to bring services there sooner. Over the long term, the opportunity is to create an indigenous satellite connectivity capability for India. The timing will depend on a multitude of factors like technology evolution and approvals, etc, so I will not put a date on it.

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quick scroll

Cognizant, Google Cloud expand ties to drive agentic AI adoption

Cognizant and Google Cloud on Tuesday announced an expansion of their partnership to accelerate the adoption of agentic AI, including a new "Gemini Frontier Capability Group". The group brings together a dedicated global workforce that pairs Google's full-stack, enterprise-ready AI platform with Cognizant's domain, industry and engineering expertise as an AI-builder, according to a release. The new group represents a substantial joint investment and builds on the momentum created by it's dedicated Gemini practice launched in April 2026. PTI

CXMT swings to profit after memory chip prices surge

Chinese chipmaker CXMT Corp. reported a surge in preliminary profit and sales during the first nine months of the year after global demand for memory sent prices of the components soaring. The domestic memory-chip leader said preliminary net income will amount to 131 billion yuan to 132.5 billion yuan ($19.6 billion to $19.8 billion) in the period, compared with a net loss of 5.3 billion yuan in the first nine months of last year. Preliminary revenue is expected to reach 265 billion yuan to 270 billion yuan, versus 32.1 billion yuan last year. The broader memory-chip field has seen a boom in demand that has sent sales and stock prices skyrocketing. BLOOMBERG

Visa, billing firms team up for AI agent payments

Visa Inc. is partnering with BILL Holdings Inc. and Billtrust to have artificial intelligence (AI) agents initiate and complete business invoice payments without the need for human authentication. The solution is in pilot mode, according to a statement on Tuesday. It seeks to address the tedious process of manually reviewing and paying business invoices, many of which are recurring and predictable. BLOOMBERG

Apple faces UK pressure to open iPhone to rival wallets

Apple Inc.'s control over the iPhone is blocking fintech rivals from competing with its digital wallet, the UK's antitrust watchdog said proposing to force the Big Tech firm to open up its its contactless technology. The Competition and Markets Authority's proposal aims to make it easier for rivals to access Apple's contactless technology and at "substantially lower fee." The proposal is part of an investigation after the regulator designated Apple as being dominant in the mobile ecosystem sector, and raised concerns over high fees and restrictions on firms to access the iPhone's contactless technology. BLOOMBERG

Focus on safety paramount: Match Group exec

Tinder, Hinge roll out India-specific safety features, biometric checks

AASHISH ARYAN
New Delhi, 20 October

Match Group, which owns and operates dating platforms such as Tinder, Hinge, and The League, has introduced India-specific safety measures, including screenshot and contact blocking, to protect users, said Yoel Roth, senior vice-president and head of trust and safety at the group.

"We heard a lot of concern, especially from women in India, that they were worried people would take screenshots of their profiles and share them on social media or with friends. So, we have blocked the ability to take screenshots on Hinge and are now expanding that functionality to Tinder as well," Roth said.

These India-specific features, along with other functions such as allowing users to block phone contacts so friends and family cannot view their profiles, are part of the group's broader effort to make both dating platforms more user-friendly and safer, Roth said. He added that Match Group invests roughly $125 million every year in safety measures across its platforms.

For both Tinder and Hinge, Match Group has also introduced mandatory biometric verification during sign-up, including a video selfie for all users.

"THERE IS A LIMITED NUMBER OF PEOPLE DOING THE SCAMMING. SO, IF WE SEE THE SAME FACE GETTING REGISTERED REPEATEDLY, WE CAN USE THAT TO KEEP THE PERSON OFF OUR APPS"

Yoel Roth
Senior V-P & Head of Trust and Safety, Match Group

The video selfie helps the platforms detect whether a user is a real person rather than an artificial intelligence-generated profile. It also helps scan the entire database for similar profiles and duplicate registrations, particularly those linked to criminal networks operating on these dating apps, Roth said.

"There is a limited number of people doing the scamming. So, if we see the same face getting registered repeatedly, we can use that to keep the person off our apps. We can keep known bad actors off our services," he said.

An initial analysis shows that these checks have helped reduce the number of bad actors on Tinder and Hinge by 40 per cent, Roth said.

To further prevent criminal networks from misusing these platforms, Match Group has partnered the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre, under the Ministry of Home Affairs, to launch a romance scam awareness campaign in India.

As part of the campaign, the company will provide practical guidance on recognising common romance scam tactics, spotting red flags, and accessing official resources to report cybercrime and seek help, Roth said.

The platforms will also warn users if a potential match tries to move the conversation too quickly to a peer-to-peer messaging app or promises high returns on investments within minutes, he said.

Indian users show "remarkable openness" to dating, though the focus is not always on finding someone to marry but also on getting to know a compatible partner, he said.

"Increasingly, we also see that GenZ singles really want dating to be a social experience and not necessarily a high-pressure thing. It is something they want to be able to do with their friends," Roth said.

With this in mind, Tinder has introduced features such as double dates, which allow users to go out with friends, and a feature that lets friends pick matches for one another, he further said. Match group is also likely to introduce its Events feature in India in the near future, Roth said.

AI agents must be given limited access to network: Microsoft V-P

AASHISH ARYAN
New Delhi, 20 October

Companies deploying artificial intelligence (AI) agents must restrict their access to enterprise systems and sensitive data to prevent them from overstepping their assigned tasks, a senior Microsoft executive has warned.

Mike Yeh, vice-president and deputy general counsel of customer security and trust at Microsoft, believes that enterprises must give least amount of privilege and access of their networks to contain AI agents and stop their overreach.

"When you look at how consumers are using agents today... they are giving them access to their email, bank accounts. You can see why that will create problems in the near term. As we get smarter about that, we have to change the mentality. The default is the least amount of privileges for the agent to do its task," Yeh told *Business Standard* in an interaction in New Delhi.

Mike Yeh, vice-president & deputy general counsel of customer security and trust, Microsoft

There should also be more transparency from frontier AI-model developing companies about the capabilities of the AI agent they are releasing to users, so that "there is a better understanding of what the consequences could be," Yeh said.

Speaking on the 2026 Microsoft Digital Defense Report, Yeh said that while most cyberattacks still exploit old vulnerabilities, going forward, everything will have to be seen through the lens of how AI has impacted it.

"We have a very small window right now to get the basics right. For example, vulnerabilities from the year 2020 that were exploited this year should have been patched. This is where the industry needs to do its homework before people start using AI in a way that really compresses the attack cycle timeline for us," he said.

To give enterprises and customers more options and control over their digital networks, Microsoft has also introduced newer control options for Azure users, Yeh said.

On Tuesday, Microsoft's chief executive officer Satya Nadella announced in Paris a host of new initiatives from the company on expansion of sovereign Cloud capabilities, including giving Azure users a unified way to assess their sovereignty posture, identify the gaps in their existing Azure capabilities, apply the necessary guardrails as per the rules of the country of operation, and retain evidence of qualifying Microsoft operator access.

Speaking on the newer initiatives announced by Nadella on Tuesday, Alistair Speirs, the general manager at Microsoft Azure, said different countries now have varying definitions of sovereignty, so companies do not have a mandatory set list of standards they must meet.

"So, we really think of sovereignty as a risk management exercise. And as a risk management exercise, it sits alongside other risks, including business continuity, natural disasters, and cybersecurity," Speirs said during a select media roundtable.

YatriKart, MMG group ink ₹120 cr deal to open 1,000 quick-stop stores

UDISHA SRIVASTAV
New Delhi, 20 October

Transit retail chain YatriKart has partnered with MMG group in a ₹120 crore deal to open 1,000 quick-stop convenience stores across India over the next five years, as the company looks to build an organised retail network catering to consumers on the move.

The MMG group is one of the largest franchise bottling and marketing partners for Coca-Cola India and also operates McDonald's outlets in northern and eastern India.

Under the franchise invested, company operated model, MMG group will fund store infrastructure and capital expenditure (capex), while YatriKart will manage operations, staffing, technology and supply chain.

The partnership builds on MMG group's earlier investment in YatriKart, when it acquired an approximately 5 per cent stake for ₹5 crore, according to Gaurav Rana, founder and chief executive officer of YatriKart.

YatriKart's quick stop outlets offer coffee, food, beverages and everyday essentials at high-footfall locations, including petrol pumps, highways, hospitals, corporate parks and transit hubs. The company is also expanding into colleges and other locations where people spend time away from home.

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Sitharaman seeks global framework to address the fallout of sanctions

FM calls for multilateral rules, citing economic penalties have consequences beyond intended targets

ASIT RANJAN MISHRA
New Delhi, 20 October

> "THE EMPHASIS ON FORMALISATION OF THE ECONOMY, HEALTHIER BANK AND CORPORATE BALANCE SHEETS, AND PRUDENT MACRO POLICIES IS UNDERPINNING THE STRONG GROWTH OUTCOMES"
>
> Nirmala Sitharaman
> Finance Minister (at the IMF and World Bank annual meet last week)

Finance Minister (FM) Nirmala Sitharaman has called on the international community to explore a multilateral convention on economic sanctions outside the Bretton Woods Institutions, including World Bank and International Monetary Fund (IMF), citing their growing economic and financial consequences for countries beyond those directly targeted.

"The growing economic and financial ramifications of primary and secondary sanctions, and their mounting macrocritical implications for countries beyond those directly targeted, highlight the need for the international community to explore a multilateral convention on economic sanctions outside the Bretton Woods Institutions to enhance predictability and stability in the global economy," Sitharaman said at a meeting of the International Monetary and Financial Committee during the IMF-World Bank annual meetings in Bangkok last week.

Sitharaman called for greater attention to the spillover effects of a broader range of policy instruments beyond traditional monetary and fiscal policies, including trade and technology restrictions, carbon taxes, and industrial and labour policies.

The remarks came amid concerns over the effects of US sanctions against Russia and Iran on third countries, including India. The Lindsey O Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026, signed into law in September, sought to increase pressure on Moscow over its war in Ukraine and on Tehran by enabling tariffs of up to 100 per cent on imports from countries that continue to buy Russian oil and gas. The threat raised concerns in New Delhi over the potential conflict between securing affordable energy supplies and protecting access to the US market. US President Donald Trump has waived key provisions of the law for 60 days, citing US national interests.

Sitharaman also flagged how large fiscal deficits, high debt, and heavy investment in artificial intelligence have pushed bond yields higher in major economies, with the effects spilling over to emerging markets (EMs) and developing economies through capital outflows, exchange-rate pressures, and tighter domestic financing conditions. "This creates difficult policy trade-offs for EMs in preserving both internal and external stability," she added.

Sound macroeconomic (macro) policies are more important than ever amid these challenges, Sitharaman said, calling on countries to rebuild fiscal buffers to withstand recurrent shocks. "Fiscal reforms should focus on revenue mobilisation, spending efficiency, growth-friendly consolidation, and targeted social protection, underpinned by credible medium-term plans. Close fiscal-monetary coordination will be essential to preserve macro stability amid simultaneous pressures on growth, debt, and inflation," she added.

Turning to India, Sitharaman said that despite heightened global uncertainty, the country's growth momentum remained strong, driven by infrastructure investment, robust manufacturing, and resilient domestic consumer demand. "The emphasis on formalisation of the economy, healthier bank and corporate balance sheets, and prudent macro policies is underpinning the strong growth outcomes," she said.

The IMF has projected India's growth at 7 per cent in both 2026-27 and 2027-28. "It is encouraging to note that India continues to be a major contributor to global growth, with a share of almost 18 per cent, and that its improved growth trajectory has contributed to the IMF's upward revision of global growth," Sitharaman said.

While maintaining that inflation and inflation expectations remained anchored, supported by prudent policies and active supply-side measures, Sitharaman acknowledged that the breadth of price pressures had widened, raising the risk that food, freight and energy costs could spill over into core prices and inflation expectations. "Policy will therefore continue to combine monetary vigilance with targeted interventions and logistics improvements to respond to supply-side shocks," she added.

The FM said India's growth-friendly fiscal consolidation aimed to preserve and augment capital expenditure while containing untargeted subsidies and recurrent spending. "The quality of consolidation — supported by tax reforms and improved spending efficiency — is already yielding positive outcomes, including by crowding in private investment. Enhanced fiscal credibility is also reflected in a moderate rise in Indian government bond yields compared with major economies since March 2026. Stronger macro fundamentals, together with recent sovereign rating upgrades, have helped contain risk premia and borrowing costs," she added.

Referring to the successful raising of over $130 billion through foreign currency non-resident (bank) deposits, Sitharaman said capital-flow measures announced in June had helped attract sizeable non-resident deposit inflows, supporting a strong accretion to foreign exchange reserves.

DATANOMICS

Finally, goods producers get pricing power

INDIVJAL DHASMANA

Goods producers saw a nearly 10 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) increase in prices of their produce during the first half of the current financial year 2026-27 (H1FY27), in contrast to the market apathy seen during the same period over the previous three years. While they witnessed no price rise in April-September period of FY26, the rise was just 1.5 per cent in the same period of FY25, following a 1 per cent fall in H1FY24. Manufacturers and producers of mining goods saw a double-digit price rise in H1FY27. However, the base was too low in the previous year for both of these segments. Electricity producers never saw any price rise in the first half of any of the four years. In fact, the output producer price index (PPI) for electricity in April-September FY27 was 91.4 points, 8.4 per cent lower than the 2022-23 base year. Manufacturers received higher prices for their products compared to inputs in every month of the first half of FY27 relative to the base year.

Producer price rise near double digit in H1FY27

Output PPI inflation in the first half (% Y-o-Y)

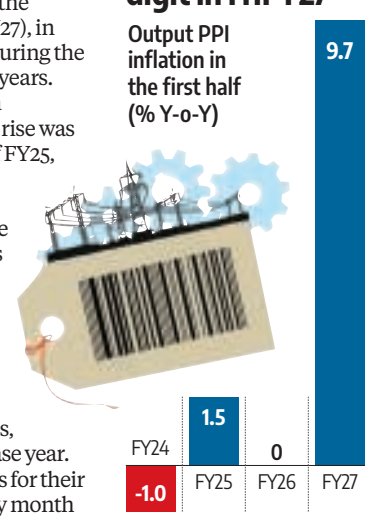
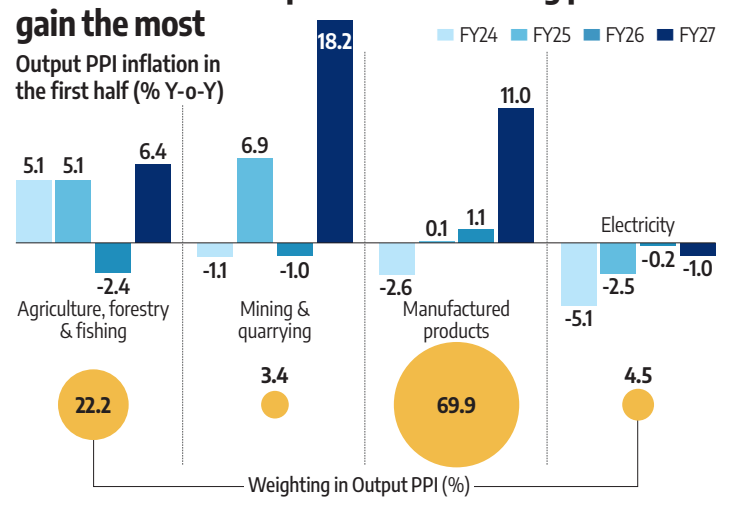


ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA

Manufacturers and producers of mining products gain the most

Output PPI inflation in the first half (% Y-o-Y)

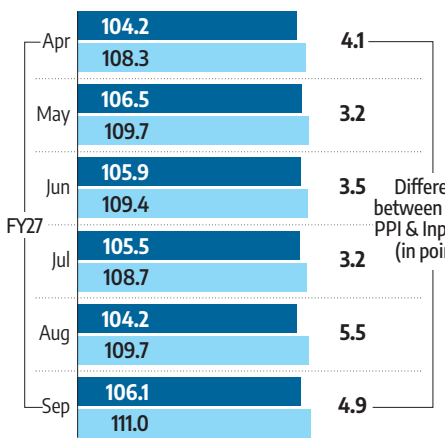


Manufacturers' output prices higher than input prices

Manufacturing sector
Input PPI* (in points)
Output PPI (in points)

*Input PPI is being calculated by the government on a trial basis

Note: Base year 2022-23. PPI: Producer price index
Source: Commerce & industry ministry, *Business Standard* calculations



QUICK READ

IAF chief takes final sortie, flies iconic Kiran aircraft

PHOTO: INDIAN AIR FORCE

Chief of Air Staff Air Chief Marshal A P Singh (*below*) flew the HJT-16 Kiran for his last sortie in uniform, at the Air Force Academy in Telangana's Dundigal

Chief of the Air Staff (CAS) Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh flew his last service sortie in an HJT-16 Kiran Mk-1 fighter trainer jet on Tuesday. He is set to retire on October 31 after serving in the Indian Air Force for four decades. Singh's first flying instructor, Wing Commander V S Kochhar (retired), flew with him. Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit will succeed Singh as the next CAS. Singh was given a water cannon salute as a mark of respect, concluding the sortie. OUR BUREAU

No rush to raise capital, have buffers: Yes Bank

Even if Yes Bank's common equity tier 1 (CET1) ratio falls to 11.4 per cent on a pro forma basis once its ₹8,415 crore of written-down additional tier 1 bonds are reinstated, the bank does not have to raise capital immediately as it has other options, Chief Financial Officer Niranjan Banodkar said on Monday. He called a CET1 ratio of 11-11.5 per cent "not ideal" and said the bank would want more comfortable capital levels irrespective of what the regulator says. But, he said, the bank has buffers and the benefit of deferred tax assets, and that whether to raise capital now or later is a commercial evaluation. Yes Bank's CET1 ratio was 13.7 per cent in September against 14 per cent in June. The overall capital adequacy ratio was 14.5 per cent in September against 15.1 per cent in June. OUR BUREAU

India-NZ trade pact comes into effect

The India-New Zealand free-trade agreement (FTA), signed on April 27, came into effect on Tuesday, providing duty-free access to a range of Indian goods, including products from labour-intensive sectors such as textiles and leather. It is the seventh trade pact to come into force in the last five years. The others are pacts with the UAE, Mauritius, the European Free Trade Association (EFTA) bloc, the UK, Oman and Australia. Signed on April 27, 2026, the agreement follows talks launched in 2010, stalled in 2015 and revived in March 2025. The pact becomes India's 17th operational FTA. New Zealand Prime Minister Christopher Luxon said that from Tuesday, Kiwi businesses can reach over a billion more customers with significantly reduced tariffs. PTI

IndusInd General Insurance names Sharad Mathur MD & CEO

IndusInd General Insurance Company Ltd (formerly Reliance General Insurance), part of IndusInd International Holdings Ltd (IIHL) Group, on Tuesday announced the appointment of Sharad Mathur as its managing director & chief executive officer (MD & CEO), following statutory approvals. Prior to joining IndusInd General Insurance, he served as MD & CEO of Universal Sompo General Insurance for over six years, leading its transformation and strengthening its distribution, risk management, and tech-led customer servicing capabilities. PTI

Polysilicon support scheme gets FinMin's in-principle nod

MNRE to seek Cabinet approval to launch the plan soon

SUDHEER PAL SINGH
New Delhi, 20 October

Plugging the gap

- Polysilicon is the last missing link in India's solar manufacturing chain
- India targets 30 gigawatt of domestic polysilicon capacity by 2030, requiring an investment of around ₹25,000 crore
- China accounts for over 93% of global production
- Solar glass support also being explored to boost domestic manufacturing

The Ministry of Finance has given in-principle approval to a proposal by the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) to launch a special scheme to support domestic polysilicon manufacturing. A highly purified form of silicon, polysilicon is the primary raw material for more than 95 per cent of solar panels globally. Following the approval, MNRE plans to seek the Cabinet's nod to launch the scheme soon.

"We have been working on a support scheme for polysilicon. The finance ministry has, in principle, given a go-ahead on that. We will now have to move the proposal to the Cabinet. That will hopefully happen in a month. It is already under deliberation," J V N Subramanyam, joint secretary at MNRE, told *Business Standard* in an exclusive interaction.

Polysilicon is the only segment of the domestic solar value chain that is not currently covered by a support mechanism. The government has already introduced measures to support domestic manufacturing across the rest of the value chain, including ingots and wafers, solar cells and modules, through initiatives such as the production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme and the approved list of models and manufacturers (ALMM).

Subramanyam said the new scheme could differ from existing interventions such as PLI and ALMM but did not share details, as the proposal is still being considered for Cabinet approval.

The government is targeting 30,000 megawatt of domestic polysilicon manufacturing capacity by 2030, which will require an investment of around ₹25,000 crore, MNRE Secretary Santosh K Sarangi recently said. The ministry has not introduced ALMM requirements for polysilicon because, while the ingot-to-module value chain is dominated by solar manufacturers globally, the same players may not enter polysilicon manufacturing, which is a different ball game, Sarangi told *Business Standard* in April.

Subramanyam said domestic renewable energy equipment manufacturing had become a success story, with the ministry providing policy certainty and creating a market, first through PLI a few years ago and then by introducing quality standards under ALMM.

"With these interventions, the country's total solar module manufacturing capacity stands at 225 gigawatt (Gw) and cell manufacturing capacity at 37 Gw. We expect cell manufacturing capacity to rise to 50 Gw by March 2027. We already have applications for around 60 Gw," Subramanyam said. He said that, apart from launching separate schemes for ingots and wafers and polysilicon, the government also plans to explore ways to promote domestic manufacturing of components such as solar glass. The broader objective is to build the entire solar value chain in India.

Globally, the polysilicon industry is highly concentrated, with Chinese firms accounting for more than 93 per cent of production. Polysilicon is a key feedstock not only for solar photovoltaic cells but also for the semiconductor industry.

ALMM List-I for solar modules is already in force, while ALMM List-II for solar photovoltaic cells came into effect in June this year. In March, the ministry introduced ALMM List-III to promote domestic manufacturing of ingots and wafers. Under this provision, solar projects will be required to source these components locally from June 2028.

Newsprint manufacturers' body seeks PM intervention to resolve coal

SUDHEER PAL SINGH
New Delhi, 20 October

The Delhi-based Indian Newsprint Manufacturers Association (INMA) has sought Prime Minister Narendra Modi's urgent intervention to resolve coal supply-related issues faced by its member companies, which supply newsprint to media houses, including *The Times of India*, *Hindustan Times*, *The Hindu*, *Navbharat Times* and *Punjab Kesari*, among others.

"We wish to bring to your attention the difficulties being faced by our members in securing timely coal supplies under their respective Fuel Supply Agreements (FSAs) executed with various subsidiaries of Coal India Limited (CIL)," the association said in a letter to the Prime Minister.

The subsidiaries named in the letter include Northern Coalfields, Central Coalfields, South Eastern Coalfields and Western Coalfields. The FSAs provide for coal supplies through both rail and road modes, with INMA members committing to premium terms to ensure a reliable and uninterrupted supply of the critical raw material.

"Despite these long-term contractual arrangements, our members continue to face significant operational challenges due to irregular coal dispatches and inadequate supplies," the association said, seeking Modi's intervention to resolve issues regarding the immediate and timely dispatch of coal rakes against existing FSAs. INMA said that despite having valid long-term FSAs in place and paying the applicable premium for assured coal supplies, its member companies were not receiving their allocated coal rakes in accordance with schedules.

More on business-standard.com

More women working in India, but not in paid jobs: Oxfam

HIMANSHI BHARDWAJ
New Delhi, 20 October

A sharp rise in the number of rural Indian women at work largely reflects economic distress rather than new opportunities, according to a new study by Oxfam. Women are taking up self-employment and agricultural work to cope with household economic stress, rather than gaining access to better jobs, it argues.

Rural women's labour force participation rate nearly doubled from 24.6 per cent in 2017-18 to 47.6 per cent in 2023-24, one of the sharpest increases anywhere in the world, the study said.

However, the rise does not reflect a corresponding increase in women being hired. Instead, more women are being counted as "self-employed", a category that includes everything from running a shop to working unpaid on a family farm.

According to the latest monthly bulletin of the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS), released by the Ministry of Statistics on October 15, unemployment among rural women fell to 3.9 per cent, its lowest level this year.

The bulletin showed that rural women's labour force participation rate stood at 38.9 per cent, the second highest since March 2026. The rate for urban women rose to 25.9 per cent, its highest in nearly a year. However, urban women faced greater difficulty finding work, with their unemployment rate at 9.2 per cent, more than double the rural rate.

MISSING IN THE workforce

The Oxfam analysis found that the share of rural women workers classified as self-employed rose from 57 per cent in 2017-18 to 72.2 per cent in 2023-24. Of these, 59 per cent were unpaid helpers in family enterprises.

Over the same period, the share of employed women in regular salaried jobs fell from 11 per cent to 8 per cent, while that in casual labour declined from 32 per cent to 20 per cent.

"In other words, as women have moved into work, they have moved out of the categories that typically come with a wage, a contract, or any security, and into unpaid or precarious own-account roles," the analysis noted.

Much of this shift has been towards agriculture, the study said. The rise in female labour force participation, led by rural women, largely reflects economic distress, unpaid work and informal employment, with women returning to agriculture rather than moving into other sectors.

The share of women reporting domestic duties as their primary activity fell sharply, while the proportion working as unpaid helpers in household enterprises or as own-account workers rose. This points to a shift from unpaid domestic work to unpaid or poorly paid self-employment, rather than towards secure incomes, the study said.

The burden is particularly heavy on disadvantaged women. Uttar Pradesh accounts for about 17 per cent of India's self-employed women, 91 per cent of whom work in agriculture. Most do not own land in their names, limiting their access to credit and markets.

The study also flagged policy changes as a concern. Women accounted for 54 per cent of person-days under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), which has been replaced by the VB-GRAM-G Act.

"Unlike the old demand-driven guarantee, the new scheme rations work to specific seasons, shifts 40 per cent of the wage bill onto states — many of them fiscally stressed — and requires twice-daily geo-tagged photo uploads through a mobile app, a barrier for women with limited digital access and skill," the study said.

The analysis argued that, while the increase in rural women's participation in the workforce is real, describing it as employment risks obscuring the nature of the work. Millions of women have entered the workforce, but many have found agricultural work instead of paid jobs and unpaid family roles instead of wages. The poorest among them often work on land to which they have no legal claim.

Insufficient returns

What the Oxfam study found

47.6%: Rural women's labour force participation nearly doubled from 24.6% since 2017-18

72.2%: Share of self-employed rural women rose from 57%; most are unpaid family workers

59%: Self-employed rural women work as unpaid helpers in family enterprises

8%: Fall in regular salaried jobs from 11%

20%: Drop in casual work dropped from 32%

91%: Self-employed women in Uttar Pradesh work in agriculture, often without land titles

54%: Women accounted for over half of MGNREGA person-days before the shift to VB-GRAM-G

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NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system.

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
02260001	12V, 7AH CAPACITY SEALED MAINTENANCE FREE BATTERY	5797 NOS	02.11.2026
19261230	BRAKE SHOE COMPLETE (STANDARD SIZE)	27762 NOS	16.11.2026

NOTE-

1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for details.
2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice NO. 51/2026-2027 Dated: 19.10.2026 **3649/2026**

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Indian Overseas Bank

Investor Relations Cell

Central Office: 763, Anna Salai, Chennai-600 002
Ph: 044-7172 9791, 2888 9360

NOTICE

RFP Ref. No: IOB/IRC/01/2026-27 dated 19.10.2026

Indian Overseas Bank has floated a Request for Proposal (RFP) vide RFP Ref. No: IOB/IRC/01/2026-27 dated 19.10.2026 inviting bids from interested Merchant Bankers for selection of Merchant Bankers/BRLMs for raising equity capital through Qualified Institutions Placement (QIP)/ Follow on Public Offer (FPO)/other permitted modes. The above RFP document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & https://iobtenders.auctiontiger.net/EPROC/.

For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following websites www.iob.bank.in & https://iobtenders.auctiontiger.net/EPROC/

The last date and time for receipt of Bid Documents is 18.11.2026 up to 03:00 P.M.

Place: Chennai
Date: 19.10.2026

Deputy General Manager

NSE

NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED

Registered Office: Exchange Plaza, C-1, Block G, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051, Maharashtra, India

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public Notice for Compulsory Delisting of Equity Shares of Companies in terms of Regulation 32 (3) of SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2021

In terms of Regulation 32(3) of SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2021('Delisting Regulations') and as per rules made under Section 21A of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Act, 1956 and the Rules, Bye-Laws, and Regulations of National Stock Exchange of India Limited ("the Exchange"), **NOTICE** is hereby given that the Exchange proposes to delist undermentioned Companies as the said Companies have met the criteria for delisting of its securities, i.e., the trading in the securities of the said Company has been under suspension for more than six months on account of non-compliance with various provisions of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and various circulars issued by SEBI/Exchange in this regard.

The Exchange has issued Show Cause Notice to the Companies at the last known address and registered email address as per the Exchange records, asking the said Companies to **SHOW CAUSE** as to why the Equity Shares of the Companies should not be compulsorily delisted from the Exchange. Show Cause Notice was issued to Shree Ram Proteins Limited vide email dated August 31, 2026, on the email ids available with the Exchange and couriered at its registered address on September 03, 2026, which was returned undelivered. Show Cause Notice was issued to Debock Industries Limited vide email dated September 16, 2026, on the email ids available with the Exchange and couriered at its registered address on September 17, 2026, which was delivered on September 19, 2026. The name of the Companies along with the last known address as per the Exchange records are given below:

Sr. No.	Company	*Registered Address of the Company
1.	Shree Ram Proteins Limited	Imperial Heights Tower- B, Second Floor, Office No. B-206, 150 Ft Ring Road, Opp Big Bazar, Rajkot - 360005 Gujarat.
1.	Debock Industries Limited	51, Lohiya Colony, 200Ft Bye Pass, Vaishali Nagar, Jaipur- 302021, Rajasthan

Address available as per the records of the Exchange.

Note:
The consequences of compulsory delisting include the following:

- The above Companies shall cease to be listed on the Stock Exchange. This Companies shall be moved to the dissemination board of the Stock Exchange.
- In terms of Regulation 34 of Delisting Regulations,
  1. The Delisted Company, its whole-time directors, person(s) responsible for ensuring compliance with the securities laws, its promoters, and the Companies which are promoted by any of them shall not directly or indirectly access the securities market or seek listing of any Equity Shares or act as an intermediary in the securities market for a period of ten years from the date of such delisting.
  2. In case of a Company whose fair value is positive -
     a. such a Company and the depositories shall not effect transfer, by way of sale, pledge, etc., of any of the Equity Shares held by the promoters / promoter group and the corporate benefits like dividend, rights, bonus shares, split, etc. shall be frozen for all the Equity Shares held by the promoters/ promoter group, till the promoters of such Company provide an exit option to the public shareholders in compliance with sub-regulation (4) of regulation 33 of these regulations, as certified by the relevant recognized Stock Exchange;
     b. the promoters, whole-time directors, and person(s) responsible for ensuring compliance with the securities laws, of the compulsorily delisted Company shall also not be eligible to become directors of any listed Company till the exit option as mentioned in clause (a) is provided.
- In terms of Regulation 33 of Delisting Regulations,
  1. Where the Equity Shares of Companies are delisted by a recognised Stock Exchange, the recognised Stock Exchange shall appoint an independent valuer(s) who shall determine the fair value of the delisted Equity Shares.
  2. The recognised Stock Exchange shall form a Panel of expert valuers and from the said Panel, the valuer(s) for the purposes of sub-regulation (1) shall be appointed.
  3. The value of the delisted Equity Shares shall be determined by the valuer(s) having regard to the factors mentioned in sub-regulation (2) of regulation 20 of SEBI (Delisting of Equity Shares) Regulations, 2021.
  4. The promoter(s) of the Companies shall acquire the delisted Equity Shares from the public shareholders by paying them the value determined by the valuer, within three months of the date of delisting from the recognised Stock Exchange, subject to the option of the public Shareholders to retain their shares.
  5. The promoter shall be liable to pay interest at the rate of ten percent per annum to all the shareholders, who offer their shares under the compulsory delisting offer, if the price payable in terms of sub-regulation (3) of regulation 33 is not paid to all the Shareholders within the time specified under sub-regulation (4) of regulation 33.

Any person who may be aggrieved by the proposed delisting may make representation, if any, to the Delisting Committee of the Exchange in writing **within 15 working days of this notice i.e. on or before November 12, 2026.**

The representation(s) with complete contact details (email Id, address and phone number) of the person(s) making a representation(s) should be addressed to:

The Delisting Committee, Listing Department, National Stock Exchange of India Limited 'Exchange Plaza-, C -1, Block-G, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai 400 051 **and** 9th Floor Inspire, BKC Main Road, G Block BKC, Patthar Nagar, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai, Maharashtra 400051. Contact no: +91 22 26598100 (32014), E-mail: vgandhi@nse.co.in, delisting@nse.co.in with cc to dl-insp-enf-delisting@nse.co.in. The representation/s should be mandatorily emailed to above specified email address. Any anonymous representation/s would not be considered valid.

The Companies are directed to contact the Exchange on the above-mentioned telephone nos. and email address in case of any discrepancy in the details of the Promoter(s)/Director(s).

Place: Mumbai **For National Stock Exchange of India Limited**

Date: October 21, 2026

Nifty50

*Q2 FY 2026-27 vs Q2 FY 2025-26

LOAN DISBURSEMENTS*	LOAN BOOK*	REVENUE FROM OPERATIONS*	NET WORTH*	NET NPAs*
₹10,579 crore	₹97,411 crore	₹2,345 crore	₹14,337 crore	1.08%
Up by 31%	Up by 15%	Up by 14%	Up by 11%	Improved by 45%

Extract of Audited Financial Results for the Quarter and Half Year Ended September 30, 2026

(₹ in crores)

Sr. No.	Particulars	Standalone						Consolidated					
		Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended	Quarter ended			Half Year ended		Year ended
		30-Sep-26	30-Jun-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26	30-Sep-26	30-Jun-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26
		(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations	2,344.75	2,249.54	2,057.45	4,594.29	4,016.98	8,337.48	2,346.88	2,250.60	2,057.85	4,597.48	4,017.69	8,338.89
2.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	706.57	412.72	696.07	1,119.28	1,000.70	2,336.92	704.45	413.75	696.39	1,118.20	1,001.23	2,337.58
3.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	706.57	412.72	696.07	1,119.28	1,000.70	2,336.92	704.45	413.75	696.39	1,118.20	1,001.23	2,337.58
4.	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	554.26	337.50	549.00	891.75	795.68	1,873.34	552.14	338.53	549.33	890.67	796.21	1,874.00
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after Tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after Tax)]	427.65	277.65	614.00	705.30	879.38	1,993.46	425.99	278.30	614.76	704.29	880.97	1,997.15
6.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face Value of ₹10/- each)	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23	2,809.23
7.	Other Equity	11,528.17	11,323.27	10,110.95	11,528.17	10,110.95	10,972.12	11,531.21	11,327.96	10,112.92	11,531.21	10,112.92	10,976.19
8.	Securities Premium Account (net)	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56	2,737.56						
9.	Net Worth	14,337.40	14,132.50	12,920.18	14,337.40	12,920.18	13,781.35						
10.	Paid-up Debt Capital/Outstanding Debt	80,882.38	79,002.01	69,939.39	80,882.38	69,939.39	77,845.63						
11.	Debt Equity Ratio	5.64	5.59	5.41	5.64	5.41	5.65						
12.	Earnings Per Share (of ₹10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)												
	A. Basic:	1.97	1.20	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73	1.97	1.21	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73
	B. Diluted:	1.97	1.20	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73	1.97	1.21	1.97	3.17	2.88	6.73
13.	Debenture Redemption Reserve	-	-	439.01	-	439.01	-	-	-	439.01	-	439.01	-

Notes:

a) The above results have been recommended by the Audit Committee of Directors and approved by the Board of Directors in their respective meetings held on 19.10.2026 and have been audited by the Joint Statutory Auditors of the Company.

b) The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly & half yearly financial results filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 & 52 of the SEBI LODR Regulations. The full format of the said financial results are available on the website of the Company, www.ireda.in/financial-results, and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com.

c) For the other line items referred in Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI LODR Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchanges and can be accessed at www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com, respectively.

For and on Behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Dr. Bijay Kumar Mohanty
Chairman & Managing Director (Addl. Charge); Director (Finance)
DIN No.: 08816532

Date: 19.10.2026
Place: New Delhi

INDIAN RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
Registered Office: 1st Floor, Core-4A, East Court, India Habitat Centre, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003, **Tel.:** 011-24682206-19, **Fax:** 011-24682202
Corporate Office: 3rd Floor, August Kranti Bhawan, Bhikaiji Cama Place, New Delhi-110066, **Tel.:** 011-26717400-12, **Fax:** 011-26717416
Business Centre: NBCC Office Complex, Office Block No. II, Plate B, 7th Floor, East Kidwai Nagar, New Delhi-110023, **Tel.:** 011-24347729-99
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Rising overnight rates make case for liquidity demand

ANJALI KUMARI
Mumbai, 20 October

The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) overnight variable rate repo (VRR) auction on Wednesday is likely to see strong demand as declining surplus liquidity pushes up overnight rates.

The weighted average call rate (WACR) rose to 5.66 per cent on Monday, nearing the marginal standing facility (MSF) rate, as festival-related currency leakage drained liquidity.

The net liquidity surplus stood at ₹1.85 trillion on Sunday, the latest data showed. The MSF rate of 5.75 per cent, 25 basis points (bps) above the policy repo rate, is known as the penal rate. The policy repo rate stands at 5.5 per cent following the hike earlier this month.

The RBI conducted a ₹1 trillion VRR auction on Monday, the first in three months. Banks bid for ₹1.51 trillion, and the central bank accepted ₹1 trillion at a weighted average rate of 5.52 per cent, well below the call rate and just above the repo rate. It will offer ₹50,000 crore at Wednesday's auction.

"Currency leakage during the festival season often leads to a fall in liquidity. This is a temporary shortage, and the RBI will continue with VRR auctions," said a dealer at a state-owned bank.

The turnaround in liquidity has been sharp. The RBI had been in absorption mode since August 6, following its last VRR auction on July 29, as surplus liquidity increased on strong mobilisation of Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank), or FCNR(B), deposits under the RBI's concessional swap facility.

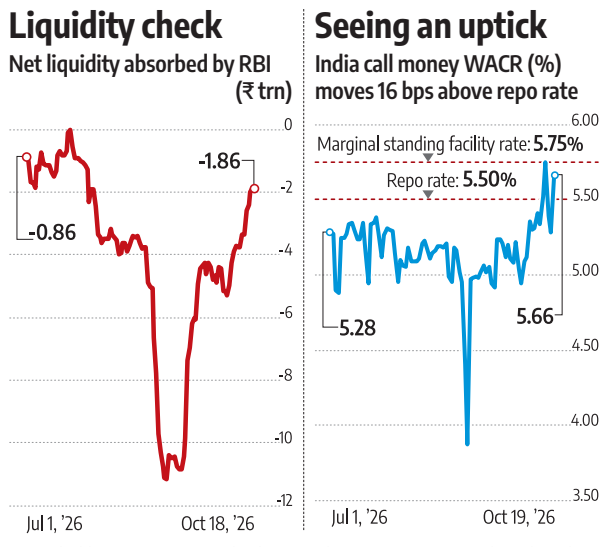
The daily cash reserve maintenance requirement, which has been tightened from October 16, has also reduced surplus liquidity.

Average daily net absorption under the liquidity adjustment facility rose from ₹1.2 trillion in July to ₹5.8 trillion in August. As recently as October 12, the central bank absorbed a net ₹3.36 trillion, while the call rate stood at 5.41 per cent. By October 16, the surplus had fallen below ₹2 trillion, or about 0.7 per cent of deposits.

Traders said the latest liquidity infusion would help banks manage monthly tax outflows.

"Amid the cash reserve ratio restrictions and a rise in overnight rates, VRR auctions are much more feasible for banks right now. That's the reason demand is expected to be there," said a dealer at a private bank.

With the WACR 16 bps above the repo rate and 9 bps below the MSF rate of 5.75 per cent, the upper end of the RBI's liquidity corridor, banks are likely to turn to the central bank for funds rather than use the penal facility, dealers said.



Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau Sources: Bloomberg/RBI

'Open to acquisition to build capabilities'

Q&A Piramal Finance is banking on urban and semi-urban markets to drive lending growth in the second half of FY27, while taking a measured approach to wholesale lending amid intensifying competition from banks. In a telephonic interview with **Aathira Varier** and **Subrata Panda**, **Jairam Sridharan**, managing director and chief executive officer, discusses the growth outlook, funding strategy and plans to build new businesses. Edited excerpts:

Retail disbursements were up 38 per cent in the second quarter (Q2). What is the outlook for the second half?

■ The festival season last year was exceptionally strong, probably the strongest in at least a decade. Developments around goods and services tax also provided a significant boost. We do not have the same factors this year. Therefore, I expect the festival season to be somewhat muted. There will still be a seasonal increase, but I do not expect the same level of boost we saw last year. Overall, however, the disbursement trajectory remains strong.

Will the urban segment drive growth in the second half (H2)?

■ Urban and semi-urban markets are probably where more growth is taking place. The monsoon has not been as good. We cannot necessarily expect rural areas to deliver significant growth at this stage, and it would be unhealthy to expect that. So, urban and semi-urban markets are likely to drive growth at present.

You were looking to get into microfinance. Is there some inorganic opportunity on the table currently?

■ We are open to inorganic opportunities in some of these businesses, but we do not necessarily need them. Our organic growth is strong at over 25 per cent. We, therefore, do not need acquisitions simply to drive growth. However, from a capability-building standpoint, we are happy to consider inorganic opportunities. We evaluate many such deals when they come to the market, but nothing has clicked so far.

Are there any other products or segments you are looking to add to your portfolio?

■ We will continue to build our gold loan and rural businesses, which still have a long way to go. We are also evaluating other businesses, particularly education loans and tractor finance. We are thinking about it and making early investments. Building a business is a two- to three-year process. It takes time and commitment.

Banks are flush with funds. Do you see any benefit in your cost of funds or an increase in lending from banks?

■ We borrowed almost exclusively from banks during the quarter. We did not tap the capital markets or international borrowing markets; we went to banks because liquidity was available. Our incremental cost of borrowing is around 8.40 per cent, as against a cost of around 8.80 per cent for our existing borrowings. Essentially, we are able to borrow at 40 basis points (bps) lower than our existing cost, with almost all of this borrowing coming from banks.

How long do you expect this to continue, given that interest rates have increased by 25 bps?

■ The rate environment has started changing, and the increase will gradually feed into lending rates. We have not seen that impact yet, but it will come over time. Our major advantage is that we received a credit-rating upgrade about six months ago. As a result, our incremental borrowing costs are 40-45 bps lower than the borrowing we are closing. We are constantly repaying old debt and raising new debt. The debt we are repaying is significantly more expensive than our current borrowing because of the rating upgrade. The gap is substantial — almost 70 bps between the rate at which we are repaying and the one at which we are borrowing today. Therefore, even if market interest rates rise, we should continue to benefit from lower borrowing costs because we are replacing higher-cost debt.

Are you planning to tap the domestic debt-capital market or international capital markets in H2?

■ We want to tap the domestic debt-capital market. However, we have not been able to do much over the past six to seven months because the pricing has been unfavourable. We recently completed a small domestic-debt issuance and hope to raise more funds in Q3. However, this market has not been conducive to borrowing in the past six months. Banks and development financial institutions will remain our key funding sources for now.

What will be the impact of the insurance regulator's proposed distribution overhaul on Piramal Finance?

■ Like every other market participant, we are giving our views directly to the regulator in the discussion paper. From an impact standpoint, this is a fairly material issue. On a gross basis, the impact on us would be 18-24 bps of return on equity. However, we have a structural advantage compared with most other non-banking financial companies (NBFCs): We own 50 per cent in life-insurance company Pramerica Life. The insurance we distribute is underwritten by our subsidiary. This means that if we lose some distribution fees, the economics of the underlying insurance company improves. Since we own 50 per cent in that company, part of the value shifts comes back to us through the consolidation of results. Effectively, we have a natural hedge because we are both a distributor and a part-owner of the insurance manufacturer. If value shifts from the distributor to the manufacturer, approximately 50 per cent of that value shift comes back to us through consolidation.

What is your strategy for the wholesale lending business?

■ We want wholesale lending to account for around 15 per cent of our overall portfolio. This time, it has fallen slightly below that level and accounts for 13-14 per cent. We want to focus on real estate and mid-market corporate clients. Both segments are doing well and growing. Real estate has performed well from an asset-quality perspective. This is not the best time to grow these segments fast because we want to build our businesses. Banks are also growing in this segment strongly. Last quarter banks grew corporate credit quite fast, which makes competition more significant for NBFCs. We will, therefore, take a measured approach. You cannot grow every segment at all times; you have to operate where the market offers opportunities. Banks are very focused on this segment, so we will play second fiddle for a while. Our opportunity will come at some point.

FROM PAGE 1

$800 mn entity shifts 2 funds out of GIFT on tax uncertainty

Sawrikar clarified that the move is not an exit from GIFT City. The FME's other funds will continue to be managed from GIFT City, providing risk management and technology support for entities in ADGM, Mauritius, and Singapore.

He also flagged withholding tax on payments to overseas service providers such as law firms and research vendors, even though the money comes from foreign investors and is invested abroad.

Along with the concerns around taxation, the fund house noted that the minimum ticket size for these funds is $150,000, a steep amount considering the Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS) limit of $250,000 per financial year for Indian investors.

In comparison, a minimum ticket size of $55,000 in ADGM will allow the fund to widen its investor base, the FME noted.

Sawrikar added that one of the FME's funds has faced distribution constraints. Non-resident investors are required to share their PAN details, while the fund cannot accept money from resident Indians because, if resident and non-resident investors are mixed, the fund loses its specified fund status and is taxed at the fund level. As a result, the fund has not been able to attract any investors in the last 15 months.

The firm applied for its Singapore licence in June and expects its ADGM licence shortly. A venture capital fund planned earlier for GIFT City will be domiciled in Mauritius instead, Sawrikar added.

"The difficulty lies less in the benefits than in the conditions attached to them. A fund managed from GIFT City has to keep meeting prescribed tests on its investor base, concentration of holdings, resident participation, and corpus to stay within the safe harbour, and a new unit cannot be carved out of an existing Indian business," said Raheel Patel, partner, Gandhi Law Associates.

Patel added that these tests have to be monitored on a continuing basis, and a breach can carry real tax consequences.

"Abu Dhabi offers a comparatively simpler framework, and for a fund house weighing incentive against certainty, that simplicity can tip the balance," Patel added.

As of June 2026, there were around 235 FMEs registered in the GIFT City with over 400 schemes. Cumulative commitments from non-retail fund management stood at around $45 billion.

HDFC to ramp up beyond

home shores

Other banks had a larger network of overseas branches that they could deploy to mobilise deposits, giving them an advantage, he said.

HDFC Bank mobilised $11.5 billion in FCNR(B) deposits under the concessional swap window, compared with $17.88 billion raised by ICICI Bank, the country's second-largest private sector lender. HSBC was another major mobiliser, raising $14.5 billion, while Axis Bank garnered $10.62 billion. State Bank of India (SBI), the country's largest lender, has reportedly mobilised nearly $11 billion through the FCNR(B) deposits facility, which closed on August 31.

"I think we probably did whatever we could with the kind of resources that we had. Yes, as we move forward, I am sure it's one strategy that the bank will have in terms of expanding its footprint in the overseas jurisdictions at some point in time," Jagdishan added.

Jagdishan will step down on October 26, with Bagchi taking over as MD & CEO on October 27. In his first public remarks since being named to the post, Bagchi said he would engage with regulators, customers and other stakeholders to gather insights that would inform his approach to leading the bank. "At this point, I am just understanding the mechanics of the balance sheet and P&L (profit and loss), which from outside you can only understand that much," Bagchi said.

Bagchi also sought to reassure investors about the strength of HDFC Bank's management team and institutional processes, stressing that the lender's operations did not depend on a handful of individuals. "It is a very process-driven institution and not dependent on just one or two or three individuals," he said.

According to HDFC Bank's FY26 annual report, its international operations comprise branches in Hong Kong, Bahrain and Singapore, as well as at the Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC). The bank also operates an International Financial Services Centre (IFSC) banking unit in Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City).

Its representative offices are located in Nairobi, Kenya; Abu Dhabi and Dubai in the UAE; and London.

Overseas branches can undertake permitted banking activities, including deposit-taking and lending, subject to local regulatory requirements. Representative offices, by contrast, are generally restricted to liaison, information-gathering and relationship-building activities and cannot independently conduct banking business.

In September 2025, HDFC Bank was barred by the local regulator from onboarding new customers at its DIFC branch.

According to disclosures, the bank mobilised $11.5 billion in foreign currency deposits under the RBI's concessional swap window. Its overseas branches extended loan facilities aggregating $5.7 billion against these deposits, while standby letters of credit issued to other banks in respect of loans backed by the deposits amounted to $3.1 billion. Separately, HDFC Bank raised $2.5 billion through US dollar-denominated bonds between June and August.

ICICI Bank has business centres in six overseas locations and representative offices in 12 locations outside India. Its international network spans Hong Kong, Singapore, the US, the UK, Canada, China, the DIFC and Bahrain.

SBI, meanwhile, has 245 overseas points of presence across 29 countries. Its overseas branches operate on both the assets and liabilities sides of the balance sheet, with specialised branches catering to retail banking, corporate banking, trade finance and investments.

Retail auto sales rise on high base this Navratri, but cars see 14% drop

GST 2.0 took effect on September 22, 2025, coinciding with the first day of Navratri, after many buyers had deferred purchases in anticipation of lower prices. The release of this pentup demand helped lift overall automobile retail sales by 34 per cent during the previous Navratri season.

Against that backdrop, the modest increase in sales during the first nine days of Navratri this year suggests that demand has remained relatively resilient, although passenger vehicles have lagged. Final registration numbers, however, are awaited.

Final registration data for the period up to October 20, including Dussehra, are expected to be updated after two days, as registrations from rural areas may take longer to appear on the Vahan portal. In broader comparison, it must be mentioned that the Navratri to Dussehra lasted 11 days last year, ending October 2, compared with 10 days this year.

"We expect (the 10-day Navratri-Dussehra) sales to be marginally down this year, as we had an exceptional year in 2025 because of the GST boost. Even after factoring that in, this year's numbers are almost matching last year, which is a continuation of the industry momentum that we have seen in 2026. During the first nine days, sales are up, except for passenger vehicles, and final numbers are awaited," said Sai Giridhar, president of Fada.

Data accessed by Business Standard from the government's Vahan portal shows that the final two days of last year's Navratri-Dussehra accounted for 189,387 vehicle registrations, a level that may have been difficult to match this year.

The 2024 season offers another point of reference. Overall automobile retail sales during Navratri that year stood at 863,327 units, including 161,443 passenger vehicles.

About the 2025 high base, an industry source said many buyers had postponed purchases after Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced plans for GST 2.0 in his Independence Day speech on August 15, 2025. The announcement led consumers to wait for the tax changes to take effect on September 22, creating pentup demand during the festival season.

Echoing the view, Giridhar said: "For more than a month, until September 22, people tried to postpone their purchases. This resulted in pentup demand during the festival season. Hence, comparing last year with this year is not a fair comparison."

Three-wheeler sales declined 1.65 per cent to 43,057 units during the nine days of this year's Navratri period. Other segments recorded growth: Construction equipment sales rose 11 per cent to 2,185 units, while tractor sales increased 9 per cent to 20,912 units.

"It is too early to comment on sales numbers. However, some states, such as Andhra Pradesh, are seeing strong growth compared with last year, particularly in two-wheelers. This suggests that rural India may be performing well," an industry expert said.

A new spark: Sivakasi sets sights on fireworks exports

If the export plans materialise, Indian manufacturers will soon be able to pitch Sivakasi as an alternative to China's Liuyang as a global export hub.

The Indian fireworks industry is worth around ₹6,000 crore, of which Sivakasi accounts for around ₹5,100 crore. Of Sivakasi's total sales, nearly 80 per cent, or more than ₹4,000 crore, comes from Diwali markets across the country.

Around 10 per cent of sales come from Vishu in Kerala, while another 10 per cent comes from other festivals, including Ganesh Chaturthi in Maharashtra.

The Tamil Nadu government is seeking to improve logistics and transport infrastructure to facilitate exports through the ports in Chennai and Thoothukudi.

"There are queries coming in. Some companies that used to purchase fireworks from China are now making enquiries in India for various reasons. If we can meet the standards and supply, it would be a great achievement for Sivakasi," said Murali Asaithambi of the Sivakasi Fireworks Manufacturers Association (SFMA).

At present, two-thirds of the world's fireworks originate from Liuyang in China's Hunan province. Industry experts say recent regulatory curbs, US tariffs and diversification strategies may be prompting global buyers to look at Sivakasi.

"We are working on three priorities: Strengthening worker safety, investing in research and modernisation, and removing longstanding barriers that prevent our manufacturers from reaching international markets," Keerthana said.

According to SFMA, India is the largest market where consumers themselves buy and burst firecrackers on a large scale.

In Europe and other regions, fireworks displays are conducted by professionals, with demand for sparklers and Roman candles particularly strong.

Some manufacturers believe production needs to increase to meet rising domestic demand as well as overseas orders.

"Our production is not keeping pace with demand. The quantity we produced over the past 11 months would only be enough to meet the demand for this Diwali. We have to get faster clearances too," said J Tamilselvan, president of the Indian Fireworks Association (IFA).

Demand has risen following a Supreme Court order in September that conditionally permitted the industry to manufacture next-generation green crackers, a demand that had been pending since 2018.

The apex court also rejected a blanket ban on firecrackers, permitting their use during specified time windows instead of imposing a total prohibition.

To improve Sivakasi's fireworks ecosystem, the Tamil Nadu Industrial Development Corporation (TIDCO) is developing a Sivakasi Pyrotechnic Common Facility Centre (SPCFC) in Virudhunagar district. The project is being conceived as India's largest fireworks manufacturing cluster, with integrated facilities for testing, certification, research, automation, skills training and technology commercialisation.

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Marco Rubio calls India a 'refining superpower'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai/New Delhi, 20 October

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar with US Secretary of State Marco Rubio (*left*) and United Arab Emirates Foreign Minister Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan during a trilateral meeting in Mumbai PHOTO: @USAMBINDIA/X VIA PTI

India and the United States (US) on Tuesday looked at expanding energy and defence cooperation amid continuing friction in their ties, with Secretary of State Marco Rubio emphasising that deeper energy trade can play a transformative role in diversifying New Delhi's supply chains.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar hosted Secretary Rubio for wide-ranging talks shortly after the top US diplomat landed in Mumbai on his second trip to the country in five months.

Rubio described India as a refining superpower, adding that the US delegation will discuss with Reliance about producing oil in Venezuela.

Asked what role India can play in meeting the world's energy demand, Rubio, who arrived in Mumbai this afternoon on a three-day India visit, said, "India is a refining superpower. They have the capability to refine heavy crude. They've done so in the past, and I think as more and more Venezuelan oil comes online, it's something they can do." "They also, by the way, have pre-existing oil concessions in Venezuela that can produce more themselves," Rubio told reporters in Mumbai. He said all these are positive things.

"I'm not claiming to you that Venezuela alone can fill the hole that could be caused by some of the things that are happening around the world, but I think over time, it most certainly can, and in the short term, it can certainly help. So, thats one of the things we'll talk about. With India, we've talked about it in the past, and they sound ready. They're willing to do it. There might be a few impediments that stand in the way in terms of sanctions and so forth that we'll have to work through," he said. Rubio said the US delegation "will discuss with Reliance about producing oil in Venezuela", claiming that "India made 'substantial progress' in diversifying oil purchases", which is a "smart thing to do".

Jaishankar said on social media that he and Rubio "shared views on further advancement of our ties, focusing on trade, energy, technology, defence, and people-to-people ties".

The US State Department said the secretary and the external affairs minister discussed regional and global issues, including developments in West Asia.

"The secretary reiterated that increased energy trade with the United States can play a transformative role in diversifying India's supply chains while meeting its sizable consumer demand," it said. "He also commended recent progress in bilateral defence and civil nuclear cooperation, and advocated for the increased purchase of US technologies and systems, which can enhance the security and prosperity of both our countries," the State Department added.

Before his talks with Jaishankar, Rubio visited the Taj memorial and laid a wreath in honour of the victims of the horrific 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks that included six American citizens.

"In Mumbai, Indian External Affairs Minister @DrSJaishankar and I discussed energy security and defense cooperation while reaffirming the importance of advancing the U.S.-India strategic partnership," Rubio said on X.

The top diplomat also answered questions from the media on the India-US energy ties as well as his trip to Reliance Industries Ltd's refinery in Jamnagar on Wednesday. "In order for energy to become usable, you have to refine it. You have a company with a massive amount of refining capability. I think I should go talk to them, especially when it involves nation-states," he said.

"We're going to go see a company that has a tremendous amount of refining capability. It makes all the sense in the world to talk to them about it. It's very difficult to understand something or see what the possibilities are if you're not going to speak to them," he noted.

The US Secretary of State also responded to a query on India's procurement of Russian crude oil.

"India has expressed repeatedly its desire to diversify its energy portfolio, which is a smart thing to do. It's not easy to do that from one day to the next," he said.

"I think they've made some substantial progress in that regard, and we're happy to see that. But in the end, it's not just about Russian oil; it's about India's desire to diversify, and we think we can be a source of some of its energy inputs. We have discussed Venezuela and other countries, and I think it's in our interest to have strong allies with diverse energy portfolios,' he noted.

It is not immediately known whether the proposed trade deal between India and the US figured in the Rubio-Jaishankar talks. There is an "extraordinary alignment" between India and the US on the core issues that matter even though there can be disagreements on some others, Rubio said. Rubio cited the need to have a "free and open" Indo-Pacific where no nation can claim dominance or ownership on international shipping as among the core issues of alignment.

Institutions, parties must unite for national interest: PM

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 20 October

PM Narendra Modi at the Vijaya Dashami celebrations at IP Extension, New Delhi PHOTO: PTI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday said all institutions and political parties of the country should unite for national interest and fight together against the enemies of the country.

Participating in *Dussehra* celebrations here, Modi also said that no matter how big or difficult a crisis may be, no one should sit back relying on others and recognise their own strength.

"May our thoughts be aligned, and may... all the institutions of the nation, all political parties, stand together for national interest. We must proceed with this very spirit and we must fight together against the enemies of the country," the PM said. Underlining that his government's goal is to make India self-reliant, the prime minister said, "We must have faith in our resources. We must turn our resolve into power and find solutions through our own hard work. Because Lord Shri Ram taught us that the difficulties cannot stop our journey." He said in 'Ram Rajya', there is no discrimination against anyone and everyone receives justice and equal opportunities. The purpose of power is not to rule, but to ensure public welfare —this is the ideal of Lord Ram.

He said Dussehra is the festival of victory of the good over evil and it gives people the courage to believe that no matter how powerful the enemy is, "when we stand with truth and humanity, victory will ultimately be ours'. The spirit of *Dussehra* has always been at the heart of India's philosophy, the PM said.

RSS an anti-constitutional cult: Rahul Gandhi

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday attacked the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), alleging that it is an all-male "anti-constitutional cult" that believes women are the property of men. The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha also said he believes in Shiva-Shakti and that's why it gives him such joy to fight the RSS. "The RSS is an all-male anti-constitutional cult that believes women are the property of men. I believe in Shiva-Shakti," Gandhi said on X.

"That's why it gives me such joy to fight them. What's beautiful is that many of their 'own' women are on my side," the former Congress chief said.

Gandhi's remarks came on the foundation day of the RSS.

RSS chief: Regime-change agitations don't resolve fundamental problems

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagpur, 20 October

Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat on Tuesday said that regime-change agitations do not resolve fundamental problems, warning that protests could become instruments of political interests and fuel divisions in society rather than delivering solutions.

Addressing the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh's annual Vijayadashami Utsav gathering in Nagpur, Bhagwat cited recent upheavals in Bangladesh, Nepal, France, and Albania, asserting that forces pursuing their own interests use regime change as a means to alter political circumstances, rarely achieving intended results.

"They claim that changing a regime will change the situation, but that has never really happened," he said.

Bhagwat claimed that a stronger India would constrain such forces, making the country a target of attempts to weaken and divide it.

While some global powers want India to develop, they do not want it to become too powerful, as it could challenge their dominance, he added.

Bhagwat performed shastra puja (weapon worship) at RSS' Vijayadashami Utsav in Nagpur.

On protests in a democracy, the RSS chief said their purpose should be to resolve problems rather than deepen social divisions.

"Problems will remain, and protests are inevitable in a democracy. But what should the purpose of protests be? They should be aimed at finding solutions," he said.

He cautioned that protests could become political instruments when driven by objectives other than public welfare, fuelling hostility towards individuals, groups or ideologies.

Bhagwat also urged political leaders, protesters and the administration to ensure that their actions did not create bitterness or divisions in society.

ALL IN A DAY

Ecosystem of terrorism must be firmly 'dismantled': Rajnath Singh

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Tuesday said that the entire "ecosystem of terrorism' must be firmly and collectively "dismantled", underlining that there can be "no place" for those who finance, support, or shelter terrorists.

Addressing the SCO Council of Heads of Government meeting in Dushanbe, Tajikistan, Singh also said that terrorism has become one of the "most serious threats" to peace and development and it not only causes harm to innocent lives but also disrupts investment and commerce.

He further said that "terrorism radicalises societies and deprives our youth of the opportunities they deserve." Pakistan's Deputy Prime Minister Ishaq Dar was also present when Singh was making these remarks at the gathering. PTI

Appoint retired judge to head inquiry commission for Kolkata stampede: HC

The Calcutta High Court on Tuesday directed that the West Bengal government set up a commission of inquiry headed by a retired judge of the court to inquire into the stampede at Chorbagan Durga puja pandal on October 17 that claimed 19 lives.

A division bench presided by Chief Justice Ravindra V Ghuge said that a sitting judge of the high court cannot be appointed to head an inquiry in accordance with a Supreme Court directive, as was prayed for by the state government.

The bench said a retired judge of the high court can be chosen by the West Bengal government to head the inquiry panel into the cause of the stampede and the people responsible for the incident. Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari had said that a sitting judge of the high court would head a special investigation team to be formed to probe the incident. PTI

Centre likely to review 2019 mineral policy

The Centre is set to review the National Mineral Policy, 2019, to align it with evolving sector demands, focusing on key priorities such as critical minerals, recycling, and deep-sea resources, according to sources.

The Mines Ministry has decided to constitute a panel to undertake a comprehensive review of the policy in the light of recent developments and emerging requirements, the sources said.

The nine-member committee will be chaired by the Additional Secretary in the Mines Ministry, they said.

The panel has been tasked with reviewing the National Mineral Policy, 2019, in view of developments in the mineral sector since its formulation, identifying provisions that need modification, and recommending a comprehensive revision of the policy.

It has been asked to submit its recommendations within two months of its constitution, sources said. The National Mineral Policy, 2019, was approved by the Union Cabinet chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. PTI

CBDT notifies form for tax exemption claims on Gsecs

MONIKA YADAV
New Delhi, 20 October

The Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) has prescribed a new form for furnishing information to claim income-tax exemption on interest income and capital gains from government securities, according to a government notification.

The CBDT notified the Income-tax (Seventh Amendment) Rules, 2026, on October 19. The rules introduce Form 173A, which must be furnished to claim tax exemption under entries 13D and 13E of Schedule IV of the Income-tax Act, 2025.

The exemptions cover interest income from government securities and capital gains arising from their sale, exchange or transfer. Entry 13D applies to foreign institutional investors (FIIs), while entry 13E covers the Bank for International Settlements (BIS). The exemptions are not available to ordinary investors.

The form requires taxpayers to furnish basic details, including their name, country of residence, address, Permanent Account Number (PAN), tax identification number in the country of residence, Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) registration number as a foreign portfolio investor (FPI) or foreign institutional investor (FII), tax year, email address and contact number.

THE CATEGORIES OF SECURITIES LISTED IN THE FORM INCLUDE TREASURY BILLS, FIXED-RATE BONDS, FLOATING-RATE BONDS AND STATE DEVELOPMENT LOANS

It also seeks transaction-level details of government securities, including their International Securities Identification Number (ISIN), type of security, tenor and value as of April 1. The categories of securities listed in the form include Treasury Bills, fixed-rate bonds, floating-rate bonds and State Development Loans (SDLs), along with other securities.

Taxpayers will also be required to report the value of securities purchased during the year, sale consideration of securities sold, total value of holdings as of March 31, gross interest received or accrued during the tax year and capital gains earned during the year.

The form includes a declaration certifying that the information furnished is true and consistent with the provisions of Schedule IV of the Income-tax Act, 2025. It is to be signed by the principal officer.

The notification specifies that the tax identification number and Sebi registration number details are optional for the Bank for International Settlements (BIS).

The Income-tax Rules, 2026, were originally notified on March 20, 2026, and have since been amended through subsequent notifications.

CJP leaders move Delhi HC against judicial custody

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka Tuesday approached the Delhi High Court seeking an urgent hearing against the extension of their judicial custody.

Das and Ranka sought a night hearing in the high court, which is shut this week due to *Dussehra* vacation.

A newly appointed Special Executive Magistrate at Mandir Marg police station on Monday ordered their judicial remand for two more days after they were produced before him.

They were taken into custody on October 13 after they allegedly climbed over a locked gate to enter Jantar Mantar , and were sent to five-day judicial custody. "We have moved the Delhi High Court and requested an urgent night hearing. Saurav and Ashutosh should not spend a single minute behind bars. Their liberty must not be curtailed because of political games. Justice must not wait," CJP legal affairs head Ratna Singh said. PTI

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(Scan this QR code to view the RHP)

CORE4 Engineering The Future...

CORE4 ENGINEERS LIMITED

CORPORATE IDENTIFICATION NUMBER: U45309KA2022PLC157463

Our Company was originally formed as a partnership firm with Registrar of Firms, registration number MYS-F87-2014-15 under the name and style "Core4 Engineers" in Mysore, Karnataka, under the Indian Partnership Act, 1932, pursuant to a partnership deed dated June 06, 2014, as amended from time to time and was registered with the Registrar of Firms, Mysore on July 11, 2014. Subsequently, the partnership firm was converted into a private limited "Core4 Engineers Private Limited" on February 03, 2022 pursuant to the provisions of Chapter XXI of the Companies Act, 2013 and a fresh Certificate of Incorporation dated February 03, 2022 was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. Thereafter, our company was converted from a private limited company to a public limited company, pursuant to a special resolution passed in the extraordinary general meeting of our shareholders held on February 27, 2025 and the name of our Company was changed to "Core4 Engineers Limited" with a fresh certificate of incorporation dated April 23, 2025, issued to our Company by the Assistant Registrar of Companies/Deputy Registrar of Companies / Registrar of Companies, Central Processing Centre. For further details on incorporation and registered office of our Company, see *"History and Certain Corporate Matters"* on page 265 of the Red Herring Prospectus ("**RHP**") dated October 16, 2026 filed with the ROC, Bangalore ("**RHP**").

Registered Office & Corporate Office: Mathrushree No.12, 1st Floor, Near Ramana Maharshi Gyana Kendra, Next to New court, K Block, Kuvempunagar, Mysore – 570 023, Karnataka, India.

Contact Person: Theja Raju, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Telephone: 0821 4507882 | **Email:** investor@core4grp.com | **Website:** https://core4engineers.com/

OUR PROMOTERS: AGRAHARA CHAMARAJE GOWDA ABHINANDAN, HOSAHALLI APPAGIGOWDA SAVITHA, MAHADEVAPPA TEJUS AND ANALA

THE ISSUE

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UPTO 58,94,400 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10/- EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] LAKHS ("THE ISSUE"). THE ISSUE WILL CONSTITUTE [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO 7,20,000 EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING TO ₹ [●] LAKHS (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE POST ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY) FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY MARKET MAKER ("MARKET MAKER RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE MARKET MAKER RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE WILL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% RESPECTIVELY, OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

CORRIGENDUM : NOTICE TO INVESTORS

This is with reference to the Pre-Issue Advertisement ("Advertisement") published on Monday, October 19, 2026 in All Editions of Business Standard (A Widely Circulated English National Daily Newspaper), All Editions of Business Standard (A Widely Circulated Hindi National Daily Newspaper), And All Editions of the Udayakala-Mandya-Mysore, (Kannada Being the Regional Language of Karnataka, where our Registered Office is Located).

The attention of investors is drawn to the following:

In the "Issue Structure" chapter on page 369 of the RHP, the reference to the phrase "Such number of Equity Shares in multiples of [●] Equity Shares such that the Bid Amount exceeds ₹ 2.00 lakhs" in the "Minimum Bid" section pertaining to the QIBs portion, and all corresponding references to such disclosure throughout the RHP, shall be read as follows:

"Such number of Equity Shares in multiples of [●] Equity Shares such that the Bid exceeds more than 2 lots"

The information above supersedes the information (as applicable) in the RHP. The RHP accordingly stands amended to the extent stated hereinabove and the above changes are to be read in conjunction with the RHP. Unless otherwise specified, all capitalised terms used herein shall have the same meaning ascribed to such terms in the RHP.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGER	REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
SOCRADAMUS CAPITAL PRIVATE LIMITED 2402 C&D, 24th Floor, A Wing, Marathon Futurex, Mafatlal Mills Compound, Lower Parel, Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** 022 - 4740 0238 **Email:** mb@socradamus.in **Investors Grievance e-mail:** investors@socradamus.in **Website:** https://socradamus.in/ **Contact Person:** Kritika Rupda **SEBI Registration Number:** INM000013138	**PURVA SHAREGISTRY (INDIA) PRIVATE LIMITED** 9, Shiv Shakti Industrial Estate, J.R.Boricha Marg Lower Parel (East), Mumbai - 400 011, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** 022 – 4961 4132 **Email:** newissue@purvashare.com **Investors Grievance e-mail:** newissue@purvashare.com **Website:** www.purvashare.com Contact Person: Deepali Gaonkar **SEBI Registration Number:** INR000001112	**CORE4 ENGINEERS LIMITED** **Theja Raju** Mathrushree No.12, 1st Floor, Near Ramana Maharshi Gyana Kendra, Next to New court, K Block, Kuvempunagar, Mysore – 570 023, Karnataka, India **Telephone:** 0821 4507882 **Email:** compliance@core4grp.com **Investor Grievance E-mail:** investor@core4grp.com **Website:** https://core4engineers.com/

Investors may contact our Company Secretary and Compliance Officer and / or the Registrar to the Issue and / or the Book Running Lead Manager, in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related problems, such as non-receipt of letters of allotment, credit of allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, etc.

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP dated October 16, 2026.

For CORE4 ENGINEERS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Agrahara Chamaraje Gowda Abhinandan
Managing Director

Place: Mysore
Date: October 19, 2026

Core4 Engineers Limited is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make initial public offering of its equity shares and has filed the RHP with the RoC. The RHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, the website of the BRLM at https://socradamus.in/, website of the BSE at www.bseindia.com and website of the Company at https://core4engineers.com/ Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see *"Risk Factors"* on page 31 of the RHP. Potential Bidders should not rely on the DRHP filed with BSE for making any investment decision instead investors shall rely on RHP filed with the RoC.

This announcement is not an issue of securities for sale in the United States or elsewhere. This announcement has been prepared for publication in India only and is not for publication or distribution, directly or indirectly, in or into the United States. The Equity Shares have not been, and will not be, registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (**"U.S. Securities Act"**) and may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are only being offered and sold outside the United States in "offshore transactions" as defined in and in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdictions where those offers and sales occur. There will be no offering of securities in the United States.

AdBaaz

QUICK READ

Alberta votes by large majority to remain part of Canada

PHOTO: REUTERS

With 75% of votes counted, 76% of Albertans voted to remain while 24% backed a binding separation vote

Alberta residents voted by a large majority to remain part of Canada in the province's first-ever referendum on separation, handing Prime Minister Mark Carney a much-needed win as he attempts to unify the country amid a trade war with the United States. At 1145 GMT on Tuesday, with three-quarters of the votes counted, 76 per cent of Albertans had backed the "remain" side versus 24 per cent in favour of a binding vote on separation. The referendum was nonbinding. "Albertans made a clear choice," Carney said . "They chose unity, to build together, and to take care of each other." "Canada is greater than the sum of its parts," he said. REUTERS

Christiane Amanpour says she is leaving CNN after 43 years

Christiane Amanpour (*pictured)*, one of the most recognised correspondents of the past four decades, will sign off from *CNN* next year as the news channel comes under new ownership by Skydance. Amanpour, 68, became famous through her on-the-ground reporting from major war zones and humanitarian crises, including the Gulf War and the Bosnian War in the 1990s. The Iranian-British journalist is the chief international anchor for *CNN* and host of *CNN International's* nightly interview programme, Amanpour. She also hosts a weekly program on *CNN* and a daily show on *PBS*. "After many months of thought and a few sleepless nights, I have decided to separate from *CNN*" she said. REUTERS

Former Google CEO owns 1% of Anthropic

Google Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Eric Schmidt owns about 1 per cent of Anthropic, positioning him for one of the largest individual windfalls when the artificial intelligence (AI) startup goes public. Schmidt invested tens of millions of dollars in Anthropic's Series A funding round. It was unclear whether he has sold any of his stake since. REUTERS

SoftBank's credit risk hits 4-year high

SoftBank's credit risk, as measured by its credit-default swaps (CDS), has risen to the highest level in nearly four years as concerns grow over artificial intelligence (AI)-related funding and a potential large acquisition. SoftBank's five-year CDS stood at 432 basis points on Tuesday, the highest since early November 2022. AGENCIES

Qualcomm to cut jobs worldwide in performance-focused layoffs

Qualcomm will cut jobs globally in a "performance-focused reduction" following its annual employee reviews, Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Cristiano Amon told staff in a memo on Monday reviewed by *Reuters*, with notifications set to begin in November. The cuts are part of an effort to build "a stronger performance culture" and address situations where the company "has consistently fallen short of expectations," Amon said. The memo did not say how many jobs would be affected, and *Reuters* could not immediately determine the scale of the cuts. Qualcomm did not immediately respond to a request for comment. It had about 52,000 employees as of September last year, most of them full-time. REUTERS

Nvidia gets $35 bn chip order from ByteDance, Alibaba, Tencent

REUTERS
20 October

ByteDance, Alibaba and Tencent have ordered more than 3 million of Nvidia's new RTX PRO 5500 graphics cards with a collective sticker price of over $35 billion, two people familiar with the matter said, in a rush for a less powerful but export-compliant chip amid United States (US) restrictions on trade with China.

America-based chipmaker Nvidia has told customers and partners it cannot guarantee that it can fill the orders because demand from Chinese technology companies far exceeds planned production, the two sources and a third person familiar with the matter said. They requested anonymity because they are not authorised to speak to the media.

The RTX PRO 5500 is a workstation chip, designed for powerful professional computers rather than the large data-centre clusters that use Nvidia's most advanced AI processors. But it is among the most powerful Nvidia chips that are still available to Chinese buyers.

Nvidia's Blackwell-based B300 data-centre chip is not allowed to be sold to Chinese buyers under US export controls, while exports of its Hopper-based H200 are reviewed on a case-by-case basis and are subject to licensing conditions.

One source said Nvidia told partners they might receive only 5 per cent to 10 per cent of the quantities requested. Another said the company had indicated it could produce no more than 3 million RTX PRO 5500 cards globally in 2027. Total orders from customers in China have exceeded 6 million, two of the sources said.

Chip Rush

RTX PRO 5500: ByteDance, Alibaba, and Tencent ordered over 3 million RTX PRO 550 chips, designed for powerful professional workstations rather than data centre clusters

Supply crunch: Nvidia may fulfil only 5-10% of requested quantities, with global production expected to be capped at 3 million cards in 2027

Export restrictions: US curbs bar sales of Nvidia's B300 data-centre chips to China, while H200 exports require case-by-case approval, increasing demand for less powerful chips

AI inference: Chinese firms primarily want the RTX PRO 5500 cards to run trained AI models and generate chatbot responses

The three Chinese tech giants' orders are for cards priced at about $11,400 each, two of the sources said, giving them a potential combined value of more than $35 billion.

The scale of the orders, which have not been previously reported, underscores the ongoing appetite among Chinese companies for Nvidia hardware despite the US curbs.

Nvidia Chief Executive Jensen Huang has said the restrictions reduced Nvidia's share of China's artificial intelligence (AI) data-centre chip market from a near monopoly to effectively nothing. But demand for the RTX PRO 5500 suggests Nvidia retains a sizeable potential market in China through less powerful products that may still be available.

The surge in demand also highlights how US restrictions have tightened computing-power supplies in the world's second-largest economy as Chinese companies race to develop cutting-edge AI models and propel Beijing's effort to deploy the technology across its industries.

US' curbs have pushed Chinese firms toward domestic suppliers, while Beijing has encouraged use of homegrown chips.

Huawei, in particular, has gained market share, though Chinese chipmakers have generally struggled to match leading US products, partly because restrictions have limited access to the foreign equipment that is used to make the most advanced semiconductors.

"US firms continue to be restricted by a combination of outdated US export controls, which cover gaming products released nearly a half a decade ago, and China's own limit on US imports," the spokesperson said.

Chinese companies are seeking to use the cards primarily for AI inference, or running trained models to generate chatbot responses, the three sources said. Inference generally requires less computing power than training models on massive datasets.

Hegseth discusses Iran with Netanyahu in surprise visit

Pak army chief arrives in Tehran as part of efforts to ease regional tensions

AGENCIES
20 October

United States (US) Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth discussed Iran with Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu during an unannounced visit to Israel on Monday, three Israeli officials said, as tensions flare between the US and Iran.

The officials did not provide further details about the meeting, first reported by Axios. The Pentagon declined to comment. The Israeli prime minister's office did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Hegseth said in a social media post that he had visited US service members in the Central Command area of responsibility, which covers West Asia, northeast Africa and parts of Asia.

Israel's Army Radio reported his meeting with Netanyahu took place at an air force base in Israel's southern desert.

Hegseth's visit comes amid rising tensions in the West Asia war as tensions flare between the US and Iran over the Strait of Hormuz and as Yemen's Iran-allied Houthis intensify their attacks on Saudi Arabia.

A billboard showing Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu in the empty hall of the United Nations, in Tehran PHOTO: REUTERS

It also came a day after US President Donald Trump endorsed Netanyahu in next week's parliamentary election in Israel, the country's first ballot since the October 7, 2023, Hamas attack on southern Israel.

US and Israeli forces launched joint strikes against Iran in late February, setting off the wider West Asia war. Netanyahu told Israeli media this month that he's not seeking to attack Iran before the October 27 Israeli election. Trump has said he will not attack Iran before US midterm elections in November.

Pakistan's Chief of Defence Forces Field Marshal Asim Munir arrived in Iran on Tuesday, as part of Islamabad's efforts to de-escalate regional tensions, Iranian media reported. Iran's state-run *IRNA* news agency reported that Field Marshal Munir, "heading a delegation of Pakistani officials, arrived in Tehran on Tuesday afternoon".

Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi also arrived in Iran, accompanying Munir on the visit, according to Iran's state-owned Press TV.

Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei said at a press conference ahead of Munir's visit that its primary objective was "to strengthen bilateral relations and mutual cooperation".

Talks between Munir and Iranian authorities will focus primarily on bilateral relations, regional developments, diplomatic processes, easing regional tensions, and various international issues, *IRNA* reported.

Field Marshal Munir has made several visits to Iran since the conflict with the US began.

His previous visit was in September, when he held meetings with President Masoud Pezeshkian, Secretary of the Supreme National Security Council Mohsen Rezaei, Parliament Speaker Mohammad Baqer Ghalibaf, Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi and Interior Minister Eskandar Momeni.

UK boosts support for Saudi with 'defensive' air patrols

Britain announced Tuesday that it is expanding military support for Saudi Arabia against the Houthis to include "defensive" air patrols by Royal Air Force jets, but stressed there is no military solution to the conflict.

Defence Secretary Wes Streeting said Royal Air Force Typhoon jets will "conduct defensive counter-air operations over Saudi Arabia, helping to protect Saudi cities, civilian populations and critical national infrastructure" from missiles and drones fired by the Iran-backed rebels in Yemen. He said the British planes won't strike Houthi targets.

The United Kingdom will also send a military transport plane and an unspecified number of military advisers to Saudi Arabia, Streeting said.

The announcement follows Britain's decision last month to offer in-air refuelling of Saudi planes operating against the Houthis. That mission is being extended by another 90 days, Streeting said. AP/PTI

Houthi strike on Yemen training camp kills 73

The death toll from a Houthi missile strike on a government military camp in southern Yemen rose to 73 people, all new recruits, making it the deadliest strike since fighting in the country began escalating three months ago, a senior Yemeni government official said Tuesday.

The recruits were all aged between 18 and 20, and some were still missing a day after the Iranian-backed rebels hit the al-Alam training camp in the southern province of Shabwa with ballistic missiles, Shabwa governor Awad Ibn al-Wazir told *The Associated Press*.

Monday's strike was part of a recent surge of fighting in Yemen, which started when forces from the internationally recognised government and Saudi-led coalition launched airstrikes on Houthi-held Sanaa International Airport in July, shattering a 2022 ceasefire deal that largely stopped fighting in the country's civil war. AP/PTI

US to give farmers $8 billion in aid to offset diesel costs

BLOOMBERG
20 October

The Trump administration announced $8 billion in aid for farmers to help offset rising fuel costs, a major burden for growers during the harvest.

The move is the administration's latest attempt to ease financial burdens on growers — traditionally a strong Republican voting base — ahead of midterm elections. The White House earlier this month also eased limits restricting the use of a tax-exempt variety of diesel.

US HAD EARLIER EASED LIMITS RESTRICTING THE USE OF A TAX EXEMPT VARIETY OF DIESEL

The Harvest Fuel Relief program will "provide relief during temporary market disruptions and increased input costs," the United States (US) Department of Agriculture said in a statement late Monday. The one-time payments will cover a portion of modelled losses for farmers during the 2026 crop year, according to the agency.

Diesel prices have surged globally as the US-Iran conflict constrains fuel exports through the Hormuz Strait. Retail prices in the US hit a record at $6.50 a gallon in September, creating headaches for the president ahead of elections. The upheaval is further delaying a recovery for farmers already struggling with massive global crop inventories and limited demand growth.

ZELENSKYY, WITKOFF MEET IN OSLO

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy met with US special envoy Steve Witkoff on Tuesday in a bid to rescue their relations that have sunk to new lows, as US President Donald Trump courts Moscow and Kyiv complains about Washington withholding vital defence support PHOTO: REUTERS

It is not just France, Europe's political centre is crumbling

STEVEN ERLANGER
20 October

Centrist parties are in trouble in Europe's largest and most important nations. Anger over low economic growth, high inflation, sizeable government debt and poor prospects for the young are feeding protest and populist parties of the far right and far left.

The mass riots in France, which started as protests over underfunded schools, are a shocking example. But the phenomenon has been building for years, with the perceived failure of liberal democracy to make good on its promises of a better future.

There is a growing perception among many Europeans that traditional parties of the centre-left and centre-right do not offer real alternatives and are led by an educated elite that has lost its connection to the poor, the workers and the young. Facing rising deficits, expenses and interest rates, governments feel constrained in what they can do to respond.

Instead, many people are supporting parties like the National Rally of Marine Le Pen, leading the polls for the French presidency on the far right, and France Unbowed of Jean-Luc Mélenchon, on the far-left, running second. In Germany, they are turning to the far-right Alternative for Germany and the far-left Die Linke party.

With major elections coming in the next year in four of Europe's most populous states — Spain, France, Italy and Poland — there are significant challenges coming from more extremist parties. Even in Italy, where protests erupted over the weekend, the right-wing prime minister, Giorgia Meloni, faces a former general, Roberto Vannacci, who is running even further to the right.

Hard-right parties also sit in the governments of the Czech Republic, Finland, Slovakia and Croatia, while Slovenia's government relies on outside support from one, Alberto Alemanno, a professor of European Law at HEC Paris, recently noted.

Protesters stand next to burning bicycles amid clashes during a demonstration in Paris on Saturday PHOTO: REUTERS

Satisfaction with how democracy is working has been declining dramatically, according to opinion polling from the Pew Research Center. In France, Pew found this year, 69 per cent of the population is dissatisfied with democracy. In Spain, it is 68 percent. In Italy, 62 per cent. In Poland, the newest democracy after years of Soviet occupation, it is 47 per cent. In the United States, it is 69 per cent.

There are many reasons put forward for the decline in optimism and faith in centrist politics. But Daron Acemoglu, a Nobel laureate in economics, puts it simply. "We started taking democracy for granted," he said. Liberal democracy has failed to keep faith with ordinary citizens. "If liberalism is to rise again, it must be with the working class at its heart," he said.

The rapid nationwide spread of the French protests to include workers and pensioners angry at inflation and high interest rates, especially given rising prices for energy and for borrowing costs, points to a larger failure of President Emmanuel Macron's centre-right government and of liberal democracy writ large. The violence of what became riots in many cities is expected only to help Le Pen and her anti-liberal complaints about immigration and lawlessness.

Acemoglu, a professor at Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), has tried to provide both an analysis and some prescriptions in a recent book, What Happened to Liberal Democracy? In it, he outlines "two broad lines of failure" over the last half-century, which have led to widespread alienation and anti-establishment sentiment.

The first is what he calls the failure to deliver on shared prosperity, especially for a salaried working class hit by automation, globalisation and sharply increased inequality, and which now feels deep anxiety about artificial intelligence (AI).

Leaders have forgotten that a key part of their pact with voters is to "take care of the drains," he said, to ensure the good functioning of the infrastructure of daily life, from roads to education to health care.

The second, Acemoglu said in an interview, is "the rise of top-down cultural politics," whereby a college-educated elite now dominates even traditional Socialist and working-class parties throughout the Western world and in his view patronises or dismisses the concerns of those who traditionally supported them.

As a result, working-class voters are moving toward populist parties on the far left and especially the far right, as in France and Germany, threatening traditional values, shrinking historically "large church" parties of the centre and threatening the working of parliamentary democracy.

In Britain's 2024 election, the two long-dominant parties, Labour and Conservative, won their lowest combined vote share in more than a century. The far-right Reform UK party surged in the polls last year, though it has since fallen somewhat. Centrist parties need to regain the trust of voters that they not only hear them but empathise with them, said Steven E Sokol, president of the American Council on Germany. "A constant in all these countries are the people who feel left behind, who feel they are no part of the prosperity and security they see all around them," he said.

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Curfews bring calm to Paris

Paris returned to calm on Tuesday after its first quiet night since a weekend marred by France's worst rioting in years, as authorities imposed curfews in several cities in an effort to prevent another round of rioting and looting.

At least 2,400 people were arrested after rioters in cities across France on Saturday clashed with police, set cars on fire and stormed public buildings, during nationwide protests against rising living costs and poor conditions in schools.

On Sunday evening, small groups set fire to trash bins, bicycles and other objects in the streets and looted businesses in Paris, Lyon, Marseilles and other cities. AP/PTI

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Improved closing auction

Sebi should aim to increase participation

It has been 10 weeks since the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) changed the way the stock markets end their trading day. It introduced the closing auction session (CAS) on August 3, with the idea of giving one efficient price for index funds, large institutional investors, and derivatives traders. But, instead, it led to problems — especially for derivatives traders, who decided to stay out of the market because of the unpredictability and volatility during the end session. A new circular dated October 15 addresses the issues and is in the right direction. It has delinked derivatives from the CAS close. The notional average daily derivatives turnover is more than 200 times that in cash. Retail investors account for about 40 per cent of the turnover in index options. The CAS was putting all these traders out of the system. The problems should be fixed in December.

The issue started when the indicative equilibrium prices in the CAS system fluctuated wildly as algo traders entered and cancelled orders, which led to volatility. The CAS settlement price is directly tied to expiring derivatives contracts, where traders had limited visibility of how the market would move. Thus, most derivatives traders and domestic funds stayed away from the market during the auction window. The bigger issue was that cash trading stopped at 3.15 pm while derivatives traded till 3.40 pm. The final value for the benchmark indices that came after the CAS was many a time far away from the closing price at 3.15 pm. Likewise for stocks that are part of the derivatives, or futures & options (F&O), segment.

The volumes handled in the auction are about 1 per cent of the daily cash turnover. The auction filled well on days when indices were rebalanced. For example, on the day of MSCI rebalance there were many buyers and sellers in the auction session and volumes were at 22 per cent of the entire trading day. But in normal days it lacked participants and sufficient volumes. In comparison, on the New York Stock Exchange, the CAS handles 12.43 per cent of daily volumes, and the same is 10 per cent for the Nasdaq. In such markets, it is hard for any single player to move the closing price because the CAS accounts for more than 10 per cent of the volumes. In India, the volumes are only 1 per cent and a small player can move stocks and thereby the index in the auction session and make money out of derivatives trades.

The new circular addresses most of these issues. From December 7, the expiry session goes back to the previous 25-year-old system of volume weighted average price (VWAP) while the daily closing price of underlying stocks will continue to be determined via CAS. Expiring index derivatives will stop trading at 3.30 pm or the same time as the cash markets. The auction will happen afterwards (3.30-3.40 pm) but stock derivatives will continue to trade until 3.45 pm.

This is a return to the old system but the auction stays and sets the official closing prices. But the link between derivatives and VWAP is restored. However, Sebi is yet to address how to bring in more passive funds to participate, improve the securities lending and borrowing mechanism (SLBM) or short selling, or separate auction order types that exist in the developed markets. A working stock-lending and short-selling market would let traders sell borrowed shares in an auction where buyers are bigger in numbers, narrowing the imbalances at the close. Thus, there is more to be done. Most importantly, fix stock lending and deepen the auction pool.

Institutional stability

India needs timely appointments in higher education

Some of India's premier higher-education institutions are facing a leadership vacuum, with 37 of the 155 Institutions of National Importance (23.9 per cent) operating under interim, acting or in-charge heads, additional-charge arrangements or extensions, according to a recent *Hindustan Times* analysis. The problem is particularly acute in central universities, where 20 of 48 institutions analysed have an interim leadership or extended tenures. Some vacancies persist despite posts being advertised months or even years earlier. This is more than an administrative inconvenience. Vice-chancellors and directors oversee faculty recruitment, academic programmes, budgets, infrastructure, and research partnerships. Prolonged uncertainty can delay decisions on new courses, the setting up of laboratories, and long-term financial commitments. Interim heads may also be reluctant to undertake major reforms when their authority is temporary. Additional-charge arrangements compound the problem by dividing the attention of senior academics between institutions. Hence, prolonged vacancies can put institutions in "standby mode", weakening accountability and long-term planning.

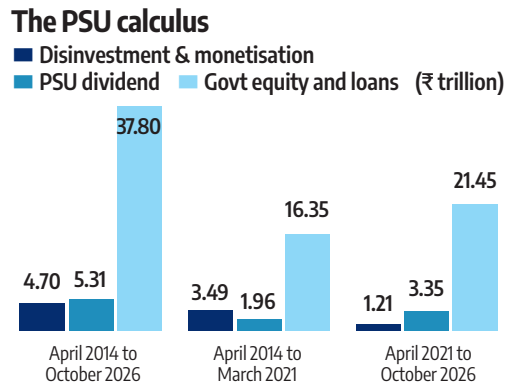
The consequences are serious because leadership gaps coincide with wider capacity constraints in higher education. According to an analysis by PRS Legislative Research, 29 per cent of the sanctioned teaching posts in central universities were vacant as of December 2024. For professors, the vacancy rate stood at 56 per cent. These shortages place additional pressure on existing faculty. The appointment process also needs closer scrutiny. The analysis highlights cases in which selection procedures had begun well before the incumbent's tenure ended, yet successors were not announced in time. Indira Gandhi National Tribal University, for instance, had functioned without a regular vice-chancellor for nearly 21 months, although the post had been advertised in June 2024 and re-advertised in March 2026. Such delays raise questions about administrative efficiency. Disputes over search committees and compliance with selection norms can further erode confidence in the process. Transparent, merit-based appointments are essential to protecting institutional credibility and autonomy.

The government should begin selection at least six months before a vacancy arises. It should establish binding timelines for screening applications, convening search committees and announcing appointments, with periodic public updates on progress. Such reporting would make delays visible and strengthen oversight without giving the government greater control over academic decisions. Committees should have clear selection criteria, independent members and safeguards against arbitrary interference. Interim appointments must be strictly time-bound, with extensions permitted only in exceptional circumstances and accompanied by a clear explanation. Institutions could also have contingency plans to ensure that essential academic and financial decisions continue during transitions. Strengthening leadership continuity and institutional autonomy is essential to improving research, teaching quality, and India's global competitiveness in higher education. Timely leadership appointments are a basic requirement for that task. Leadership gaps and an inadequate strength of teaching staff, even in India's premier institutions, could seriously undermine the country's broader objective of achieving higher sustainable growth and becoming a developed country by 2047.

Prospects of reviving asset sale

The disinvestment journey of the past decade has not been impressive. How it pans out now depends on some key factors

ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA



Source: Govt of India

The Narendra Modi government appears to be on a disinvestment drive. This is happening after a slow and halting implementation of its policy on strategic sale of public-sector undertakings (PSUs) it had announced in 2021.

Last week, the Union Cabinet approved a proposal to sell over 30 per cent of the government's total equity in IDBI Bank at a price that should yield the central exchequer a disinvestment receipt of over ₹26,500 crore in the current year. With more than five months to go before the current year ends, the government will have collected more than its annual target of ₹80,000 crore from such asset sales during 2026-27. Equally important, the IDBI Bank deal means that the Modi government has now given a push to privatisation after a pause.

RAISINA HILL

A K BHATTACHARYA

It is also important to note that the IDBI Bank privatisation doesn't appear to be a flash in the pan. According to the finance ministry, the government plans to list three more PSUs on the stock exchange — India Infrastructure Finance Company Ltd (IIFCL), Mahanadi Coalfields Ltd (MCL) and South Eastern Coalfields Ltd (SECL). Listing MCL and SECL may not result in any disinvestment receipts for the government, as they are wholly-owned subsidiaries of Coal India Ltd (CIL), which alone will benefit from such share sale proceeds. But the listing decision on IIFCL, wholly owned by the government, will mean more disinvestment receipt if it is listed before March 2027 as planned. Indeed, preparations for an initial public offer of IIFCL shares have already begun.

To be sure, the government's track record on privatisation so far has been unimpressive. After formulating a policy on strategic disinvestment in 2021, wherein the government decided to exit all PSUs barring a few strategic ones, only Air India, Ferro Scrap Nigam, Neelachal Ispat Nigam and Indian Medicines Pharmaceuticals Corporation have been privatised. Air India was a high-profile company, but owing to its huge, accumulated debt, the net proceeds for the government from its privatisation in January 2022 were only ₹2,700 crore.

Not that the sale of the other three companies saw higher realisation. The privatisation of Ferro Scrap and Neelachal Ispat yielded zero receipts. The sale proceed from Indian Medicines Pharmaceuticals Corporation was ₹118.73 crore. That meant four cases of privatisation got the government only ₹2,818.73 crore. Critics of the government's privatisation policy have not yet latched on to this number, but when they do, reservations about the policy on strategic sale of PSUs will only get more serious.

In the last twelve and a half years of the Modi government, total disinvestment receipts are estimated at ₹4.37 trillion, of which privatisation proceeds account for a tiny proportion of just 0.64 per cent, with the remaining amount being collected through the sale of minority shares. In the last one and a half years, asset monetisation (or the sale of land and buildings owned by government-owned PSUs) has picked up, with a total amount estimated at ₹34,787 crore. Even after including asset monetisation, total disinvestment proceeds in the Modi regime so far have been less than PSU dividend receipts of ₹5.32 trillion during this period.

This is perhaps one of the reasons for the government slowing down its disinvestment programme from 2021-22, ironically the same year when the government announced its policy on strategic sale of PSUs. It was argued by senior finance ministry functionaries then that value maximisation was as important an objective in managing PSU assets as achieving disinvestment targets. This reflected a shift in strategy that was no longer overly dependent on strategic disinvestment and required a broader and more holistic approach decoupled from fiscal management.

Not surprisingly, the change in approach was visible in slowing disinvestment receipts, rising dividends from PSUs, and a sharp increase in the government's equity contribution and loans released to PSUs in subsequent years. Between 2021-22 and 2025-26, disinvestment receipts were estimated at just about 21 per cent of the total such proceeds during the twelve and a half years of the Modi government. In the same period, however, PSU dividends rose to ₹3.35 trillion, accounting for 63 per cent of total received by the government. And the government's equity and loans to PSUs in this period rose to ₹21.45 trillion, over 57 per cent of what was allocated from 2021-22 to 2026-27. It was during the same period that the government's Budget documents stopped referring to disinvestment in its capital receipts calculations. In what seemed to be part of its plan to de-emphasise disinvestment, all receipts from asset sales were classified as non-debt capital receipts.

Now that the government's approach to disinvestment is changing, it will be important to keep track of a few parameters of the government's receipts and expenditure allocations. One, it will be helpful if disinvestment receipts and asset monetisation receipts are clearly identified in the receipts budget, so that these numbers can be easily identified and subjected to analysis and dissemination.

Two, tracking disinvestment numbers will be important. But equally important will be the need to measure the pace at which the government is investing in PSUs through equity contribution and loans. In the early years of the Modi government, the amount allocated for equity and loans to PSUs was a little more than a third of the government's total capital expenditure budget. In the last few years, this share has been close to 50 per cent. This trend should be reversed without any decline in the government's overall capex target.

Three, it will be necessary to keep a close watch on the ratio between the government's total receipts from PSUs (through disinvestment and dividend income) and the amount it spends on them through equity and loans. In the last five years, the amount of government receipts from PSUs as a share of total spending on PSUs has steadily fallen from around 30 per cent in 2021-22 to 15 per cent in 2024-25, before recovering a bit to about 26 per cent in 2025-26. This ratio should get better over time as the government's disinvestment receipts increase and the need for fresh equity infusion declines.

Not in default, but already affected

AARAADHYA SRIVASTAVA,
PRATIBHA KUMARI & JITHIN P

The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), a landmark reform introduced during the first term of the Modi government, marked its 10th anniversary in May 2026. Commentaries assessing the IBC's performance have critiqued it on three grounds: (1) delays in the resolution process, (2) the relatively large share of concluded cases ending in liquidation rather than restructuring, and (3) the large haircuts suffered by creditors.

These are valid concerns regarding the functioning of the IBC once a firm enters insolvency proceedings. However, these very features determine what lenders expect to recover upon default and, consequently, shape the terms on which they extend credit before any default occurs. Thus, evaluating the IBC primarily through resolution outcomes provides only a partial picture of its effects. We, therefore, look beyond the insolvency process to examine how the reform affected firms that never entered insolvency proceedings.

In its early years, the IBC was widely credited with improving India's previously dysfunctional corporate insolvency resolution framework. Before the IBC, creditors recovered barely a quarter of the value of distressed assets, while resolution often took more than four years, according to the World Bank's Doing Business 2015 report. By 2020, recovery rates under the IBC had risen to over 45 per cent, while average resolution time had fallen to around 413 days, a remarkable turnaround from the multi-year delays of the past. This early period provides a useful setting for understanding the effects of improvements in the insolvency resolution process, before subsequent challenges weakened these gains.

Quicker resolution reduced the deadweight costs associated with lengthy bankruptcy proceedings, while higher recovery rates strengthened lenders' confidence in the enforceability of their claims. With lower expected losses in the event of default, lenders had greater incentives to expand the supply of credit and lend at a lower cost than before. Research supports this argument.In a 2021 paper published in the *Journal of Corporate Finance*, Bose, Filomeni, and Mallick document that the IBC expanded the availability of low-cost credit to distressed firms.

Distressed firms, in turn, had an incentive to use their additional borrowing capacity to finance risky projects. Why? Because if such projects succeeded, the resulting improvement in cash flows could allow firms to avoid default. Consistent with this possibility, Singh, Chauhan, and Jadiyappa (2022), in a paper published in *Finance Research Letters*, document that the IBC induced distressed firms to take on more risk than non-distressed firms, with the increase in risk-taking accompanied by improved operating performance. These results suggest that a bankruptcy law that rapidly resolves insolvency, as the IBC did during its initial years, can both enable creditors to recover a larger fraction of their dues more quickly and improve the prospects of distressed firms.

These findings should not, however, imply that the IBC mattered only for distressed firms. The reform could also have affected the financing and investment decisions of relatively healthy firms. How? By improving expected recovery for lenders and making the insolvency process more time-bound, the IBC may have increased the amount of credit that lenders were willing to extend against a given pool of collateral. Firms with a greater stock of collateralisable assets could then have accessed additional debt to finance value-enhancing activities such as capital-goods imports, which can serve as a source of technological upgrading. We tested this hypothesis and found that, following the introduction of the IBC, import-dependent firms with more pledgeable assets borrowed more and used the additional funds to increase their capital-goods imports by about 31 per cent relative to otherwise comparable firms.

Put together, these findings suggest that the IBC has consequences even for firms that never enter insolvency. Its influence, however, depends on lenders perceiving it as a credible mechanism for timely recovery. Recent evidence of prolonged insolvency proceedings raises concerns in this regard. According to the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India newsletter for the April-June 2026 quarter, the average time taken to complete a restructuring process was 1,026 days, while the average liquidation process took 1,378 days. Such delays may undermine lenders' confidence in the framework, with implications for the supply and cost of credit. Weaker confidence could, in turn, affect firms' access to external finance, constrain investment by viable firms, and increase the likelihood of default among financially weaker firms.

The IBC should, therefore, be judged not only by what happens when firms default, but also by how the prospect of default shapes the behaviour of firms and lenders before it occurs. Its greatest contribution may lie not in resolving insolvency after the fact, but in changing behaviour before it does. For that to happen, however, the promise of timely resolution must remain credible.

The writers are, respectively, assistant professor at the Indian Institute of Management, Ranchi; assistant professor at TAPMI, Bengaluru; and assistant professor at the Indian Institute of Management, Raipur. The views are personal

The cities called Delhi

BOOK REVIEW

VEENU SANDHU

Delhi, with its multiple identities and contested pasts, is like a scratch card. Look below any surface and a story reveals itself. It is a city where centuries coexist, where empires have risen and fallen, where conquerors have built over — and often alongside — the ruins of their predecessors, and where the past has a habit of hobnobbing with the present. To capture its history in just 214 pages, introduction and index included, seems an impossible task. Yet John Zubrzycki manages to pull it off, offering through *The Shortest History of Delhi* a remarkably rich and engaging introduction to one of the world's most historically complex cities.

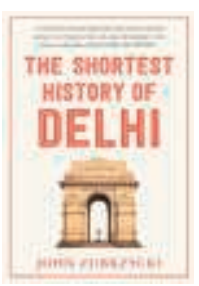
There is, of course, no single history of Delhi. There is its political history, its architectural history, the cultural and social histories, and the countless stories of those who have inhabited it, shaped it, destroyed it, and rebuilt it. Mr Zubrzycki, who holds a doctorate in Indian history from the University of New South Wales, served as a diplomat at the Australian High Commission in New Delhi, and has written five other books on India, including *The Shortest History of India*, skillfully bringing these strands together.

The book is part of a series that attempts to present vast subjects through compact narratives, with titles ranging from economics, China, and Egypt to football, music, migration, and the universe.

Described variously as "the Rome of Asia", "the foundation of the eighth heaven", the "Persepolis" of the British, among others, Delhi has inspired travellers, poets, and chroniclers such as the Moroccan explorer Ibn Battuta and the Sufi poet, scholar, and musician Amir Khusrau. Referencing them, Mr Zubrzycki begins by examining the city's origins, particularly its association with Indraprastha, the legendary capital of the Pandavas in the *Mahabharata*. He distinguishes between mythology and archaeological evidence. While excavations at *Purana Qila* (Old Fort) have yielded pottery dating to around 1,000 BC, no conclusive proof links Delhi to the legendary city. Yet the belief in Indraprastha became so firmly embedded in Delhi's identity that even the British invoked it when justifying their decision to shift the imperial capital from Calcutta to Delhi in 1911.

The first historically documented city called Delhi emerged much later, in the 11th century, under the Tomar Rajputs. Their fortified settlement of Lal Kot was later expanded by Prithviraj Chauhan into Qila Rai Pithora. Then came the Delhi Sultanate, the Khiljis, and the Tughlaqs, and the new capitals such as Siri, Tughlaqabad, and Firozabad. The Mughals added further layers —Humayun's Din Panah, and Shah Jahan's spectacular Shahjahanabad.

Mr Zubrzycki takes the reader through this succession of dynasties without reducing the history of Delhi to a catalogue of kings and battles. He tells the story often through personalities — for instance, Qutb ud-Din Aibak (1150-1210), the founder of the Delhi Sultanate who rose from slavery to become one of Muhammad Ghori's most trusted generals. His extraordinary ascent was accompanied by ruthless military campaigns and destruction, which the author offers a graphic account of: "... after a particularly gruesome battle that saw the Yamuna River 'turn the colour of blood', Aibak took control of Delhi from the Chauhans."



The Shortest History of Delhi
by John Zubrzycki
Published by Picador India
214 pages ₹479

The city's fortunes took another devastating turn with the decline of the Mughal power, invasions by Nadir Shah and others, and eventually British control. Particularly vivid is Mr Zubrzycki's recounting of the aftermath of the 1857 revolt, when large parts of Shahjahanabad were systematically demolished. Muslim properties were confiscated and the Red Fort occupied by British troops. He quotes historian Narayani Gupta, who observed: "Delhi was made to forget that it was a Mughal City."

The British subsequently sought to impose their own imperial vision through New Delhi, designed principally by Edward Lutyens. But then Delhi isn't known to allow a permanent seat to anyone. With Independence, and Partition, that vision too would change as refugees arrived, carrying memories of the cities they had left behind.

Mr Zubrzycki suggests that more than any other event, Partition marked the birth of Delhi's culture as we recognise it today.

Photographs, informative pullout sections, and maps support the narrative, as does a chart of how Delhi's population has grown, which brings the reader to the final chapter, aptly titled "The Contradictory City". This section, arrived at after travelling through centuries, delves into concerns over the present. Mr Zubrzycki is highly critical of Delhi's chaotic expansion, its crumbling infrastructure and the repeated failure of urban plans. He is equally unsparing in his assessment of the Central Vista redevelopment.

The builders of Tughlaqabad, Shahjahanabad and Lutyens's Delhi all imagined their built heritage would last. Today, a lot of it is in ruins, others are decaying and still others have been appropriated by successive ruling classes. Why should the present be any different, he wonders. Delhi, after all, has always been a work in progress, its story never quite complete.

Business Standard NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, 21 OCTOBER 2026

The Smart Investor

STREET VIEW

"I see this (Nasdaq futures falling) as a dip inside a selective market rather than a genuine AI buying opportunity or the start of a deeper repricing. Investors are pickier about AI stories than they were a year ago"

Ion Jauregui,
Analyst, ActivTrades

Some AIFs in GIFT City get tax notices despite exemption

Notices issued over surcharges 'due' on dividends and interest income

SACHIN P MAMPATTA
Mumbai, 20 October

Investment funds set up in India's emerging international financial hub Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City) have received a handful of tax notices over recent months.

The notices are over surcharges purportedly due on dividends and interest income that Category III Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs) have received, according to three people familiar with the matter.

The notices are for assessment years 2024-25 and 2025-26 and are apparently not in sync with existing tax norms on surcharge applicable to such funds, said tax experts.

Domestic category III AIFs pay a surcharge of 10-15 per cent on dividend income and 10-37 per cent on interest income, while there is no such surcharge applicable on specified funds-category III AIFs located at GIFT City. They are liable to pay only a flat 10 per cent tax on income from securities such as dividends and interest.

The flat 10 per cent rate on interest and dividend income from securities for these funds was introduced by the Taxation and Other Laws (Relaxation and Amendment of Certain Provisions) Act, 2020, effective from FY21 or the 2021-22 assessment year.

Tax returns are generally filed in the assessment year that follows the financial year in which the income was earned.

The surcharge exemption on that 10 per cent tax was introduced in Finance Act, 2023, applicable from FY24 or 2024-25 assessment year.

The notices gain significance in light of recent traction for AIFs located in the jurisdiction. Category III AIFs have raised over $21.4 billion in commitments as of March 2026, shows data from the International Financial Services Centres Authority (IFSCA) bulletins. They have invested over a third of the committed capital.

"Cat III AIFs in GIFT City are charged a flat rate of 10% on dividend and interest and any recovery of surcharge and cess is erroneous. Normally such cases should get resolved by seeking a rectification of the demand since it is likely a system issue. However, if this does not get resolved by filing a rectification, the GIFT City fund might have to undergo the process of filing an appeal to the CIT(A)," said Rajesh H. Gandhi, partner, Deloitte India.

The Commissioner of Income Tax (Appeals) or CIT (A) is the first forum for appeal against action by the income tax department.

Tushar Sachade, partner at Price Waterhouse & Co LLP said that funds are talking with the IFSCA authorities and tax department on the same.

"Discussions are ongoing," he said. Pranay Bhatia, founder and managing partner of EFFIINEXT Advisory said that tax notices have seen an increase this year in respect of GIFT City Funds as well as other institutions.

Many of these are likely to be automated notices sent on account of system errors or contain standard questions that may or may not be relevant to the taxpayers' structure and circumstances. Such issues could be resolved after escalation to appellate authorities but can create a sense of uncertainty in the interim period, according to Bhatia.

"At the end of the day, tax is a complex subject involving interpretation and dynamic outcomes, which could lead to anxiety among investors," he said.There are 228 Category III AIFs in GIFT City as of March 2026.

There were only 14 as of March 2022-the earliest available figure in regulatory annual reports. The committed capital mentioned in 2022 was around $1 billion.

Emails sent to the IFSCA and the Central Board of Direct Taxes on September 1 did not receive a reply.

The lay of the land

- Some Category III AIFs in GIFT City face tax notices
- Dispute is around taxation of dividend, interest income
- Finance Act 2023 introduced surcharge exemption on 10 per cent tax
- Experts say relief possible in appeal process

PSBs take returns lead; private banks hold valuation edge

Q2 results tilt towards state-owned banks, while FCNR(B) inflows cloud private lenders' margin outlook

KAIRAVI LUKKA
Mumbai, 20 October

On Monday, the Nifty fell 1.11 per cent, with private-sector banks (PVBs) leading the rout. State-owned lenders, in contrast, ended higher. This divergence is not limited to Monday's session. Over the past year, the Nifty Private Bank index has fallen 4.36 per cent, while the Nifty PSU Bank index has risen 5.5 per cent.

The ongoing second-quarter (July-September/Q2) results season for 2026-27 has favoured public-sector banks (PSBs) over large private lenders so far, as heavy foreign currency non-resident (bank), or FCNR(B), inflows have weighed on margins at most PVBs. However, analysts do not expect the valuation gap between the two groups to narrow materially any time soon. Despite reporting higher returns on equity (RoE) than private banks, PSBs continue to trade at a discount, reflecting doubts about the sustainability of their returns, analysts said.

At Monday's close, the Nifty PSU Bank index traded at a price-to-book (P/B) ratio of 1.15x, compared with 1.95x for the Nifty Private Bank index. A year ago, the respective ratios stood at 1.28x and 2.19x, according to National Stock Exchange data.

With at least 16 banks having announced their Q2 results so far, many over the previous weekend, bank stocks saw mixed reactions on Monday.

Axis Bank fell the most, down 4.2 per cent, followed by Yes Bank, HDFC Bank, and IDFC First Bank, which fell between 2.2 per cent and 3.5 per cent. ICICI Bank fell 1.15 per cent. In contrast, Union Bank, Punjab National Bank, Bank of Baroda (BoB), and Canara Bank rose between 3.1 per cent and 5.3 per cent.

"Large PVBs saw margins impacted in Q2 by heavy FCNR(B) inflows, which, like term deposits, weighed on current account savings account ratios and raised the cost of funds. We expect HDFC Bank's net interest margins (NIMs) to improve from the third quarter (October-December/Q3) onwards, while relief for ICICI Bank and Axis Bank is likely only from the fourth quarter (January-March/Q4)," said Ishank Gupta, equity research analyst for banking and financial services at Choice Institutional Equities.

The interest-rate outlook could also favour PVBs. Kotak Institutional Equities (KIE) expects a further 50-basis point increase in the repo rate, taking it to 6 per cent. Repo-linked loans account for 57 per cent of ICICI Bank's loan book and 61 per cent of Axis Bank's, compared with 31 per cent for State Bank of India and 35 per cent for BoB. This would leave PVBs better placed than PSBs to benefit from the expected rate hikes.

"While our estimates do not yet fully reflect the impact of FCNR deposit repricing, we see scope for positive earnings surprises as margin tailwinds play out. Coupled with resilient asset quality and still-healthy growth prospects, this reinforces our preference for frontline private banks as the best way to position for the next phase of the banking cycle," the KIE report said.

Gupta added that NIMs improved across PSBs, but profitability took a bigger hit from their greater exposure to investments amid rising government security yields.

Raj Gaikar, research analyst at Samco Securities, said PSBs have historically traded at a steep discount to their private-sector peers on a P/B basis. However, the gap has narrowed sharply in recent years following a strong rally in PSB stocks.

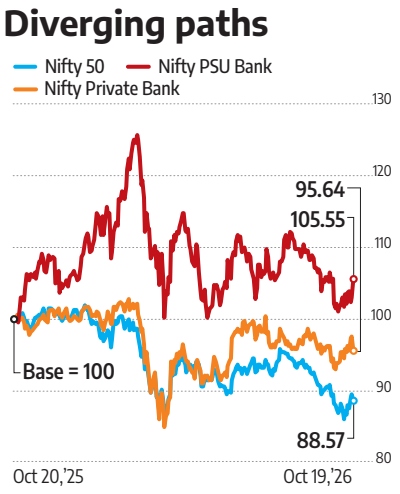
"PSBs operate with much higher balance-sheet leverage than large PVBs, which lifts RoE even when their return on assets is lower. PVBs earn more per rupee of assets, have stronger low-cost deposit bases, and have shown steadier earnings across cycles. The PSBs asset quality and capital have improved a lot," he said, adding that the current valuation gap looks broadly fair rather than suggesting that either group is deeply undervalued.

Over the six months since around the start of the West Asian conflict, the Nifty Private Bank index has risen marginally by 0.7 per cent, while the Nifty PSU Bank index has fallen 7.2 per cent, pointing to a slower recovery for state-owned lenders. Gupta does not expect the valuation gap between PVBs and PSBs to close materially. "Strong performance could narrow the gap in the near term, but a valuation differential is likely to persist," he said.

"PSBs have had a strong run, and much of the easy rerating is now behind us," Gaikar said, adding that further gains must come from earnings growth rather than multiple expansion.

ILLUSTRATION: BINY SINHA

Diverging paths



Source: Bloomberg, NSE
Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau

Direct plans gain in long-term SIPs, but regular ones dominate

The share of mutual fund systematic investment plan (SIP) assets in direct plans held for over five years more than doubled to 16.6 per cent in September 2026 from 6.9 per cent in September 2021. However, regular plans continue to dominate this category, accounting for ₹4.77 trillion of the ₹5.73 trillion in SIP assets.

Direct plans allow investors to invest without an intermediary and carry lower expense ratios. Regular plans, sold through individual agents, banks and wealth managers, tend to have higher longevity as investors benefit from professional guidance.

The share of direct plan has inched up in other periods as well, as they continue to grow in popularity. In the 4-5 year old SIP cohort, its share is up from 12.5 per cent to 23.7 per cent in the last period. Similarly, in the 3-4 year band, the share is up by nearly 10 percentage points.

Their share of SIP assets in the over-five-year category rose from 14.3 per cent in September 2025 to 16.6 per cent in September 2026. In the one-to-two-year category, it increased to 30.9 per cent from 27 per cent over the same period. Among SIPs less than a year old, the share rose to 32.3 per cent from 30.7 per cent.

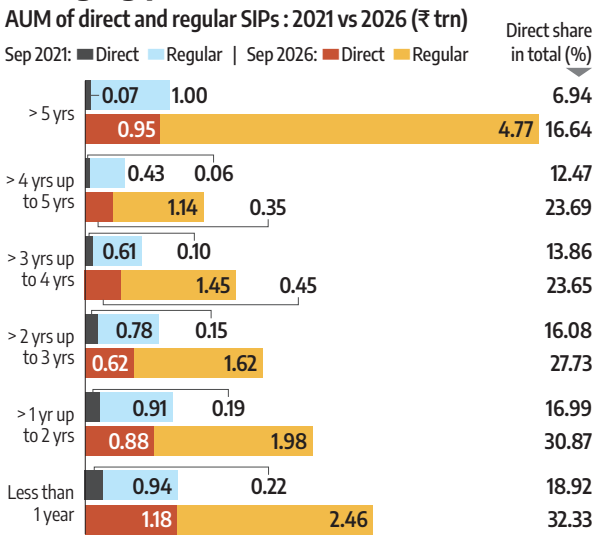
The rising SIP longevity, even in direct plans, is attributable to growing investor maturity. However, there are other factors as well. Experts say the share of direct plans in long-running SIPs was bound to be low until a few years back because direct plans are a recent phenomenon. Although introduced in 2013, direct plans have gained traction in recent years with the growth of digital investment platforms.

Consequently, fewer direct-plan SIPs have had the opportunity to build a five-year track record.

ABHISHEK KUMAR

Changing picture

AUM of direct and regular SIPs : 2021 vs 2026 (₹ trn)



Source: Industry data

Global stocks fall as AI worries return

BLOOMBERG
20 October

A rebound in the artificial intelligence trade sputtered after the dismal debut of a South Korean data center firm revived worries about whether the technology's spending boom can last. Treasuries rallied on haven demand.

S&P 500 futures fell 0.4 per cent as a poor reception for Elice in Seoul sapped appetite for risky assets.

The AI-infrastructure provider plunged 32 per cent, suffering the country's worst opening day for a sizeable firm. Nasdaq 100 contracts were down 0.8 per cent.

Treasuries benefited from a flight to safety despite climbing oil prices, with 10-year yields dropping five basis points to 5.09 per cent.

Brent crude briefly topped $111 a barrel for the first time since May as traders weighed the risk of further Iranian attacks in the Strait of Hormuz. The dollar fell 0.2 per cent.

"Concerns surrounding AI-related infrastructure investment have been building for several days," said Roger Lee at Cavendish.

Investors are now waiting for results from the biggest AI spenders for clues on how long the vast outlays can continue and at what pace.

MSCI's benchmark for Asia touched its lowest level since July, with South Korea's Kospi index falling 3.7 per cent. Industrial goods and services, along with mining stocks, pulled Europe's Stoxx 600 0.8 per cent lower.

Markets have already begun to price in a slowdown in earnings growth, said Mathias Heim, chief investment officer at Belle Capital.

Brent hits 5-month high

Oil advanced on Tuesday, with Brent reaching a five-month high, as traders priced in a geopolitical risk premium from Houthi attacks on Saudi infrastructure a nd reports of vessel attacks in the Gulf. Brent crude futures rose to $111.75 a barrel, the highest since May, and as of 11.20 GMT were trading at $111.20, up $1.65 or 1.5 per cent.

The November contract for US West Texas Intermediate crude, which expires on Tuesday, rose as high as $110, the highest since April for a nearby contract. REUTERS

THE COMPASS | DECODING MARKET DIRECTION

Cost pressures to persist for UltraTech in the near term

DEVANGSHU DATTA

Cement major UltraTech's September quarter (Q2FY27) results indicate that it retains its leadership in a crowded market. Volumes grew 13 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y), while the company continued with its planned capacity expansions. Although the monsoon season is typically weak for cement demand, price hikes helped support realisations to some extent. However, rising costs continued to weigh on profitability.

Earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) per tonne dropped to ₹240 quarter-on-quarter (Q-o-Q) to ₹974. Going ahead, high fuel costs remain a key concern, although operating leverage and strong volume growth could provide some relief. Margin recovery will also depend on maintaining prices in a competitive market. UltraTech added 4.6 million tonnes (mt) of cement capacity by September 2026, taking its domestic capacity to 204.7 mt.

The company launched its cables and wires (C&W) business, UltraVolt, in September. It has already committed ₹1,100 crore of the planned ₹1,800 crore capital expenditure (capex), which is expected to be completed in the second half of FY27. The C&W distribution network includes more than 80,000 retailers and electricians across 500 districts and 15,000 pin codes. More than 1,500 channel partners have also signed up to become UltraVolt dealers.

UltraTech's Q2FY27 earnings were in line with consensus estimates. Consolidated revenue rose 19 per cent Y-o-Y to ₹23,300 crore, while Ebitda grew 20 per cent to ₹3,700 crore. Ebitda per tonne increased 7 per cent Y-o-Y, while declining ₹240 Q-o-Q to ₹974. The operating profit margin (OPM) expanded 20 basis points Y-o-Y to 16 per cent. Adjusted net profit rose 22 per cent Y-o-Y to ₹1,500 crore.

Management remains confident about medium-term cement demand. Prices strengthened in September and October, although cost pressures persist. The company is also considering expanding beyond its planned capacity of 240 mt per annum (mtpa) by FY28, with detailed plans for further expansion likely to be announced by the end of FY27. Meanwhile, it is scaling up its nascent C&W business.

Cement sales volume rose 13 per cent Y-o-Y to 38.2 mt, while blended realisation increased 5 per cent to ₹6,095 per tonne, up 2 per cent Q-o-Q. Ready-mix concrete (RMC) revenue grew 29 per cent Y-o-Y, while white cement revenue rose 4 per cent. However, operating expenditure per tonne increased 5 per cent Y-o-Y and 8 per cent Q-o-Q, driven by higher fuel and freight costs. Depreciation and interest costs rose 6 per cent and 20 per cent Y-o-Y, respectively.

In H1FY27, revenue grew 17 per cent Y-o-Y, while Ebitda and net profit increased 16 per cent and 18 per cent, respectively. OPM contracted 20 basis points Y-o-Y to 18 per cent, while Ebitda per tonne rose 3 per cent to ₹1,099. Operating cash flow (OCF) stood at ₹6,910 crore, compared with ₹5,570 crore in H1FY26. Capex was ₹5,770 crore, resulting in free cash flow of ₹1,140 crore, against ₹770 crore a year earlier. Net debt increased to ₹23,500 crore from ₹16,600 crore in March 2026. The management noted that cement prices adjust with a lag to structural changes in costs. Prices are therefore expected to rise further in the near term as companies seek to offset higher expenses. Domestic cement demand is estimated to have grown 10 per cent Y-o-Y in Q2FY27, while UltraTech reported volume growth of 13.8 per cent, indicating market share gains. Capacity utilisation increased to 71 per cent in Q2FY27 from 66 per cent in Q2FY26.

Demand is expected to pick up from mid-November, after the festival season. Urban housing, infrastructure and private-sector capex are likely to remain key growth drivers. The net debt-to-Ebitda ratio is expected to remain broadly stable at 0.8-1.0 times. Return on equity (RoE) and return on capital employed (RoCE) are projected to rise by 100 bps each in FY28 compared with FY26, as more scale creates better operating leverage.

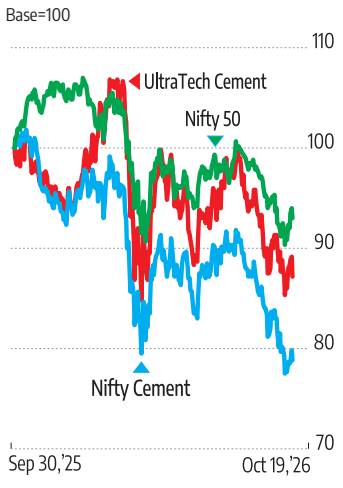
In the C&W business, the focus is on scaling up production. With an annualised copper consumption capacity of 78,000 tonnes, UltraVolt ranks second in terms of installed capacity and is not expected to require additional investment beyond the planned capex to maintain its position. The company has introduced differentiated products rather than competing primarily on price. The business is expected to mature in FY28. Given the encouraging feedback from the launch, it may scale up faster.

UltraTech has extended its lead in cement capacity and market share while maintaining its cost leadership and strong cash flow generation. Most analysts are retaining or marginally raising their earnings per share (EPS) estimates for FY27 and FY28, factoring in low-to-mid-teens growth in revenue and Ebitda.

The stock is valued at around 17 times its estimated FY27 enterprise value (EV)-to-Ebitda. While some analysts may upgrade their valuations, others are maintaining them. Key risks include rising costs and flatter demand because pricing power is moderate.

The writer is a New Delhi-based independent journalist

COMPANY: UltraTech Cement



Crompton's Q2 showing lifts growth outlook

Experts cite steady demand, cost gains to drive growth, margins

RAM PRASAD SAHU
Mumbai, 20 October

Consumer durables and lighting major Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals reported an 18 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) rise in sales in the September quarter, aided by double-digit growth across segments and price hikes. Exports also hit a quarterly high, rising 70 per cent Y-o-Y.

Though gross margins contracted due to input cost inflation, cost efficiencies helped improve operating margins. Brokerages remain positive on the firm's growth prospects, citing steady demand for energy-efficient products, an expanding portfolio and scope for further margin gains.

At the current price of ₹208.9, the stock trades at just under 20 times its FY28 estimated earnings.

Crompton's electrical consumer durables (ECD) segment, which accounts for about 72 per cent of revenue, reported 19.2 per cent growth over the year-ago period. This was led by 40 per cent growth in brushless direct current (BLDC) fans that consume significantly less electricity, double-digit growth in residential, agricultural and specialty pumps, and more than 20 per cent growth in small domestic appliances. These include induction cooktops, air fryers and mixer grinders.

Growth in BLDC fans was driven by portfolio interventions, improved distribution and increasing consumer preference for energy-efficient products. Water heaters gained market share, while solar pump growth remained muted due to lower PM-KUSUM order inflows. A potential recovery is expected under PM-KUSUM 2.0.

While ecommerce remained subdued, general trade and rural trade recorded double-digit growth. The lighting segment posted revenue growth of 14.3 per cent, driven by ceiling lights and outdoor lighting in business-to-consumer (B2C) portfolio, and industrial and indoor commercial lighting in business-to-business (B2B) portfolio. Revenue at acquired subsidiary Butterfly Gandhimathi grew 16.6 per cent Y-o-Y, driven by pressure cookers, induction cooktops, mixer grinders and electric rice cookers.

Motilal Oswal Research remains positive on Crompton's growth prospects, supported by BLDC fan penetration, improving product mix, and the scale-up of solar rooftop and wires. Analysts led by Sanjeev Kumar Singh believe the refreshed brand identity and cost efficiencies will help long-term growth and margin expansion. The firm is targeting an earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) margin of 11-12 per cent by FY29. The brokerage has a "buy" rating on it with a target price of ₹300.

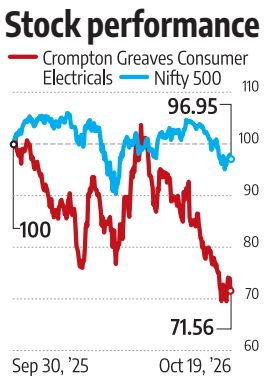
At the gross level, margins declined 180 basis points (bps) Y-o-Y to 29.8 per cent amid continued commodity cost inflation. The impact was partly offset by price hikes of 11-16 per cent across categories in the first half of FY27, with Crompton passing on 80 per cent of the cost inflation to consumers. However, cost savings helped Ebitda margin improve 40 bps Y-o-Y to 9 per cent.

Segment-wise, the lighting business's Ebit margin fell 260 basis points to 12.9 per cent Y-o-Y, as B2B orders were executed at pre-contracted prices. ECD margins improved 100 bps to 11.6 per cent, while margins at Butterfly Gandhimathi declined 30 bps to 7.4 per cent due to higher advertising costs.

Elara Research lowered its earnings estimates by 3 per cent for FY27, 2 per cent for FY28 and 4 per cent for FY29, factoring in margin pressure from cost inflation and a higher mix of the solar portfolio, which operates at the lower end of the firm's margin band compared with its core portfolio. The brokerage retained a "buy" rating but lowered its target price to ₹325.

Nomura Research marginally raised its FY27 revenue growth estimates for ECD and lighting to 13 per cent from 10-12 per cent earlier, factoring in price hikes. It expects the rampup in categories such as wires, solar and kitchen appliances, along with pan-India expansion, to help growth, subject to execution. Progress towards the firm's FY29 revenue growth target of 13-15 per cent and Ebitda margin target of 11-12 per cent could pose upside risks to estimates, according to analysts led by Siddhartha Bera. Nomura has a "buy" rating with a target price of ₹292.

Stock performance



Financial snapshot

Figures in ₹ cr	Revenue	Ebitda	Net profit
FY26	8,096	827	417
Y-o-Y chg %	2.9	-8.2	-25.1
FY27E	9,230	949	591
Y-o-Y chg %	14.0	14.7	41.9
FY28E	10,385	1,109	707
Y-o-Y chg %	12.5	16.9	19.6

E: Estimates; Ebitda: Earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation
Source: *Bloomberg*
Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau

YOUR MONEY

NATIONAL PENSION SYSTEM

What the new NPS Central platform offers investors

AMIT KUMAR

The Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) has launched NPS Central, a unified digital platform that allows National Pension System (NPS) subscribers to manage their pension accounts without having to navigate separate recordkeeping agency portals. Subscribers can log in using their registered mobile number and date of birth, verified through a one-time password (OTP), instead of remembering their Permanent Retirement Account Number (PRAN).

Available at the website *www.npscentral.in*, the platform brings together services offered through the three Central Recordkeeping Agencies (CRAs)—Protean, KFintech and CAMS. It was launched on October 1, 2026, on the occasion of NPS Diwas.

The platform is intended to simplify access to pension services, from checking investments and making contributions to exploring schemes and updating personal details. Prospective subscribers can also use it to register for NPS, compare investment options and select a pension fund.

How to log in to NPS Central

Existing NPS subscribers can follow these steps to access their accounts.

Visit the official website, www.npscentral.in. Enter the registered mobile number and date of birth. Complete authentication using the OTP received on the registered mobile number.

Access the consolidated dashboard to view NPS accounts and investment portfolios.

Subscribers do not need to remember their PRAN to log in through this process, according to PFRDA. However, the mobile number used for authentication must be the one registered with the account.

The consolidated dashboard could be particularly useful for subscribers who have accounts serviced by different CRAs. Instead of navigating separate interfaces, they can access their account information through a common platform.

Opening new NPS accounts

The new platform offers AI-assisted onboarding to the NPS, with an AI-enabled assistant for queries, and options to complete know-your-customer (KYC) verification through Central KYC (CKYC) and DigiLocker.

Prospective subscribers can explore and compare investment schemes, review their performance and select a pension fund manager.

Onboarding charges on NPS Central are nil, subject to the applicable terms and conditions, the PFRDA said.

Prospective subscribers should nevertheless review the scheme's features and applicable charges before registering. The absence of an onboarding fee does not necessarily mean that all services or investments under NPS are free of charges.

NPS Swasthya also available on the platform

NPS Central facilitates registration for NPS Swasthya, which combines a dedicated investment corpus with a super top-up health insurance arrangement. This brings healthcare-related services into the broader NPS digital ecosystem. However, the two components serve different purposes. The investment corpus and the insurance arrangement have their respective terms and conditions, which subscribers should examine before enrolling.

The PFRDA announcement does not specify the detailed eligibility criteria, insurance coverage limits or other product conditions for NPS Swasthya. Subscribers should check the applicable scheme documents before making a decision.

Which features are still to come?

Not all planned services are necessarily available at launch. PFRDA has said that it intends to expand NPS Central progressively, adding further account management and subscriber servicing facilities.

The proposed enhancements in the platform include:

Changes to investment choices and Pension Funds. Loan Against NPS facilities. Systematic Investment Plan (SIP) mandates. Onboarding and maintenance of NPS Vatsalya accounts. Corporate onboarding. Re-KYC services. Services relating to NPS Tier II accounts.

The regulator also plans to integrate the platform with other participants in the NPS ecosystem and existing digital touchpoints.

This would allow participating entities to offer unified NPS services through their own channels.

PFRDA said application programming interface (API) specifications for such integration are being made available on the NPS Central website.

Investors can use NPS Central to:

- Check their pension investment
- Make contributions
- Explore different schemes with varying investment options
- Update account details
- Download statements
- Raise grievances

The three-pillar sequence to building wealth

Many people do not have a personal finance plan; they have a collection of financial reactions. Over time, accepting pushed credit cards, signing workplace forms and buying hyped mutual funds leave you with fragmented accounts, random products and no clear picture of net worth. To break this cycle, stop collecting products and build a unified financial architecture.

The sequence to success

Protection & liquidity: Before pursuing growth, buy independent health insurance and pure term life insurance. Park three to six months of baseline living expenses in a separate savings account for emergencies.

Eradicate toxic debt: You cannot out-invest bad debt. Freeze discretionary spending and clear high-interest loans and credit card balances.

Automate wealth building: Route short-term funds into safe debt instruments, and long-term capital into broad-market equity index funds. Avoid endless optimisation. Choose index funds, consolidate unused accounts, add nominees across all portfolios and pin your asset allocation directives to your desk. A solid financial plan should feel slightly boring — build the system, then let it work.

Read full report here: www.business-standard.com/s/2g9ujl4

COMPILED BY PALLAV NAYAK

nuvama

NUVAMA CUSTODIAL SERVICES LIMITED

Corporate Identity Number : U67190MH2021PLC355152
Regd. Off: 801- 804, Wing A, Building No. 3, Inspire BKC, G Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai – 400 051
Tel: +91 22 6620 3030

Financial Results for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026 (₹ in Crore, except per share data)

	Particulars	Quarter ended September 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended June 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended September 30, 2025 (Unaudited)	Half year ended September 30, 2026 (Unaudited)	Half year ended September 30, 2025 (Unaudited)	Year ended March 31, 2026 (Audited)
1	Total income from operations	44.67	45.36	79.21	90.03	143.18	263.64
2	Net Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	0.86	2.27	10.05	3.13	13.58	22.57
3	Net Profit for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	0.86	2.27	10.05	3.13	13.58	22.57
4	Net Profit for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	0.62	1.67	7.50	2.29	10.13	16.83
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	0.60	1.63	7.51	2.23	10.12	16.83
6	Paid-up equity share capital (Face Value of ₹ 10/- Per Share)	55.00	55.00	55.00	55.00	55.00	55.00
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves)	50.07	49.47	41.12	50.07	41.12	47.84
8	Securities premium account	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL	NIL
9	Net worth [1]	105.07	104.47	96.12	105.07	96.12	102.84
10	Paid-up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt [2]	99.92	97.63	36.25	99.92	36.25	95.71
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Share	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
12	Debt Equity Ratio [3]	0.95	0.93	0.38	0.95	0.38	0.93
13	Earnings Per Share (₹) (Face Value of ₹ 10/- each)						
	- Basic (Refer note 5)	0.12	0.30	1.36	0.42	1.84	3.06
	- Diluted (Refer note 5)	0.12	0.30	1.36	0.42	1.84	3.06
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
15	Debenture Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (DSCR) [4]	0.03	0.04	0.29	0.07	0.39	0.27
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (ISCR) [5]	1.43	2.15	15.78	1.79	13.69	5.66

[1] Net worth = Equity share capital + Other Equity
[2] Paid-up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt = Debt securities + Borrowings (other than debt securities)
[3] Debt Equity Ratio = Total Debt (Debt securities + Borrowings (other than debt securities)) / Net worth
[4] Debt Service Coverage Ratio = (Profit before tax and Finance cost) / (Finance cost + Total Debt)
[5] Interest Service Coverage Ratio = (Profit before tax and Finance cost) / Finance cost

Notes:

1 The above is an extract of the detailed format of the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026 financial results filed with the Stock Exchange in accordance with Regulation 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended (the 'Listing Regulations, 2015') and the Indian Accounting Standards specified under section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 as amended and the relevant provision of the Companies Act, 2013, as applicable. The full format of the financial results are available on the website of the Stock exchange (www.bseindia.com).
2 For the other line items referred in regulation 52 (4) of the LODR Regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the Stock Exchange (BSE).
3 The above financial results of the Company for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026 have been reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their meetings held on October 19, 2026.
4 The above financial results for the quarter and half year ended September 30, 2026 have been subjected to limited review by the statutory auditors of the Company and the auditors have issued an unmodified review report.
5 Earnings per share for the quarters and half years ended are not annualised.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Anand Lalla
Executive Director & CEO
DIN : 02891270

Mumbai, October 19, 2026

Back to front? Green shoots in defensive sectors

Defensive stocks have underperformed amid sectoral headwinds, but lower valuations offer room for recovery, write **Krishna Kant & Ram Prasad Sahu**

Defensive sectors such as fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG), information technology (IT) services, and pharmaceuticals usually provide stability to equity portfolios during periods of price volatility and broader market selloffs. However, over the past two years, these sectors have been on the back foot, leading the decline in the broader market.

According to analysts, the decline in stocks in these sectors was driven by factors such as weak consumer demand and inflationary pressures in FMCG, growth headwinds from artificial intelligence in IT services, and export-related challenges in the US market for pharmaceutical companies. Their stock performance was also weighed down by record equity valuations at the end of calendar year 2024 (CY24).

The Nifty IT Index is down 16.8 per cent in CY26 so far, compared with a 12.4 per cent decline in the Nifty 50. This follows a 12.6 per cent fall in the IT index in CY25, even as the Nifty 50 rose 10.5 per cent. The Nifty FMCG Index, meanwhile, is down 20.7 per cent in CY26 so far, following a 2.3 per cent decline in CY25.

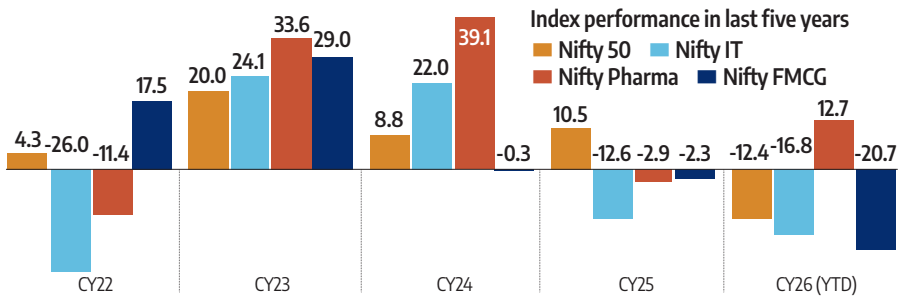
There are, however, early signs of a turnaround in defensive stocks, with the Nifty Pharma rallying 12.7 per cent year-to-date after declining 2.9 per cent in CY25. IT stocks, too, have rallied over the past two weeks. The Nifty IT Index is up 13.8 per cent month-to-date in October, compared with a 1.2 per cent rise in the Nifty 50 over the same period.

Analysts attribute the potential turnaround to the valuation de-rating of defensive stocks over the past two years, which has significantly narrowed their valuation premium over the Nifty 50 and the BSE Sensex. In fact, most IT services companies now trade at lower trailing price-to-earnings multiples than the benchmark indices, potentially improving the risk-reward proposition for long-term investors. Moderating valuations, coupled with cash-rich and debt-free balance sheets, make leading defensive stocks attractive for investors looking to accumulate shares.

Here is a look at 10 stocks across these three defensive sectors that offer a balance of reasonable valuations, near- and long-term earnings growth potential, high return on equity and relatively low valuation multiples.

Defensive sectors vs the benchmark index

Index performance in last five years



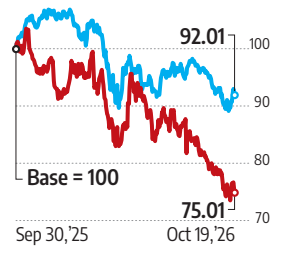
CY: Calendar year; YTD: Year to date; Note: CY26 performance is upto October 19
Source: Capitaline, Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau

ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA

Hindustan Unilever

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Jun 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
1,853	-27.7	-5.9	41.5	-25.8	22.6	5.8	27.4	3.6

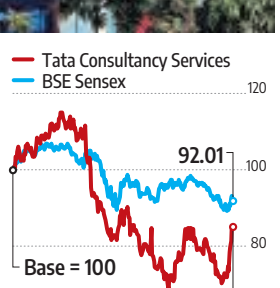
- Fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) major Hindustan Unilever Ltd (HUL) stock price continues to languish tracking its industry peers
- HUL stock price is down 18.2 per cent year-to-date in CY26 and is up 0.8 per cent month-to-date in October
- At its current stock price its trading at nearly 26 per cent discount its 5-year average valuation, biggest in many years
- Analysts at HDFC Securities expect HUL to report low double-digit growth in net sales in Q2FY27 aided by low base last year but earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) margins likely to contract from higher commodity prices
- HUL net sales was up 10.3 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) in Q1FY27, fastest growth in last four quarters
- Its adjusted net profit was however down 3.7 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1FY27 as Ebitda margins shrunk to 7-year low
- Brokerages see limited upside in the stock price given likely pressure on earnings and margins in forthcoming quarters



Tata Consultancy Services

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Sep 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
2,461	-16.9	-7.5	17.3	-38.6	45.9	9.9	4.3	8.7

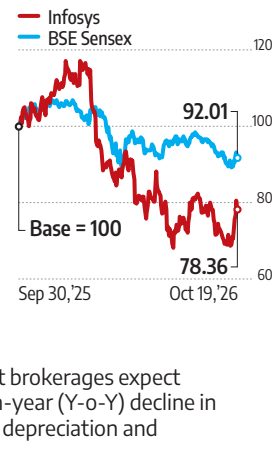
- Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) continues to trade at a big discount to its historical valuation despite recent rally
- Its current trailing price-to-earnings (P/E) at 16.3x is still nearly 39 per cent lower than 5-year average earnings multiple
- TCS's net sales were up 11.2 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) while adjusted net profit was up 7.4 per cent Y-o-Y in Q2FY27 in line with the growth seen in previous two quarters
- However, the company's earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) margins was up 60 basis points in Q2FY27 over Q2FY26 compared to margin contraction in Q1FY27
- TCS claimed that artificial intelligence (AI) revenue was up 19.2 per cent quarter-on-quarter (Q-o-Q) to $3.1 billion on an annualised basis, crossing 10 per cent of total revenue
- Analysts at Motilal Oswal maintain a "buy" rating though the stock price has already crossed the target price



Infosys

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Jun 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
1,131	-21.5	-9.1	15.3	-39.9	33.6	11.2	7.3	14.3

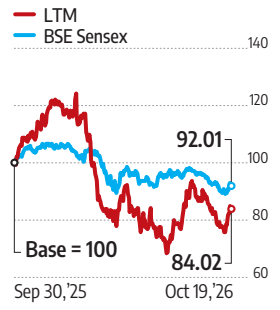
- Infosys share price is up 16.8 per cent month-to-date in October but it is still trading at nearly 40 per cent discount to its 5-year average valuation
- The stock is constant currency trading at a price-to-earnings (P/E) of 15.3x compared to its 5-year average earnings multiple of 25.4x
- The company is yet to declare its result for Q2FY27 but brokerages expect a muted quarter with a year-on-year (Y-o-Y) decline in earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) margins
- Analysts at HDFC Securities also expect Infosys to cut its revenue growth in constant current for FY27E by 50 basis points to 2-3 per cent (from 2-3.5 per cent)
- The firm's net sales were up 14 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1FY27, growing at the fastest pace in the last four quarters
- Infosys adjusted net profit was up 12.3 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1FY27 while Ebitda margin was down 27 basis points Y-o-Y in the quarter



LTM

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Sep 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
4,265	-23.9	-9.1	24.1	-28.2	21.7	14.7	5.4	15.1

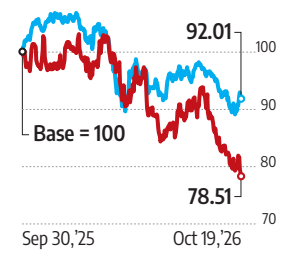
- Information technology (IT) major LTM is currently trading at trailing price-to-earnings (P/E) of 24.1x, 28 per cent discount to its 5-year average earnings multiple of 33.6x
- The company's net sales were up 13.6 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) in Q2FY27, growing at the slowest pace in the last three quarters
- The company's adjusted net profit was down 0.2 per cent Y-o-Y, its worst show in the last three quarters
- Management expects sequential growth to accelerate in H2FY27, following temporary weakness in technology and Saudi Arabia related business
- Its earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) margins were down nearly 300 basis points Y-o-Y in Q2FY27 to one of the lowest levels in the last 5 years
- Analysts at JM Financial see limited upside in the stock, given its high valuation and current growth profile



Britannia Industries

Share price (₹)	1-year Change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E Multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E Multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Jun 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
4,705	-22.7	4.4	43.5	-21.7	51.0	6.6	12.5	18.7

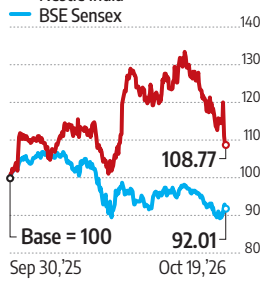
- Biscuits, bakery and dairy products major's stock is down 23 per cent over the past year and valuations are at a 22 per cent discount to its five-year average. Its returns ratios are second only to Nestlé on this list
- The company posted a steady performance in the June quarter aided by volume growth. Despite input cost pressures from the West Asia conflict, margins remained resilient
- Britannia, according to HDFC Securities, appears to have moved past its rough patch, with the new leadership revamping the execution team and sharpening its focus on reigniting growth across multiple fronts
- Growth trends across channels and states continue to improve, translating into sequential market share gain
- The company remains confident in navigating geopolitical uncertainties, with strong Q1 demand providing a healthy start to FY27. Axis Securities has a "buy" rating citing strong performance and gradual improvement in demand



Nestlé India

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Jun 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
1,243	-3.6	5.1	58.8	-22.2	68.8	21.7	30.2	34.7

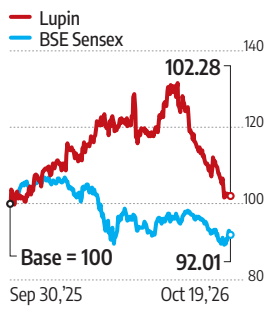
- Food processing major Nestlé India saw a decline in its share price in October after a relatively stable show during Jan-Sep period
- Nestlé share price is down 3.4 per cent month-to date in October against a 1.7 per cent decline in the first nine-months of CY26
- As a result there has been a valuation de-rating and it is currently trading at 22 per cent discount to its 5-year average price-to earnings (P/E) multiple of 75.5x
- Nestlé net sales were up 20.5 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) while its adjusted net profit was up 36.2 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1FY27 — both among the fastest in fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) space
- The company's earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation (Ebitda) margins were up nearly 200 basis points Y-o-Y in Q1FY27 despite inflationary pressures
- Analysts at HDFC Securities have upgraded the stock to buy and see 19 per cent upside on lower valuation and better earnings growth



Lupin

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Jun 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
1,939	0.0	15.6	16.6	-69.8	26.5	28.2	58.2	61.0

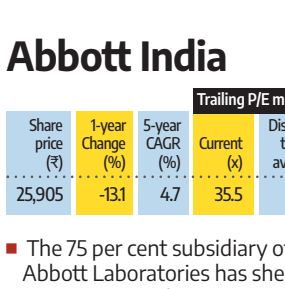
- Among the companies covered, Lupin is the most attractively valued, with its current trailing valuations at a 70 per cent discount to its five-year average
- The pharma major, according to PL Capital, saw a turnaround in profitability over the last 3 years with a 5 times jump in operating profit during FY23-26. This was aided by better product mix, continued niche launches in the US, clearance from USFDA for its facilities, domestic formulations regaining momentum and cost optimisation measures
- The company continues to outperform the Indian pharma market. Chronic therapies, which saw its revenue contribution rise to 65.7 per cent from 63.9 per cent a year ago, grew 18.9 per cent on a moving annual total (MAT) basis led by strong cardiac and anti-diabetic growth. In comparison, acute therapies MAT growth was 9.9 per cent
- This mix, the highest among top firms, combined with volume-led growth, provides good visibility on the sustainability of Lupin's domestic performance, according to Equirus Securities



United Spirits

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E Multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E Multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Jun 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
1,364	0.2	9.7	56.7	-23.8	20.7	3.1	14.2	15.4

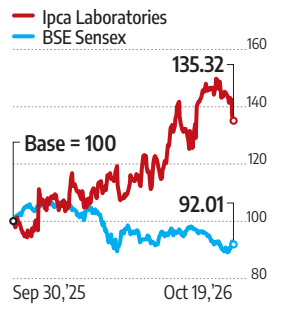
- The stock of India's leading alcohol beverage company is flattish over the past year and trades at a 24 per cent discount to its five-year average valuation
- A subsidiary of global beverage major Diageo, United Spirits is likely to benefit from the strong long-term outlook for the Indian spirits industry and leverage its parent's global marquee portfolio in premium categories
- Management remains focused on accelerating premiumisation through broader category participation and innovation-led brand investments
- Following its strategic reduction in the popular segment, the firm has delivered 7 per cent revenue growth over the last three years, with the Prestige & Above segment — which contributes 60 per cent of revenue growing at a robust 14 per cent annually
- In the medium term, HDFC Securities expects regulatory relaxation to support faster volume growth in the lower to mid-prestige segments



Ipca Laboratories

Share price (₹)	1-year change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Jun 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
1,815	41.1	9.2	40.3	-9.3	17.0	10.6	40.2	53.5

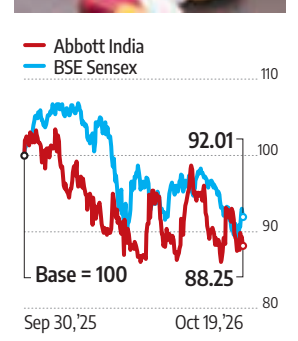
- Ipca Labs is the best performer on the returns front in this list with the least discount to five-year valuation. Strong beat in the June quarter (Q1), upward revision in topline and margin guidance and outlook has aided the rally
- The pharma company posted a broad-based sales beat across markets in Q1FY27. A strong topline led to a sharp 24 per cent beat in operating profit
- Exports continued to grow at a strong pace for the fourth consecutive quarter, led by a robust show in export generics and increased institutional sales
- After two quarters of weak performance, the active pharma ingredient segment saw a strong revival in growth during the quarter
- After three years of robust earnings growth during FY24-26, Motilal Oswal Research expects the momentum to sustain during FY26-28



Abbott India

Share price (₹)	1-year Change (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Trailing P/E multiple: Current (x)	Trailing P/E multiple: Discount to 5-yr avg (%)	RoNW (%)#	TTM ended Jun 2026 Y-o-Y chg (%): Revenue	PBIDT	Adj PAT
25,905	-13.1	4.7	35.5	-27.6	33.8	6.3	11.3	11.2

- The 75 per cent subsidiary of US-based healthcare major Abbott Laboratories has shed 13 per cent in value over the past year. Its valuations are now at a 28 per cent discount to its five-year average
- Abbott India's sales grew by 11 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) in Q1FY27 to ₹1,340 crore. Growth has increased since Q3FY26, when sales grew 7 per cent Y-o-Y, and growth improving to 11 per cent Y-o-Y in Q4FY26
- Overall growth was decent given the expected slowdown in some Novo Nordisk brands. It is noteworthy that, except for the anti-diabetic formulations Mixtard and Novomix, most of the power brands are consistently delivering 10-12 per cent growth, thus demonstrating stickiness
- The firm remains a standout performer among multinational corporations due to its new product launch trajectory and consistent relative performance, says ICICI Securities



Data as on Oct 19, 2026; Share price (rounded-off); chg: Change; CAGR: Compound annual growth rate; P/E: Price-to-earnings ratio (x); PBIDT: Profit before interest, depreciation and taxes; Adjusted PAT: Profit after tax excluding extra-ordinary items/one-offs; Financial data is for trailing 12 months (TTM) ended June 2026 except for Tata Consultancy Services and LTM which is for TTM ended September 2026; #RoNW (Return on net worth) calculated on latest TTM adjusted net profit; Compiled by *Business Standard* Research Bureau

Sources: Bloomberg, Capitaline, Exchanges

Power: The old is undermining the new

ABHISHEK ANAND, PRAVEEN RAVI, NAVNEERAJ SHARMA & ARVIND SUBRAMANIAN

In fifteen years, India has doubled power supply, virtually eliminating official shortages, which were once a tenth of peak demand. September 2026, with evening shortages and surging market prices, was an augury of the next challenge. It is tempting to treat this year as an outlier, the product of war, a weak monsoon and heat. That would be a mistake because the shocks exposed a structural problem: Under-investment in the old power sector.

The old sector has two parts: Non-intermittent generating capacity (NIC) — comprising coal, gas, hydro and nuclear — and distribution capacity, namely the local network that carries power to homes, shops and factories. The new sector consists of dynamic but intermittent power sources: Solar and wind.

Capacity in the new sector has grown from 13 Gw in 2011 to more than 220 Gw and helped meet rising demand in this difficult year, especially during the daytime. The success of the new sector, and official shortage figures that hide a more sober reality, have obscured the serious under-investment in the old — a gap that will only widen as demand soars from an AI-addled economy as and energy shocks become more frequent.

Consider generation. Figure 1 plots annual growth in demand against growth in capacity, split into NIC and intermittent sources. Growth in overall capacity consistently exceeded demand growth between 2010-11 and 2016-17 but fell short in most years thereafter. Since 2016-17, demand grew by about half while capacity grew by about a third. The key finding is that NIC capacity grew even more slowly, by less than a fifth. That matters most in the evenings and at night, when solar is of no help: the NIC installed for every 100 MW of evening peak demand has fallen by about a quarter since 2016-17, back to where it stood in 2010-11.

For some years the system coped well, because plants from the investment boom of the 2000s could be run harder. Coal plants ran at under 60 per cent of capacity in 2016-17 and at about 70 per cent by 2024-25. That was a good use of what had been built. This September there was little slack. In the evenings almost no coal plant that could run was standing idle and, after sunset, supply could not keep up with demand.

Take distribution next. While the data is less precise, we can estimate investment in the distribution network — what discoms spend each year on lines, substations, transformers and other equipment. Figure 2 plots such investment against underlying sales. From 2020-21 to 2022-23, discoms invested about as much each year, after inflation, as they had in the first half of the 2010s, while selling about 50 per cent more power. Even allowing for the uncertainty, we can say that in the last several years, the level of real investment has fallen behind the growth in power that the network has to carry, and even further behind what a modern system geared to incorporating increasing amounts of renewables will require. Investment has picked up since 2023-24, but has not yet caught up.

This under-investment is both a symptom of deeper problems and a potential aggravating factor. Discoms invest too little largely because many are loss-making and cash-strapped — where tariffs do not cover costs and subsidies arrive late, little is left for the network. Some discoms show that it can be done.

Gujarat's four state-owned discoms rank among the ten best in the power ministry's latest ratings. In Odisha, a private operator took over the discoms in 2020 and 2021. Within three years the share of power lost or not paid for fell from 31 per cent to 18 per cent, losses were turned into profits, and investment had risen. What these discoms share is not ownership but managers who are left to manage and are held to account.

There is a subtle but no less important link from discoms' weak finances to investment in generation, not in renewables but in NIC. A discom short of money buys as little power as it can in advance and relies on the exchange. In a normal year that is cheap. This September, with little power on offer and prices at their ceiling, discoms that had counted on the exchange had to cut supply. Nor will such a discom sign the long-term power purchase agreements (PPAs) that would insure it against a bad year. And without such contracts, generators, wary of being paid late, are reluctant to build new plants, NIC above all. As it is, investment in NIC is hobbled by the sword of Damocles: The risk that better batteries will leave new plants stranded.

Moreover, as the new sector expands, investment in the network will have to rise sharply. In an OECD study, the grid cost of each unit of solar and wind power roughly triples as their share of electricity goes from a tenth to three-quarters.

The network also has to help manage and reduce demand. As demand grows, time-of-day pricing (much higher prices during evening peaks) will become essential, and that requires smart meters. Despite the Centre sanctioning the funds, only about a quarter of the planned smart meters have been installed.

What next? Part of the framework exists. Guidelines issued in 2023 already require every discom to line up enough capacity to meet its demand. States now need to act on them: Contract for evening power that depends on neither rain nor imported gas, whether from new plants, pumped storage or batteries, and invest in the local network. Coal supply to plants also needs to become more reliable. By mid-September, plants held about a week's coal, half as much as a year earlier. The Centre can tie its support to reform, starting with hour-by-hour data on power cuts, and back the states that reform first. The binding constraint is political economy, not technology.

China is becoming one of those rare countries with surplus green power, geared to exploiting the AI revolution, because it has been building both sectors at once: Clean power, and the firm capacity and grids behind it. India has shown with solar that it can build fast. The next step is to bring the old sector up to the capabilities and standards of the new.

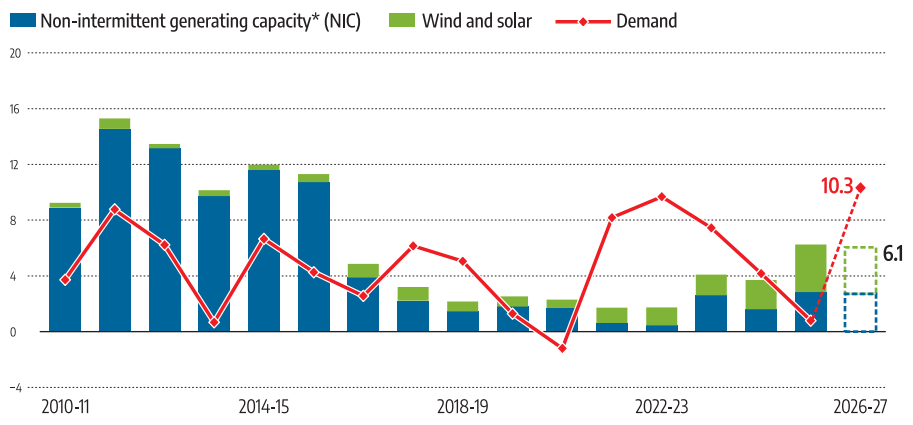
Abhishek Anand is visiting fellow, Madras Institute of Development Studies; Praveen Ravi is principal consultant, CEGIS; Navneeraj Sharma is an independent consultant; Arvind Subramanian is senior fellow, Peterson Institute for International Economics

Note: The analysis, not the writing, in this piece is based on extensive use of AI

Figure 1. Capacity and demand

Financial years 2010-11 to 2026-27

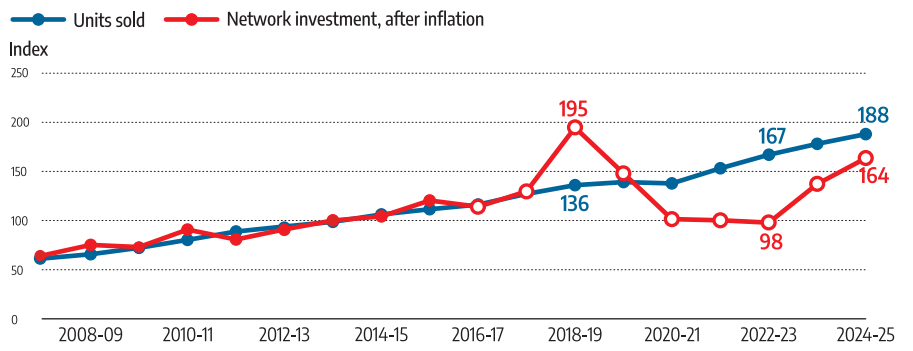
Growth in capacity (bars) and in demand (line), each financial year against the year before (% change)



Note: Capacity adjusted for energy equivalence: coal plants counted at 85% of capacity, other plants at the share of capacity they actually ran at that year. Demand is the energy needed in the year. 2026-27 is for April to September only (hollow bar);
*NIC — comprises coal, gas, hydro and nuclear
Sources: Central Electricity Authority; Grid-India; authors' calculations

Figure 2. Electricity sales and distribution investment (index)

Units of electricity sold and discom investment after inflation; average of 2011-12 to 2015-16 = 100



Sources: Power Finance Corporation; World Bank; authors' estimates

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ARM BRANCH , AGRA

E-AUCTION NOTICE

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES UNDER THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 READ WITH PROVISON TO RULE 9(1) and 8 (6) OF THE SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower (s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the Physical/Symbolic possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of Canara Bank, Secured Creditor, will be sold on **"As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is"** for the recovery of dues to the Bank. The details are describe herebelow.

S. No.	Name & Address of Borrowers & Guarantors	Amount due (Rs.) as per demand notice	Description of Properties	Type of Possession	Reserve Price (Rs.) / EMD 10% (Rs.)
	For Sr. No. 1 — **Date & Time of e-auction : 27.11.2026 from 11:00 AM to 1:00 PM (With extension of 5 min. duration each till the conclusion of sale) & EMD deposit date : 26.11.2026 upto 05:00 PM**				
1.	**Borrower-** M/s Surbhi Enterprises Through Its Proprietor Smt Surbhi Singhal W/o Shri Mayank Singhal, Add.- Katra Wazir Khan Yamuna Bank, Agra, Proprietor/ Guarantor/ Mortgagor- Smt Surbhi Singhal W/o Shri Mayank Singhal, Guarantor- Shri Mayank Singhal S/o Shri Vinod Singhal, Add. of both- Ward No.2, Ab Road, Shiv Mandir Ke Paas New City Colony, Ashok Nagar, Guna, M.P., Guarantor/Mortgagor- Shri Nishant Goyal S/o Late Girish Goyal, Add.- 51 G. F. Hanuman Nagar Maruti State Shahganj, Agra **Sale Notice Letter Date: 17.10.2026**	**40,90,095.70** as per demand notice dt. 17.06.2026 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	EMT of Residential Flat Building property situated at Flat No. 105, at Ground Floor, on plot no. 05, Khasrano. 263, Mauja Patholi, Shri Tulsi Meera Homes, Block 5, Mauza Patholi, Tehsil and District Agra, Area: 69.69 sqmtrs, in the name of Shri Nishant Goyal S/o Late Shri Girish Goyal and Smt Surbhi Singhal W/o Shri Mayank Singhal, Bounded as: East: Flat No 104, West: Flat no. 106 & Staircase and Passage, North: 9 Mtr wide road, South: Others property Details of Property	Symbolic	22,31,000/- / 2,23,000/-
	For Sr. No. 2 to 7 — **Date & Time of e-auction : 13.11.2026 from 11:00 AM to 1:00 PM (With extension of 5 min. duration each till the conclusion of sale) & EMD deposit date : 12.11.2026 upto 05:00 PM**				
2.	**Borrower/Mortgagor-** M/s Malik Packaging, through proprietor - Shri Suhail Malik S/o Shri Shamsuddin, **Guarantor-** a) Shri Shamsuddin S/o Late Shri Nizamuddin, b) Shri Yusuf Malik S/o Late Shri Nizamuddin, c) Late Smt Avda Begam urf Avadi Begum w/o Late Shri Nizamuddin through her Legal Heirs, i) Shri Shamsuddin ii) Shri Parvej Malik, iii) Shri Yusuf Malik, iv) Late Aasif Malik through his legal heirs Smt Mubina W/o Late Aasif Malik & Other Legal Heirs, d) Late Aasif Malik through his Legal Heirs Smt Mubina W/o Late Aasif Malik & Other legal heirs **Sale Notice Letter Date: 17.10.2026**	**56,29,077.45** as per demand notice dt. 10.04.2026 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	EMT of Commercial Cum Residential Property, situated at Property No. 29/48 & 29/50, Gali Hattu Kha, Mal Ka bazaar, Agra, Area: 123.03 Sq Mtr, in the name of Shamsuddin, Yusuf Malik, Legal Heirs of Late Avda Begum urf Avadi Begum & Legal heirs of Late Aasif Malik, Bounded as: East: Property of Bedamal Sindhi, West: Shop of Nasruddin & Gali Hattu Kha, North: Property of Basiruddin, South: Govt Road Details of Property	Symbolic	70,25,000/- / 7,03,000/-
3.	**Borrower- 1.** Smt Asha Gupta W/o Shri Anand Singh Gupta, **2.** Shri Anand Singh Gupta S/o Shri Dhani Ram Gupta, **Add. of both-** B 1, Veer Nagar, Dayalbagh, Agra, **3.** Shri Omveer Singh Ponia S/o Shri Natha Singh, Add.- 9 RVN, Real Estate, Satguru Dham, Agra **Sale Notice Letter Date: 17.10.2026**	**28,83,531/-** as per demand notice dt. 11.01.2018 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	Residential Property at Plot No 113, Part of Khasra No 72, Gayatri Suncity, Rajrai, Agra, Area- 151.03 Sq. Mtr., in the name of Smt Asha Gupta W/o Shri Anand Singh Gupta & Shri Anand Singh Gupta S/o Dhani Ram Gupta, Bounded as: East- Plot No 114, West- Plot No 112, North- 18' Wide Road, South- Others Property Details of Property	Physical	20,82,000/- / 2,09,000/-
4.	**Borrower-** 1. M/s Flexo Footwear Through its Proprietor- Shri Merajuddin S/o Shri Shahbuddin, 2. Shri Merajuddin S/o Shri Shahbuddin, 3. Shri Suhail Ahmed S/o Shri Shahbuddin, Add. of all- 15/42 Soron Katra Shahganj, Agra **Sale Notice Letter Date: 17.10.2026**	**22,49,841.83** as per demand notice dt. 26.06.2025 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	Emt of Residential Cum Commercial Building Property Situated at Plot No. 08, In Part of Khasra No. 30 of Village Abhaypura, Tehsil & District Agra, Area- 167.22 Sq Meter, Bounded as: East- House of Raj Kumari Devi, West- Owner's Property then Other's Property, North- Others Property, South- Rasta 9.00 m wide & Exit Details of Property	Symbolic	40,94,000/- / 4,10,000/-
5.	**Borrower- M/s Krishna Agencies**, Add.- Plot No 4, ARJ Estate Phase 3, Mauza Chhalesar Etmadpur Agra **Through Its Directors & Guarantors- 1.** Sri Lokendra Khurana S/o Sri Keval Krishna Khurana, **2.** Smt Kavita Khurana W/o Sri Lokendra Khurana, Add. of both- Flat No. 702,7th Floor, Kaveri Kaustubh,Tower-2, Near Bhawna Estate, Sikandra, Agra, **3.** Smt Usha Khurana W/o Sri Kewal Krishna Khurana, Add.- Flat No. Ex- 133, Bhawna Executive Apartment Ist Floor, Bhawna Estate, Sikandra, Agra **Sale Notice Letter Date: 17.10.2026**	**3,76,55,978.73** as per demand notice dt. 11.09.2023 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	EMT of Commercial Shop Property Situated at Shop No.6 at Ist Floor, Vashishtha Complex, NH -2 Service Road, Hariparwat Ward, Tehsil & Distt Agra, Area- 353.28 Sq. Ft., in the name of Sri Lokendra Khurana S/o Sri Kewal Krishna Khurana, Bounded as: East- Passage, West- Shop No. 9, North- Shop No. 7 & 8, South- Others Property Details of Property	Physical	19,28,000/- / 1,93,000/-
6.	**Borrower-** 1. M/S RGS Footwear, 2. Shri Bablu S/o Shri Shakoor Khan, Add. of both- 4A/786, Keshar Vihar Shahganj, Agra, 3. Sharifan Beghum W/o Shakoor Khan, Add.- Khasra No 644, Nagar Nigam No. 50/K-644B, Alipur Albatiya Road, Lohamandi Ward, Mauza Boghipura, Agra **Sale Notice Letter Date: 17.10.2026**	**34,23,176.80** as per demand notice dt. 29.07.2021 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	Property bearing on Khasra No.644 situated at Alipur Lohamandi Ward Agra and Nagar Nigam No 5D/K-644B, Area- 83.61 Sq. Mtr., property in the name of Smt Sharifan Beghum W/o Shakoor Khan, Bounded as: East: 8 Feet wide Road and Entry, West: Land Prabhudayal, North: Plot of Sh Dayashankar, South: Land Deegar Details of Property	Physical	22,10,000/- / 2,21,000/-
7.	**Borrower- 1. Avon Elastomers India,** Add 1- 60, Jaipur House Colony, Agra, Add 2- Nagla Birbal, Sadabad, Hathras, 2. Shri Gagan Monga S/o Bharat Bhusan Monga, 3. Shri Harkesh Monga S/o Bharat Bhusan Monga, Add of both- 60, Jaipur House Colony, Agra, 4. Smt. Prem Tata W/o V.S AGR, Add- Nagla Birbal, Sadabad, Hathras **Sale Notice Letter Date: 17.10.2026**	**10,64,47,209.70** as per demand notice dt. 02.02.2019 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	1. Shop on plot No. C-36, khasra no. 2087 Mauza Ghatwasan jatni ka bagh, Jeevanee Mandi ,Near Jannat Hotel Agra, Area- 46.44 sq Mtr./ 55.55 Sq Yrds, in the name of Shri Gagan Monga S/o Shri Bharat Bhusan Monga, Bounded as: East– Plot No. C -37, West– Plot No. C 35, North– Other's Property, South– 25 feet wide Road Details of Property	Physical	16,02,000/- / 1,60,000/-
			2. Shop on plot No. C-37, khasra no. 2087 Mauza Ghatwasan jatni ka bagh, Jeevanee Mandi, Agra, Area- 46.44 sq Mtr., in the name of shri Gagan Monga S/o Shri Bharat Bhusan Monga, Bounded as: East– Plot No.C -38, West– Plot No. C 36, North– Property No. 19, South– Rasta 25 feet wide Road Details of Property	Physical	16,02,000/- / 1,60,000/-
	For Sr. No. 8 — **Date & Time of e-auction : 30.11.2026 from 11:00 AM to 1:00 PM (With extension of 5 min. duration each till the conclusion of sale) & EMD deposit date : 29.11.2026 upto 05:00 PM**				
8.	**Borrower-** 1. M/s. SMG Float Glass Works through its Partners Shri Asit Kumar & Smt. Usha Devi, Add.- 36, Radhika Enclaves, Khamani Goverdhan Road, Mathura, 2. Shri Asit Kumar S/o Babooram, 3. Smt. Usha Devi W/o Asit Kumar, Add. of both- Farrukhabad Road, Udaypura, Ivanepur Pathakpur, Etawah **Sale Notice Letter Date: 17.10.2026**	**2,63,46,416.51** as per demand notice dt. 18.09.2020 + interest & Other Exp. thereon (less recovery, if any)	Glass Stand- 3N, Scrap glass(kg)- 50Kg, Ceiling Fan- 3N, Bada Takhat- 1N, Window AC- 1N, Sofa Set- 1N, Deewan- 1N, Table- 1N, Double Bed- 2N, Almirah- 2N, Chair- 7N, Compressor- 1N, Ladder- 3N, Ply Board- 1N, Pipe- 4N, Fridge- 1N, Window Ac- 1N, Stabilizer- 1N, Fan- 1N, Wooden Counter- 1N, Double Bed box- 1N, Wooden Almirah- 1N, Glass Stand- 6N, Wooden Table- 1N, Glass 6*6- 6N, Glass 4*6- 3N, Glass 2*6- 13N, Sofa - 1N, Doble Bed- 2N, Window AC Loyad- 2N, 24-inch TV Haier company- 1N, Dressing Table- 1N, Celling Fan- 1N, Gas Cylinder with Chula- 1N, Chimney- 1N, Plastic Chair- 3N, Miscellaneous- 1N	Physical	47,550/- / 4,755/-

EMD amount is to be deposited in E-Wallet of M/s PSB Alliance Private Limited (BAANKNET) portal directly or by generating the Challan therein to deposit the EMD through RTGS/NEFT in the account details as mentioned in the said challan before above mentioned dates respectively. After depositing of EMD amount intending bidder/s may select the property and place the bid.

Note: 1. No interest will be claimed on the bid/subsequent amount. 2. Authorised officer is entitled to cancel the bid at any stage without assigning any reason whatsoever. 3. All charges for conveyance, stamp duty/GST registration charges etc., as applicable shall be borne by the successful bidder only.

For details terms and conditions of the sale and participating in E Auction, please go through the website https://baanknet.com/ or Canara Bank's Website or may contact ARM Branch, Canra Bank (Mob. 9084688622 e-mail id cb7315@canarabank.com) OR to the service provider M/S PSB Alliance Ltd (baanknet) contact on 8291220220.

Place : Agra Date : 21-10-2026 **Authorised Officer**

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Business Standard
Insight Out

Airport baggage weight issue under govt scanner

DEEPAK PATEL
New Delhi, 20 October

The Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) is likely to take steps to address concerns over alleged discrepancies in baggage weighing at airports and disputed excess-baggage charges. It is said to be looking into the issue following a representation by Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) Rajya Sabha Member of Parliament Ajeet Madhavrao Gopchade to Cabinet Secretary T V Somanathan seeking a nationwide audit of weighing machines and independent reference scales for passengers.

In his letter dated September 27, Gopchade called for "ensuring accurate and independently verified baggage weighing at airports to protect air passengers from disputed excess-baggage charges". Somanathan acknowledged receipt of the letter in a response dated October 5.

Sources in the ministry privy to the development told *Business Standard* that the MoCA is now looking into the concerns raised by the MP.

The MoCA and the Cabinet Secretariat did not respond to *Business Standard's* queries on this matter.

In his letter, Gopchade had pointed to a media report based on a LocalCircles survey of over 36,000 passengers across 289 districts. The report said six out of 10 flyers had experienced higher baggage weights at airport check-in than at home.

The MP also referred to a reported instance in which the same bag showed weights of 18 kg, 16 kg and 15 kg on three different airport scales. He said earlier Legal Metrology inspections at Pune airport had found baggage scales with errors beyond permissible limits, meaning the machines were weighing luggage inaccurately beyond the margin allowed under measurement rules.

Gopchade sought a nationwide special Legal Metrology audit, which would involve checking baggage weighing machines for accuracy and compliance with measurement rules. He called for mandatory periodic verification and scientific calibration, that is checking and adjusting machines against recognised measurement standards, through competent laboratories.

The Ministry of Consumer Affairs had also intervened in December 2023 after passengers complained that airport baggage scales showed higher weights than the actual weight of their luggage, potentially forcing them to pay excess-baggage charges. In one instance, a suitcase weighing 15 kg when its owner checked out of a hotel weighed 16.5 kg on an airline's scale at the airport.

The Legal Metrology Division of the Ministry of Consumer Affairs had written to officials in states and Union territories on December 19, 2023, asking them to inspect, verify and recalibrate airport baggage scales. The letter stressed that weighing systems needed to be "completely accurate and trustworthy", particularly since passengers were required to pay for excess baggage.

Delhi airport's passenger traffic rose 5% in H1FY27

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 20 October

Total passenger traffic at Delhi airport rose 5 per cent to 38.5 million in the first six months ended September 2026, driven by more number of domestic as well as international travellers.

In the first half of 2025-26, Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGIA) in the national capital had reported passenger traffic of 36.7 million.

Latest data provided by GMR Airports showed that Air Traffic Movements (ATMs) at the airport also jumped 6.9 per cent to 233,331 in the first half of the ongoing 2026-27 financial year.

During this period, the domestic traffic climbed to 28.1 million while the international traffic increased to 10.4 million, taking the total traffic to 38.5 million.

IGIA is operated by Delhi International Airport Ltd (DIAL), part of GMR Airports.

At the Delhi airport, average monthly traffic stood around 6.5 million and also recorded the highest-ever H1 total passenger traffic in the first six months of this financial year, GMR Airports said in a recent regulatory filing.

KILLING OF 3 MEITEI PEOPLE

Manipur CM meets Oppn leaders as strike hits normal life in valley districts

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Imphal, 20 October

A deserted street in Imphal on Tuesday during a statewide protest called by a civil society group against the killing of three civilians PHOTO:PTI

Manipur Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh on Tuesday held a meeting with INDIA bloc leaders, including state Congress chief Okram Ibobi Singh, and reviewed the overall law and order situation amid a statewide 48-hour strike called to protest the killing of three Meiteis by suspected militants in Kangpokpi district.

Members of the Native People Committee Manipur in different parts of Imphal East and Imphal West districts blocked roads and staged protests against the killing of three firewood collectors at Sunurok hills in Kangpokpi a day ago. The organisation called for the bandh on Tuesday and Wednesday.

Normal life was affected with closures of markets, educational institutions and business establishments in five valley districts of Manipur. Public transport remained off the roads, but a few private vehicles were seen plying. Most markets, educational institutions and business establishments were closed in Imphal East, Imphal West, Bishnupur, Thoubal and Kakching districts.

The chief minister, in a social media post, said the meeting reviewed the overall security situation of the state. He also said the representatives of political parties expressed deep concern over Monday's incident and urged him to convene an all-political party meeting in view of the prevailing situation.

On Monday night, protestors burnt tyres on roads at Kwakeithel and Chingmeirong in Imphal West district and Khurai Lamlong in Imphal East.

Security has been tightened in and around the state capital as a precautionary measure, a police officer said, adding that no untoward incident has been reported this morning, but protesters held demonstrations in some areas.

The ethnic conflict that erupted in May 2023 between the valley-based Meitei and hill-based Kuki communities in Manipur has claimed at least 306 lives, while 49 people remain missing and thousands have been left homeless. In recent months, clashes between Kuki and Naga communities have also been reported.

The meeting, held at the CM Secretariat, was also attended by Lok Sabha MP Angomcha Bimol Akoijam and leaders of various political parties belonging to the Opposition bloc.

The CM said the meeting with Opposition leaders also had a constructive discussion on maintaining peace and collective efforts for the restoration of normalcy in the state.

Later, Ibobi Singh told reporters, "Representatives of the INDIA bloc met the CM to discuss the prevailing law and order situation, which has deteriorated rapidly."

"There have been killings of people from every community. In fact, law and order has completely failed in the state. If the government wants to curb the armed groups, it is only a question of a few days," the Congress leader claimed.

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